

Euthydemus

ΕΥΘΥΔΗΜΟΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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CR: Who was it, Socrates, you were conversing with in the Lyceum yesterday? There was such a large crowd gathered around you that even though I wanted to listen I was not able to hear anything clearly when I got close. Yet when I popped my head up I got a look, and you seemed to be in conversation with a stranger. Who was he?

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S: Which of them are you asking about, Crito? For there were two men, not one.

ΚΡ. τίς ἦν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ὃ χθὲς ἐν Λυκείῳ διελέγου; ἢ πολὺς ὤμας ὄχλος περιειστίηται, ὥστ' ἔγωγε βουλόμενος ἀκούειν προσελθὼν οὐδὲν οἶός τ' ἢ ἀκοῦσαι σαφές· ὑπερκύψας μέντοι κατεῖδον, καί μοι ἔδοξεν εἶναι ξένος τις ὃ διελέγου. τίς ἦν; ΣΩ. πότερον καὶ ἐρωτᾷς, ὃ Κρίτων; οὐ γὰρ εἷς ἀλλὰ δύο ἦσθην. ΚΡ. ὃν μὲν ἐγὼ λέγω, ἐκ δεξιᾶς τρίτος ἀπὸ σοῦ καθῆστο·

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CR: I am referring to the man seated two places to your right. Axiochus' boy was between the two of you, and he seemed to me to have really grown up, Socrates, and to be much the same age as our own Critobolus, who is a slender youth, while that boy looks older than his years and is noble and good in aspect.

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S: Euthydemus is the man you are asking about, Crito. And the person seated on my left was his brother, Dionysodorus. He gets involved in the discussions too.

ἐν μέσῳ δ' ὤμων τὸ Ἀξιόχου μειράκιον ἦν. καὶ μάλα πολὺ, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐπιδεδωκέναι μοι ἔδοξεν, καὶ τοῦ ἡμετέρου οὐ πολὺ τι τὴν ἡλικίαν διαφέρειν Κριτοβούλου. ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνος μὲν σκληφρός, οὗτος δὲ προφερὴς καὶ καλὸς καὶ ἀγαθὸς τὴν ὄψιν. ΣΩ. Εὐθύδημος οὗτός ἐστιν, ὃ Κρίτων, ὃν ἐρωτᾷς, ὃ δὲ παρ' ἐμὲ καθήμενος ἐξ ἀριστερᾶς ἀδελφὸς τούτου, Διονυσόδωρος μετέχει δὲ καὶ οὗτος τῶν λόγων. ΚΡ. οὐδέτερον γινώσκω, ὃ Σώκρατες. καινοὶ τινες αὖ

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CR: I don't know either of them, Socrates. They are, it seems, more sophists, a new kind. Where are they from, and what is their wisdom?

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S: Although the family is, I believe, from this part of the world, from Chios, these men went to Thurii as colonists. But after being exiled from there, they have already spent several years in these regions. As for your question about their wisdom, it is astounding, Crito. These two are almost totally wise. They really are a pair of total combatants – not like the two total athletes from Acharnania. For those two are able to fight with the body alone, while these two are firstly physically formidable in armour-fighting, and able to teach anyone who pays them a fee. Secondly, they are supreme in courtroom combat, both in fighting a case, and in teaching someone else to deliver and to compose the kind of speeches appropriate for the law courts. And of late they have brought perfection to their skill as total athletes, becoming so formidable in verbal combat and in refuting whatever anyone says, whether it be true or false. So I am thinking of placing myself in their hands, Crito.

οὗτοι, ὡς ἔοικε, σοφισταί· ποδαποί; καὶ τίς ἡ σοφία; ΣΩ. οὗτοι τὸ μὲν γένος, ὡς ἐγῶμαι, ἐντεῦθεν ποθέν εἰσιν ἐκ Χίου, ἀπώκησαν δὲ ἐς Θουρίους, φεύγοντες δὲ ἐκεῖθεν πόλλ' ἤδη ἔτη περὶ τούσδε τοὺς τόπους διατρίβουσιν. ὃ δὲ σὺ ἐρωτᾷς τὴν σοφίαν αὐτοῖν, θαυμασία, ὦ Κρίτων· πάσσοφοι ἀτεχνῶς τῷ γε, οὐδ' ἤδη πρὸ τοῦ ὅτι εἶεν οἱ παγκρατιασταί. τούτῳ γὰρ ἔστον κομιδῇ παμμάχῳ. οὐ κατὰ τὸ Ἀκαρνᾶνε ἐγενέσθην τὸ παγκρατιαστὰ ἀδελφῷ· ἐκείνῳ μὲν γὰρ τῷ σώματι μόνον οἶώ τε μάχεσθαι, τούτῳ δὲ πρῶτον μὲν τῷ σώματι δεινοτάτῳ ἔστὸν καὶ μάχῃ, ἢ πάντων ἔστι κρατεῖν ΣΩ. —ἐν ὅπλοις γὰρ αὐτῷ τε σοφῷ πάνυ μάχεσθαι καὶ ἄλλον, ὃς ἂν διδῶ μισθόν, οἶώ τε ποιῆσαι—ἔπειτα τὴν ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις μάχην κρατίστῳ καὶ ἀγωνίσασθαι καὶ ἄλλον διδάξαι λέγειν τε καὶ συγγράφεσθαι λόγους οἷους εἰς τὰ δικαστήρια. πρὸ τοῦ μὲν οὖν ταῦτα δεινῷ ἦσθην μόνον, νῦν δὲ τέλος ἐπιτεθήκατον παγκρατιαστικῇ τέχνῃ. ἢ γὰρ ἦν λοιπὴ αὐτοῖν μάχῃ ἀργός, ταύτην νῦν

ἐξείργασθον, ὥστε μὴδ' ἂν ἓνα αὐτοῖς οἶόν τ' εἶναι μὴδ' ἀντᾶραι· οὕτω δεινῷ γεγόνατον ἐν τοῖς λόγοις μάχεσθαί τε καὶ ἐξελέγχειν

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CR: What's this, Socrates? Aren't you afraid, at your age, that you may already be too old?

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S: Not in the least, Crito. I have enough evidence, and encouragement, not to be afraid. For these two were almost old men when they embarked in this disputatious wisdom which I am so keen on. There is only one thing I am afraid of – that I might draw criticism upon the two strangers, just as I did to the harpist Connus, who still, even now, is teaching me to play the harp. So I'm afraid someone may criticise the two strangers in the very same way. And perhaps, fearing this very outcome, they may be unwilling to accept me. Yet, Crito, I have persuaded other old men to attend the class as fellow pupils of mine, and in this case too I shall attempt to persuade some others. Yes, why don't you attend along with me? And we will bring your sons as bait. Since they will want the boys as pupils, I know that they will educate us too.

τὸ αἰὶ λεγόμενον, ὁμοίως ἕαντε ψευδὸς ἕαντε ἀληθὲς ἦ. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Κρίτων, ἐν νῶ ἔχω τοῖν ἀνδροῖν παραδοῦναι ἐμαυτόν· καὶ γὰρ φατον ἐν ὀλίγῳ χρόνῳ ποιῆσαι ἂν καὶ ἄλλον ὄντιν οὖν τὰ αὐτὰ ταῦτα δεινόν. ΚΡ. τί δέ, ὦ Σώκρατες; οὐ φοβῇ τὴν ἡλικίαν, μὴ ἤδη πρεσβύτερος ἦς; ΣΩ. ἥκιστα γε, ὦ Κρίτων· ἱκανὸν τεκμήριον ἔχω καὶ παραμύθιον τοῦ μὴ φοβεῖσθαι. αὐτῷ γὰρ τούτῳ, ὥς ἔπος εἰπεῖν, γέροντε ὄντε ἡρξάσθην ταύτης τῆς σοφίας ἣς ἔγωγε ἐπιθυμῶ, τῆς ἐριστικῆς· πέρυσιν ἢ προπέρυσιν οὐδέπω ἦσθην

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CR: There's no reason not to, Socrates, if that's what you think. But first explain to me what the wisdom of the two men is so that I may know what we are going to learn.

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S: You shall hear straightaway, as I can't claim that I didn't pay attention to them. No, I attended fully, and I remember, and I shall try to recount everything to you from the beginning. Indeed, by some divine providence I happened to be sitting there, just where you saw me, alone in the dressing room, and I was already thinking of getting up to leave. But as soon as I stood up, the familiar divine sign came. So I sat down again, and a little later these two men entered, Euthydemus and Dionysodorus, and others too, pupils of theirs, I think. And once they arrived they walked about in the roofed portico. They had barely completed two or three circuits when Clinias¹ came in – and what you say is true, he really has grown up. Behind him was a whole host of admirers, and among them was Ctesippus, a young man from the deme of Paeania, noble and good by nature, except for some arrogance born of youth.

σοφώ. ἀλλ' ἐγὼ ἔν μόνον φοβοῦμαι, μὴ αὖ ὄνειδος τοῖν ξένοιον περιάψω, ὥσπερ Κόννων τῷ Μητροβίου, τῷ καθαριστῇ, ὃς ἐμὲ διδάσκει ἔτι καὶ νῦν καθαρίζειν ὀρώντες οὖν οἱ παῖδες οἱ συμφοιτηταί μοι ἐμοῦ τε καταγελῶσι καὶ τὸν Κόννον καλοῦσι γεροντοδιδάσκαλον. μὴ οὖν καὶ τοῖν ξένοιον τις ταῦτὸν τοῦτο ὀνειδίσῃ· οἱ δ' αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἴσως φοβούμενοι τάχα με οὐκ ἂν ἐθέλοιεν προσδέξασθαι. ἐγὼ δ', ὦ Κρίτων, ἐκεῖσε μὲν ἄλλους πέπεικα συμμαθητάς μοι φοιτᾶν πρεσβύτας, ἐνταῦθα δέ γε ἐτέρους πειράσομαι πείθειν. καὶ σὺ τί οὐ συμφοιτᾷς; ὥς δὲ δέλεαρ αὐτοῖς ἄζομεν τοὺς σοὺς ὑεῖς· ἐφιέμενοι γὰρ ἐκείνων οἶδ' ὅτι καὶ ἡμᾶς παιδεύσουσιν. ΚΡ. ἀλλ' οὐδὲν κωλύει, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἕαν γε σοὶ δοκῇ. πρῶτον δέ μοι διηγήσαι τὴν σοφίαν τοῖν ἀνδροῖν τίς ἐστίν, ἵνα εἰδῶ ὅτι καὶ μαθησόμεθα. ΣΩ. οὐκ ἂν φθάνοις ἀκούων· ὥς οὐκ ἂν ἔχοιμί γε εἰπεῖν ὅτι οὐ προσεῖχον τὸν νοῦν αὐτοῖν, ἀλλὰ πάνυ καὶ προσεῖχον καὶ μέμνημαι, καὶ σοὶ πειράσομαι ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἅπαντα διηγῆσασθαι.

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S: Now, when Clinias saw me from the entrance, seated on my own, he came straight over and sat down on my right, just as you say. On seeing him, Dionysodorus and Euthydemus first stood talking to one another, glancing over at us from time to time. Then one of them, Euthydemus,

went and sat beside the young man, while the other one sat next to me on my left, and the others sat where they could.

κατὰ θεὸν γάρ τινα ἔτυχον καθήμενος ἐνταῦθα, οὔτερ σύ με εἶδες, ἐν τῷ ἀποδυτηρίῳ μόνος, καὶ ἤδη ἐν νῷ εἶχον ἀναστῆναι· ἀνισταμένου δέ μου ἐγένετο τὸ εἰωθὸς σημεῖον τὸ δαιμόνιον. ΣΩ. πάλιν οὖν ἐκαθεζόμεν, καὶ ὀλίγω

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Well, I greeted them both warmly as it was some time since I had seen them, and then I said to Clinias that Euthydemus and Dionysodorus knew everything there is to know about warfare, whatever anyone who is to be a good general needs to know, and that they are also able to make someone capable of coming to his own aid in court, should someone do him an injustice. Now, when I said this they were contemptuous. So they laughed, exchanged glances, and Euthydemus said, “We no longer take these matters seriously, Socrates. No, we treat them as diversions.” I was amazed and I said, “Your work must surely be noble if such weighty concerns as these are mere diversions for you. By god, tell me what this noble concern is.” “Excellence, Socrates,” he replied, “is what we believe we are able to impart better and more quickly than anyone else.”

ὕστερον εἰσέρχεσθον τούτῳ—ὃ τ’ Εὐθύδημος καὶ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος—καὶ ἄλλοι μαθηταὶ ἅμα αὖ πολλοὶ ἐμοὶ δοκεῖν· εἰσελθόντε δὲ περιπατεῖτην ἐν τῷ καταστέγῳ δρόμῳ. καὶ οὕτω τούτῳ δὴ ἢ τρεῖς δρόμους περιεληλυθότε ἦσθην, καὶ εἰσέρχεται Κλεινίας, ὃν σὺ φῆς πολὺ ἐπιδεδωκέναι, ἀληθῆ λέγων· ὀπισθεν δὲ αὐτοῦ ἔρασταὶ πάνυ πολλοὶ τε καὶ ἄλλοι καὶ Κτήσιππος, νεανίσκος τις Παιανιεύς, μάλα καλὸς τε κάγαθός τιν φύσιν, ὅσον μὴ ὑβριστὴς δὲ διὰ τὸ νέος εἶναι. ἰδὼν οὖν με ὁ Κλεινίας ἀπὸ τῆς εἰσόδου μόνον καθήμενον, ἄντικρυς ἰὼν παρεκαθέζετο ἐκ δεξιᾶς, ὥστερ καὶ σὺ φῆς. ἰδόντε δὲ αὐτὸν ὃ τε Διονυσόδωρος καὶ ὁ Εὐθύδημος πρῶτον μὲν ἐπιστάντε διελεγέσθην ἀλλήλοιν, ἄλλην καὶ ἄλλην ἀποβλέποντε εἰς ἡμᾶς—καὶ γὰρ πάνυ αὐτοῖν προσεῖχον τὸν νοῦν—ἔπειτα ἰόντε ὁ μὲν παρὰ τὸ μεῖράκιον ἐκαθέζετο,

ὁ Εὐθύδημος, ὁ δὲ παρ' αὐτὸν ἐμὲ ἐξ ἀριστερᾶς, οἱ δ' ἄλλοι ὡς ἕκαστος ἐτύγχανεν. ἤσπαζόμεν οὖν αὐτῷ ἅτε διὰ χρόνου ἑωρακώς· μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο εἶπον πρὸς τὸν Κλεινίαν· ὦ Κλεινία, τῷδε μέντοι τῷ ἄνδρι σοφῷ, Εὐθύδημός τε καὶ Διονυσόδωρος, οὐ τὰ σμικρὰ ἀλλὰ τὰ μεγάλα τὰ γὰρ περὶ τὸν πόλεμον πάντα ἐπίστασθον, ὅσα δεῖ τὸν μέλλοντα ἀγαθὸν στρατηγὸν ἔσεσθαι, τάς τε τάξεις καὶ τὰς ἡγεμονίας τῶν στρατοπέδων καὶ ὅσα ἐν ὅπλοις μάχεσθαι διδασκτέον· οἷω τε δὲ καὶ ποιῆσαι δυνατὸν εἶναι αὐτὸν αὐτῷ βοηθεῖν ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις, ἃν τις αὐτὸν ἀδικῇ. εἰπὼν οὖν ταῦτα κατεφρονήθη ὑπ' αὐτοῖν· ἐγελασάτην οὖν ἄμφω βλέψαντες εἰς ἀλλήλῳ, καὶ ὁ Εὐθύδημος εἶπεν· οὗτοι ἔτι ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, σπουδάζομεν, ἀλλὰ παρέργοις αὐτοῖς χρώμεθα. κἀγὼ θαυμάσας εἶπον· καλὸν ἄν που τὸ ἔργον ὑμῶν εἴη, εἰ τηλικαῦτα πράγματα πάρεργα ὑμῖν τυγχάνει ὄντα, καὶ πρὸς θεῶν εἵπετόν μοι τί ἐστὶ τοῦτο τὸ καλόν. ἀρετὴν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, οἰόμεθα οἷω τ' εἶναι παραδοῦναι κάλλιστ' ἀνθρώπων καὶ τάχιστα.

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“By Zeus,” I said, “you are making quite a declaration. Where did you discover this godsend? But, Dionysodorus and Euthydemus, make sure you are speaking the truth. For when you are making such an enormous proclamation, don’t be surprised if it is disbelieved.” “Well, Socrates, you may rest assured that this is how matters stand.” “Then I account you far more blessed for this possession than the Great King for his empire. But tell me this. Are you thinking of giving a demonstration of this wisdom, or what do you intend?” “That’s the very reason we are here, Socrates, to give a demonstration and to teach, if anyone wishes to learn.”

ὦ Ζεῦ, οἶον, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, λέγετον πρᾶγμα· πόθεν τοῦτο τὸ ἔρμαιον ἠύρετην; ἐγὼ δὲ περὶ ὑμῶν διανοοῦμένην ἔτι, ὥσπερ νυνδὴ ἔλεγον, ὡς τὸ πολὺ τοῦτο δεινοῖν ὄντοιν, ἐν ὅπλοις μάχεσθαι, καὶ ταῦτα ἔλεγον περὶ σφῶν· ὅτε γὰρ τὸ πρότερον ἐπεδημησάτην, τοῦτο μέμνημαι σφῶν ἐπαγγελλομένω. Ω. εἰ δὲ νῦν ἀληθῶς ταύτην τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἔχετον, ἴλεω εἶτον—ἀτεχνῶς γὰρ ἔγωγε σφῶν ὥσπερ θεῶν προσαγορεύω, συγγνώμην δεόμενος ἔχειν μοι τῶν ἔμπροσθεν εἰρημένων. ἀλλ'

όρατον, ὦ Εὐθύδημέ τε καὶ Διονυσόδωρε, εἰ ἀληθῇ λέγετον· ὑπὸ γὰρ τοῦ μεγέθους τοῦ ἐπαγγέλματος οὐδὲν θαυμαστὸν ἀπιστεῖν. ἀλλ' εὖ ἴσθι, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφατον, τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχον. μακαρίζω ἄρ' ὑμᾶς ἔγωγε τοῦ κτήματος πολὺ μᾶλλον ἢ μέγαν βασιλέα τῆς ἀρχῆς· τοσόνδε δέ μοι εἶπετον, εἰ ἐν νῶ ἔχετον ἐπιδεικνύναι ταύτην τὴν σοφίαν, ἢ πῶς σφῶν βεβούλευται. ἐπ' αὐτό γε τοῦτο πάρεσμεν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς ἐπιδείζοντε καὶ διδάζοντε, ἐάν τις ἐθέλῃ μανθάνειν. ἀλλ' ὅτι μὲν ἐθελήσουσιν ἅπαντες οἱ μὴ ἔχοντες, ἐγὼ ὑμῖν ἐγγυῶμαι, πρῶτος μὲν ἐγώ, ἔπειτα δὲ Κλεινίας οὐτοσί, πρὸς δ' ἡμῖν Κτήσιππός τε ὅδε καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι οὗτοι, ἣν δ' ἐγὼ δεικνὺς αὐτῷ τοὺς ἐραστὰς τοὺς Κλεινίου· οἱ δὲ ἐτύγχανον ἡμᾶς ἤδη περιστάμενοι. ὁ γὰρ Κτήσιππος ἔτυχε πόρρω καθεζόμενος τοῦ Κλεινίου—κάμοι δοκεῖν ὡς ἐτύγχανεν ὁ Εὐθύδημος ἐμοὶ διαλεγόμενος προνευκῶς εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν,

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I asked them then to demonstrate – not a comprehensive one, but to convince this young man here, Clinias, that he should practise philosophy and concern himself with excellence, and I described the boy's situation: the son of Axiochus, first cousin of the present Alcibiades, young and at risk of being turned to some other pursuit. Now, once I had said almost exactly this, Euthydemus responded in a manner both courageous and confident. “That makes no difference, Socrates,” he said, “as long as the young man is willing to answer.” “Well,” I replied, “he certainly is well accustomed to this, for these people here are constantly coming to him, asking him lots of questions and engaging him in discourse, and so he is quite courageous at answering.”

ἐν μέσῳ ὄντος ἡμῶν τοῦ Κλεινίου ἐπεσκότει τῷ Κτησίππῳ τῆς θέας—βουλόμενός τε οὖν θεάσασθαι ὁ Κτήσιππος τὰ παιδικὰ καὶ ἅμα φιλήκοος ὢν ἀναπηδήσας πρῶτος προσέστη ἡμῖν ἐν τῷ καταντικρύ· οὕτως οὖν καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι ἐκεῖνον ἰδόντες περιέστησαν ἡμᾶς, οἳ τε τοῦ Κλεινίου ἐρασταὶ καὶ οἱ τοῦ Εὐθυδήμου τε καὶ Διονυσόδωρου ἐταῖροι. τούτους δὴ ἐγὼ δεικνὺς ἔλεγον τῷ Εὐθυδήμῳ ὅτι πάντες ἔτοιμοι εἶεν μανθάνειν· ὁ τε οὖν Κτήσιππος συνέφη μάλα προθύμως καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι, καὶ ἐκέλευον

αὐτῷ κοινῇ πάντες ἐπιδείξασθαι τὴν δύναμιν τῆς σοφίας. εἶπον οὖν ἐγώ· ὦ Εὐθύδημε καὶ Διονυσόδωρε, πάνυ μὲν οὖν παντὶ τρόπῳ καὶ τούτοις χαρίσασθον καὶ ἐμοῦ ἕνεκα ἐπιδείξασθον. τὰ μὲν οὖν πλεῖστα δηλὸν ὅτι οὐκ ὀλίγον ἔργον ἐπιδείξαι· τόδε δέ μοι εἶπετον, πότερον πεπεισμένον ἤδη ὡς χρή παρ' ὑμῶν μανθάνειν δύναισθ' ἂν ἀγαθὸν ποιῆσαι ἄνδρα μόνον, ἢ καὶ ἐκείνον τὸν μήπω πεπεισμένον διὰ τὸ μὴ οἶεσθαι ὅλως τὸ πρᾶγμα τὴν ἀρετὴν μαθητὸν εἶναι ἢ μὴ σφῶ εἶναι αὐτῆς διδασκάλῳ; φέρε, καὶ τὸν οὕτως ἔχοντα τῆς αὐτῆς τέχνης ἔργον πεῖσαι ὡς καὶ διδασκτὸν ἢ ἀρετὴ καὶ οὗτοι ὑμεῖς ἐστέ παρ' ὧν ἂν κάλλιστά τις αὐτὸ μάθοι, ἢ ἄλλης; ταύτης μὲν οὖν, ἔφη, τῆς αὐτῆς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁ Διονυσόδωρος. ΣΩ. ὑμεῖς ἄρα, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, τῶν νῦν ἀνθρώπων κάλλιστ' ἂν προτρέψαιτε εἰς φιλοσοφίαν καὶ ἀρετῆς ἐπιμέλειαν; οἴομεθά γε δή, ὦ Σώκρατες. τῶν μὲν τοίνυν ἄλλων τὴν ἐπίδειξιν ἡμῖν, ἔφην, εἰς αὐθις ἀπόθεσθον, τοῦτο δ' αὐτὸ ἐπιδείξασθον· τουτονὶ τὸν νεανίσκον πείσατον ὡς χρή φιλοσοφεῖν καὶ ἀρετῆς ἐπιμελεῖσθαι, καὶ χαριεῖσθον ἐμοί τε καὶ τουτοισὶ πᾶσιν. συμβέβηκεν γάρ τι τοιοῦτον τῷ μεираκίῳ τούτῳ· ἐγώ τε καὶ οἶδε πάντες τυγχάνομεν ἐπιθυμοῦντες ὡς βέλτιστον αὐτὸν γενέσθαι. ἔστι δὲ οὗτος Ἀξιόχου μὲν υἱὸς τοῦ Ἀλκιβιάδου τοῦ παλαιοῦ, αὐτανεψιὸς δὲ τοῦ νῦν ὄντος Ἀλκιβιάδου· ὄνομα δ' αὐτῷ Κλεινίας. ἔστι δὲ νέος· φοβούμεθα δὲ περὶ αὐτῷ, οἷον εἰκὸς περὶ νέῳ, μή τις φθῇ ἡμᾶς ἐπ' ἄλλο τι ἐπιτήδευμα τρέψας αὐτοῦ τὴν διάνοιαν καὶ διαφθείρῃ. σφῶ οὖν ἤκετον εἰς κάλλιστον· ἄλλ' εἰ μή τι διαφέρει ὑμῖν, λάβετον πεῖραν τοῦ μεираκίου καὶ διαλέχθητον ἐναντίον ἡμῶν. εἰπόντος οὖν ἐμοῦ σχεδὸν τι αὐτὰ ταῦτα ὁ Εὐθύδημος ἅμα ἀνδρείως τε καὶ θαρραλέως, ἀλλ' οὐδὲν διαφέρει, ὦ

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So Euthydemus began somewhat as follows. “Clinias, who are the people who learn? Are they the wise or the unlearned?” And the young man, faced with such a significant question, blushed and looked at me in perplexity. And once I realised that he had been upset, I said, “Take heart, Clinias. Answer courageously, giving whatever answer seems right to you, for this may well confer an enormous benefit upon you.”

At this, Dionysodorus leaned forward and whispered that whatever answer the young man gives, he will be refuted. And Clinias answered that those who learn are the wise. Then Euthydemus led him through a series of steps: when you were learning, you did not yet know the things you were learning? Then you were not wise, but unlearned? “Then whilst you were learning what you did not know, you were learning whilst being unlearned – it is the unlearned who learn, Clinias, and not, as you believe, the wise.” Now, once he had said all this, his followers laughed and cheered like a chorus at a signal from their teacher.

Σώκρατες, ἔφη, ἐὰν μόνον ἐθέλῃ ἀποκρίνεσθαι ὁ νεανίσκος. ἀλλὰ μὲν δὴ, ἔφην ἐγώ, τοῦτό γε καὶ εἴθισται· θαμὰ γὰρ αὐτῷ οἶδε προσιόντες πολλὰ ἐρωτῶσιν τε καὶ διαλέγονται, ὥστε ἐπεικῶς θαρρεῖ τὸ ἀποκρίνασθαι. τὰ δὴ μετὰ ταῦτα, ὦ Κρίτων, πῶς ἂν καλῶς σοι διηγησαίμην; οὐ γὰρ σμικρὸν τὸ ἔργον δύνασθαι ἀναλαβεῖν διεξιόντα σοφίαν ἀμήχανον ὅσην· ὥστ’ ἔγωγε, καθάπερ οἱ ποιηταί, δέομαι ἀρχόμενος τῆς διηγήσεως μούσας τε καὶ Μνημοσύνην ἐπικαλεῖσθαι. ἦρξατο δ’ οὖν ἐνθὲνδε ποθὲν ὁ Εὐθύδημος, ὡς ἐγῶμαι· ὦ Κλεινία, πότεροί εἰσι τῶν ἀνθρώπων οἱ μανθάνοντες, οἱ σοφοὶ ἢ οἱ ἀμαθεῖς; καὶ τὸ μειράκιον, ἅτε μεγάλου ὄντος τοῦ ἐρωτήματος, ἠρυθρίασέν τε καὶ ἀπορήσας ἐνέβλεψεν εἰς ἐμέ· καὶ ἐγὼ γνοὺς αὐτὸν τεθορυβημένον, θάρρει, ἦν δ’ ἐγώ, ὦ Κλεινία, καὶ ἀποκρίναι ἀνδρείως, ὁπότερά σοι φαίνεται· ἴσως γάρ τοι ὠφελεῖ τὴν μεγίστην ὠφελίαν. καὶ ἐν τούτῳ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος προσκύψας μοι μικρὸν πρὸς τὸ οὔ, πάνυ μειδιάσας τῷ προσώπῳ, καὶ μὴν, ἔφη, σοί, ὦ Σώκρατες, προλέγω ὅτι ὁπότερ’ ἂν ἀποκρίνηται τὸ μειράκιον, ἐξελεγχθήσεται. ΣΩ. καὶ αὐτοῦ μεταξὺ ταῦτα λέγοντος ὁ Κλεινίας ἔτυχεν ἀποκρινάμενος, ὥστε οὐδὲ παρακελεύεσθαι μοι ἐξεγένετο

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And before the youth had well and truly recovered, Dionysodorus took over. “What about this, Clinias? Whenever the grammarian gave dictation to you, which boys learned the dictation, the wise or the unlearned?” “The wise,” replied Clinias. “So it is the wise who learn,

not the unlearned, and you didn't answer Euthydemus properly just now." With this, the admirers of the two men laughed and cheered loudly in delight at their wisdom, while the rest of us were stunned and fell silent. And Euthydemus, in order to astound us even more, like one of those good dancers, gave a double twist to his questions on the same topic and asked, "Now, do those who learn, learn what they know or what they do not know?" And Dionysodorus whispered again, "And this, Socrates, will be another one, similar to the previous one."

εὐλαβηθῆναι τῷ μεираκίῳ, ἀλλ' ἀπεκρίνατο ὅτι οἱ σοφοὶ εἶεν οἱ μανθάνοντες. καὶ ὁ Εὐθύδημος, καλεῖς δέ τινας, ἔφη, διδασκάλους, ἢ οὐ;—ὠμολόγει.—οὐκοῦν τῶν μανθανόντων οἱ διδάσκαλοι διδάσκαλοί εἰσιν, ὥσπερ ὁ κιθαριστὴς καὶ ὁ γραμματιστὴς διδάσκαλοι δήπου ἦσαν σοῦ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων παίδων, ὑμεῖς δὲ μαθηταί;—συνέφη.—ἄλλο τι οὖν, ἡνίκα ἐμανθάνετε, οὐπω ἡπίστασθε ταῦτα ἃ ἐμανθάνετε;—οὐκ ἔφη.—ἄρ' οὖν σοφοὶ ἦτε, ὅτε ταῦτα οὐκ ἡπίστασθε;—οὐ δῆτα, ἦ δ' ὅς.—οὐκοῦν εἰ μὴ σοφοί, ἀμαθεῖς;—πάνυ γε.—ὑμεῖς ἄρα μανθάνοντες ἃ οὐκ ἡπίστασθε, ἀμαθεῖς ὄντες ἐμανθάνετε.—ἐπένευσεν τὸ μεираκίον.—οἱ ἀμαθεῖς ἄρα μανθάνουσιν, ὦ Κλεινία, ἀλλ' οὐχ οἱ σοφοί, ὥς σὺ οἶε. ταῦτ' οὖν εἰπόντος αὐτοῦ, ὥσπερ ὑπὸ διδασκάλου χορὸς ἀποσημήναντος, ἅμα ἀνεθορύβησάν τε καὶ ἐγέλασαν οἱ ἐπόμενοι ἐκεῖνοι μετὰ τοῦ Διονυσσοδώρου τε καὶ Εὐθυδήμου· καὶ πρὶν ἀναπνεῦσαι καλῶς τε καὶ εὖ τὸ μεираκίον, ἐκδεξάμενος ὁ Διονυσσόδωρος, τί δέ, ὦ Κλεινία, ἔφη, ὁπότε ἀποστοματίζοι ὑμῖν ὁ γραμματιστής, πότεροι ἐμάνθανον τῶν παίδων τὰ ἀποστοματιζόμενα, οἱ σοφοὶ ἢ οἱ ἀμαθεῖς;—οἱ σοφοί, ἔφη ὁ Κλεινίας.—οἱ σοφοὶ ἄρα μανθάνουσιν ἀλλ' οὐχ οἱ ἀμαθεῖς, καὶ οὐκ εὖ σὺ ἄρτι Εὐθυδήμῳ ἀπεκρίνω. ἐνταῦθα δὴ καὶ πάνυ μέγα ἐγέλασάν τε καὶ ἐθορύβησαν οἱ ἐρασταὶ τοῖν ἀνδροῖν, ἀγασθέντες τῆς σοφίας αὐτοῖν· οἱ δ' ἄλλοι ἡμεῖς ἐκπεπληγμένοι ἐσιωπῶμεν. γνοὺς δὲ ἡμᾶς ὁ Εὐθύδημος ἐκπεπληγμένους, ἴν' ἔτι μᾶλλον θαυμάζοιμεν αὐτόν, οὐκ ἀνίει τὸ μεираκίον, ἀλλ' ἡρώτα, καὶ ὥσπερ οἱ ἀγαθοὶ ὀρχησταί, διπλᾶ ἔστρεφε τὰ ἐρωτήματα περὶ τοῦ αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἔφη· πότερον γὰρ οἱ μανθάνοντες μανθάνουσιν ἃ ἐπίστανται ἢ ἃ μὴ ἐπίστανται; καὶ ὁ Διονυσσόδωρος πάλιν μικρὸν πρὸς με ψιθυρίσας, καὶ

τοῦτ', ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἕτερον τοιοῦτον οἶον τὸ πρότερον. ὦ Ζεῦ, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἥ μὴν καὶ τὸ πρότερόν γε καλὸν ἡμῖν ἐφάνη τὸ ἐρώτημα. πάντ', ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, τοιαῦτα ἡμεῖς ἐρωτῶμεν ἄφυστα. τοιγάρτοι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, δοκεῖτέ μοι εὐδοκιμεῖν παρὰ τοῖς μαθηταῖς. ΣΩ. ἐν δὲ τούτῳ ὁ μὲν Κλεινίας τῷ Εὐθυδήμῳ ἀπεκρίνατο ὅτι μανθάνοιεν οἱ μανθάνοντες ἅ οὐκ ἐπίσταιντο· ὁ δὲ ἤρετο

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He put Clinias through the letters argument – you know all your letters? Yes. When anyone dictates, doesn't he dictate letters? Yes. Doesn't he dictate something you know? Yes. Therefore you are learning what you know. So you did not answer correctly. Then Dionysodorus threw the argument back like a ball: learning is the acquisition of knowledge, while knowing is already having knowledge, so those who acquire are those who do not have – the unlearned learn, not those who know. Well, Euthydemus was rushing in to give the lad a fall for the third time when I realised the young man was going under. Wanting to give him some respite I said, by way of encouragement, “Clinias, do not be surprised if these arguments appear unfamiliar to you. They are doing the same thing as those who are involved in Corybantic initiation – they are now really just dancing around you and having fun with these dance moves. After this they will initiate you.”

αὐτὸν διὰ τῶν αὐτῶν ὥνπερ τὸ πρότερον· τί δέ; ἦ δ' ὅς, οὐκ ἐπίστασαι σὺ γράμματα;—ναί, ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν ἅπαντα;—ὡμολόγει.—ὅταν οὖν τις ἀποστοματίζει ὅτιοῦν, οὐ γράμματα ἀποστοματίζει;—ὡμολόγει.—οὐκοῦν ὧν τι σὺ ἐπίστασαι, ἔφη, ἀποστοματίζει, εἴπερ πάντα ἐπίστασαι;—καὶ τοῦτο ὡμολόγει.—τί οὖν; ἦ δ' ὅς, ἄρα σὺ οὐ μανθάνεις ἅττ' ἂν ἀποστοματίζει τις, ὁ δὲ μὴ ἐπιστάμενος γράμματα μανθάνει;—οὐκ, ἀλλ', ἦ δ' ὅς, μανθάνω.—οὐκοῦν ἅ ἐπίστασαι, ἦ δ' ὅς, μανθάνεις, εἴπερ γε ἅπαντα τὰ γράμματα ἐπίστασαι.—ὡμολόγησεν.—οὐκ ἄρα ὁρθῶς ἀπεκρίνω, ἔφη. καὶ οὕτω σφόδρα τι ταῦτα εἴρητο τῷ Εὐθυδήμῳ, καὶ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος ὥσπερ σφαῖραν ἐκδεξάμενος τὸν λόγον πάλιν ἐστοχάζετο τοῦ μειρακίου, καὶ εἶπεν· Ἐξαπατᾷ σε Εὐθύδημος, ὦ

Κλεινία. εἰπὲ γάρ μοι, τὸ μανθάνειν οὐκ ἐπιστήμην ἐστὶ λαμβάνειν τούτου οὗ ἂν τις μανθάνῃ;—ὡμολόγει ὁ Κλεινίας.—τὸ δ' ἐπίστασθαι, ἧ δ' ὅς, ἄλλο τι ἢ ἔχειν ἐπιστήμην ἥδη ἐστίν;—συνέφη.—τὸ ἄρα μὴ ἐπίστασθαι μήπω ἔχειν ἐπιστήμην ἐστίν;—ὡμολόγει αὐτῷ.—πότερον οὖν εἰσιν οἱ λαμβάνοντες ὅτιοῦν οἱ ἔχοντες ἥδη ἢ οἱ ἂν μὴ ἔχωσιν;—οἱ ἂν μὴ.—οὐκοῦν ὡμολόγηκας εἶναι τούτων καὶ τοὺς μὴ ἐπιστάμενους, τῶν μὴ ἐχόντων;—κατένευσε.—τῶν λαμβανόντων ἄρ' εἰσιν οἱ μανθάνοντες, ἀλλ' οὐ τῶν ἐχόντων;—συνέφη.—οἱ μὴ ἐπιστάμενοι ἄρα, ἔφη, μανθάνουσιν, ὧ Κλεινία, ἀλλ' οὐχ οἱ ἐπιστάμενοι. ἔτι δὲ ἐπὶ τὸ τρίτον καταβαλῶν ὥσπερ πάλαισμα ὥρμα ὁ Εὐθύδημος τὸν νεανίσκον· καὶ ἐγὼ γνοὺς βαπτιζόμενον τὸ μειράκιον, βουλόμενος ἀναπαῦσαι αὐτό, μὴ ἡμῖν ἀποδειλιάσειε, παραμυθούμενος εἶπον· ὧ Κλεινία, μὴ θαύμαζε εἴ σοι φαίνονται ἀήθεις οἱ λόγοι. ἴσως γὰρ οὐκ αἰσθάνῃ οἷον ποιεῖτον τῷ ξένῳ περὶ σέ· ποιεῖτον δὲ ταὐτὸν ὅπερ οἱ ἐν τῇ τελετῇ τῶν Κορυβάντων, ὅταν τὴν θρόνῳσιν ποιῶσιν περὶ τοῦτον ὃν ἂν μέλλωσι τελεῖν. καὶ γὰρ ἐκεῖ χορεία τίς ἐστὶ καὶ παιδιά, εἰ ἄρα καὶ τετέλεσαι· καὶ νῦν

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I explained to Clinias that this was the playfulness of their instructions: they were demonstrating that the same word 'learning' applies both to someone who initially has no knowledge but subsequently acquires some, and to someone who already has the knowledge and investigates further. These men were demonstrating that this fact had escaped his notice, that the same word is applied to people in opposite circumstances. "So, you should regard all of this as child's play on their part, after which they will of course demonstrate their serious work to you. So let that be the end of your game playing, Dionysodorus and Euthydemus, and that is probably enough. And so, after this you should give a demonstration in which you exhort the youth to devote himself to wisdom and excellence. But first I shall demonstrate to you both how I understand this, and the sort of thing I am eager to hear."

τούτω οὐδὲν ἄλλο ἢ χορεύετον περὶ σέ καὶ οἶον ὀρχεῖσθον παίζοντε, ὥς μετὰ τοῦτο τελοῦντε. νῦν οὖν νόμισον τὰ πρῶτα τῶν ἱερῶν ἀκούειν τῶν σοφιστικῶν. ΣΩ. πρῶτον γάρ, ὥς φησι Πρόδικος, περὶ ὀνομάτων ὀρθότητος μαθεῖν δεῖ· ὃ δὴ καὶ ἐνδείκνυσθόν σοι τῷ ξένῳ, ὅτι οὐκ ᾔδησθα τὸ μανθάνειν ὅτι οἱ ἄνθρωποι καλοῦσι μὲν ἐπὶ τῷ τοιῷδε, ὅταν τις ἐξ ἀρχῆς μηδεμίαν ἔχων ἐπιστήμην περὶ πράγματός τινος ἔπειτα ὕστερον αὐτοῦ λαμβάνῃ τὴν ἐπιστήμην, καλοῦσι δὲ ταῦτόν τοῦτο καὶ ἐπειδὴν ἔχων ἤδη τὴν ἐπιστήμην αὕτη τῇ ἐπιστήμῃ ταῦτόν τοῦτο πρᾶγμα ἐπισκοπῇ ἢ πραττόμενον ἢ λεγόμενον—μᾶλλον μὲν αὐτὸ συνιέναι καλοῦσιν ἢ μανθάνειν, ἔστι δ' ὅτε καὶ μανθάνειν—σέ δὲ τοῦτο, ὥς οὗτοι ἐνδείκνυνται, διαλέληθεν, ταῦτόν ὄνομα ἐπ' ἀνθρώποις ἐναντίως ἔχουσιν κείμενον, τῷ τε εἰδότι καὶ ἐπὶ τῷ μὴ παραπλήσιον δὲ τούτῳ καὶ τὸ ἐν τῷ δευτέρῳ ἐρωτήματι, ἐν ᾧ ἡρώτων σε πότερα μανθάνουσιν οἱ ἄνθρωποι ἢ ἐπίστανται ἢ ἢ μὴ. ταῦτα δὴ τῶν μαθημάτων παιδιὰ ἐστίν—διὸ καὶ φημι ἐγὼ σοι τούτους προσπαίξιν—παιδιὰν δὲ λέγω διὰ ταῦτα, ὅτι, εἰ καὶ πολλά τις ἢ καὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα μάθοι, τὰ μὲν πράγματα οὐδὲν ἂν μᾶλλον εἰδείῃ πῇ ἔχει, προσπαίξιν δὲ οἷός τ' ἂν εἴη τοῖς ἀνθρώποις διὰ τὴν τῶν ὀνομάτων διαφορὰν ὑποσκελίζων καὶ ἀνατρέπων, ὥσπερ οἱ τὰ σκολύθρια τῶν μελλόντων καθιζήσεσθαι ὑποσπῶντες χαίρουσι καὶ γελῶσιν, ἐπειδὴν ἴδωσιν ὑπτίον ἀνατετραμμένον. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν σοι παρὰ τούτων νόμιζε παιδιὰν γεγονέναι· τὸ δὲ μετὰ ταῦτα δῆλον ὅτι τούτῳ γέ σοι αὐτῷ τὰ σπουδαῖα ἐνδείξεσθον, καὶ ἐγὼ ὑφηγήσομαι αὐτοῖν ἵνα μοι ὃ ὑπέσχοντο ἀποδῶσιν. ἐφάτην γὰρ ἐπιδείξασθαι τὴν προτρεπτικὴν σοφίαν· νῦν δέ, μοι δοκεῖ, δεῖν ὠθητήτην πρότερον παῖσαι πρὸς σέ. ταῦτα μὲν οὖν, ὦ Εὐθύδημέ τε καὶ Διονυσόδωρε, πεπαίσθω τε ὑμῖν, καὶ ἴσως ἱκανῶς ἔχει· τὸ δὲ δὴ μετὰ ταῦτα ἐπιδείξατον προτρέποντε τὸ μειράκιον ὅπως χρὴ σοφίας τε καὶ ἀρετῆς ἐπιμεληθῆναι. πρότερον δ' ἐγὼ σφῶν ἐνδείξομαι οἶον αὐτὸ ὑπολαμβάνω καὶ οἷον αὐτοῦ ἐπιθυμῶ ἀκοῦσαι. ἐὰν οὖν δόξω ὑμῖν ἰδιωτικῶς τε καὶ γελοίως αὐτὸ ποιεῖν, μή μου καταγελαῖτε· ὑπὸ προθυμίας γὰρ τοῦ ἀκοῦσαι τῆς ὑμετέρας σοφίας τολμήσω ἀπαυτοσχεδιάσαι ἐναντίον

So I said, “Does every one of us wish to do well? Or is this question one of those that will provoke the laughter I was afraid of a moment ago? Yes, it is surely ridiculous even to ask such questions, for what man is there who does not wish to do well?” And Clinias agreed. “So be it. The next question is, since we wish to do well, how may we do well? Would it be by possessing much that is good? Come then, all things considered, what sort of things are good for us? Being wealthy, and being healthy too, and being handsome and endowed with the other bodily features?” He thought so too. “Then again, noble birth, power and esteem in your own city are obviously good.” He agreed. “And what about being sound-minded and just and courageous – are these good?” “They are good,” said Clinias. “And where shall we situate wisdom? With the good?” “With the good.”

ὕμῶν. ἀνάσχεσθον οὖν ἀγελαστὶ ἀκούοντες αὐτοῖ τε καὶ οἱ μαθηταὶ ὕμῶν· σὺ δέ μοι, ὦ παῖ Ἀξιόχου, ἀπόκριναι. ἄρά γε πάντες ἄνθρωποι βουλόμεθα εὖ πράττειν; ἢ τοῦτο μὲν ἐρώτημα ὧν νυνδὴ ἐφοβούμην ἐν τῶν καταγελάστων; ἀνόητον γὰρ δῆπου καὶ τὸ ἐρωτᾶν τὰ τοιαῦτα· τίς γὰρ οὐ βούλεται ἀνθρώπων εὖ πράττειν;— ΣΩ. οὐδεὶς ὅστις οὐκ, ἔφη ὁ Κλεινίας.—εἶεν, ἦν δ’ ἐγώ· τὸ δὴ μετὰ τοῦτο, ἐπειδὴ βουλόμεθα εὖ πράττειν, πῶς ἂν εὖ πράττοιμεν; ἄρ’ ἂν εἰ ἡμῖν πολλὰ κάγαθὰ εἴη; ἢ τοῦτο ἐκείνου ἔτι εὐηθέστερον; δῆλον γάρ που καὶ τοῦτο ὅτι οὕτως ἔχει.—συνέφη.—φέρει δὴ, ἀγαθὰ δὲ ποῖα ἄρα τῶν ὄντων τυγχάνει ἡμῖν ὄντα; ἢ οὐ χαλεπὸν οὐδὲ σεμνοῦ ἀνδρὸς πάνυ τι οὐδὲ τοῦτο ἔοικεν εἶναι εὐπορεῖν; πᾶς γὰρ ἂν ἡμῖν εἴποι ὅτι τὸ πλουτεῖν ἀγαθόν· ἢ γάρ;—πάνυ γ’, ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ὑγιαίνειν καὶ τὸ καλὸν εἶναι καὶ τᾶλλα κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἱκανῶς παρεσκευάσθαι;—συνεδόκει.—ἀλλὰ μὴν εὐγένειά γε καὶ δυνάμεις καὶ τιμαὶ ἐν τῇ ἑαυτοῦ δῆλὰ ἐστὶν ἀγαθὰ ὄντα.—ὠμολόγει.—τί οὖν, ἔφη, ἔτι ἡμῖν λείπεται τῶν ἀγαθῶν; τί ἄρα ἐστὶν τὸ σῶφρονά τε εἶναι καὶ δίκαιον καὶ ἀνδρεῖον; πότερον πρὸς Διός, ὦ Κλεινίας, ἡγῇ σύ, ἐὰν ταῦτα τιθῶμεν ὡς ἀγαθὰ, ὀρθῶς ἡμᾶς θήσιν, ἢ ἐὰν μή; ἴσως γὰρ ἂν τις ἡμῖν ἀμφισβητήσῃ· σοὶ δὲ πῶς δοκεῖ;—ἀγαθὰ, ἔφη ὁ Κλεινίας.—

I then said we were in danger of omitting good fortune, which everyone agrees is the most important good of all – but then I changed my mind: “Surely wisdom is good fortune. Yes, a child would realise this.” I asked whether the flute players are the most fortunate when it comes to flute music, the writing teachers when it comes to letters, the wise pilot on the sea, the wise general in battle, the wise doctor when ill? In every case, Clinias agreed, wisdom brings good fortune, for wisdom would not ever fall into error. Rather, it must act aright and succeed, or else no longer be wisdom. In the end we both agreed, I know not how, that once wisdom is present, he to whom it is present needs no additional good fortune.

εἶεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ· τὴν δὲ σοφίαν ποῦ χοροῦ τάξομεν; ἐν τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς, ἢ πῶς λέγεις;—ἐν τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς.—ἐνθυμοῦ δὴ μή τι παραλείπωμεν τῶν ἀγαθῶν, ὅτι καὶ ἄξιον λόγου.—ἀλλὰ μοι δοκοῦμεν, ἔφη, οὐδέν, ὁ Κλεινίας.—καὶ ἐγὼ ἀναμνησθεῖς εἶπον ὅτι ναὶ μὰ Δία κινδυνεύομέν γε τὸ μέγιστον τῶν ἀγαθῶν παραλιπεῖν.—τί τοῦτο; ἦ δ' ὅς.—τὴν εὐτυχίαν, ᾧ Κλεινία ὁ πάντες φασί, καὶ οἱ πάνυ φαῦλοι, μέγιστον τῶν ἀγαθῶν εἶναι.—ἀληθῆ λέγεις, ἔφη.—καὶ ἐγὼ αὖ πάλιν μετανοήσας εἶπον ὅτι ὀλίγου καταγέλαστοι ἐγενόμεθα ὑπὸ τῶν ξένων ἐγώ τε καὶ σύ, ᾧ παῖ Ἀξιόχου.—τί δὴ, ἔφη, τοῦτο;—ὅτι εὐτυχίαν ἐν τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν θέμενοι νυνδὴ αὖθις περὶ τοῦ αὐτοῦ ἐλέγομεν.—τί οὖν δὴ τοῦτο;—καταγέλαστον δήπου, ὃ πάλαι πρόκειται, τοῦτο πάλιν προτιθέναι καὶ δις ταῦτά λέγειν.—πῶς, ἔφη, τοῦτο λέγεις;—ἡ σοφία δήπου, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, εὐτυχία ἐστίν· τοῦτο δὲ κἂν παῖς γνοίῃ.—καὶ ὅς ἐθαύμασεν· οὕτως ἔτι νέος τε καὶ εὐήθης ἐστί.—κἀγὼ γνοὺς αὐτὸν θαυμάζοντα, ἄρα οὐκ οἶσθα, ἔφη, ᾧ Κλεινία, ὅτι περὶ ἀνλημάτων εὐπραγίαν οἱ ἀνληταὶ εὐτυχέστατοί εἰσιν;—συνέφη.—οὐκοῦν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ περὶ γραμμάτων γραφῆς τε καὶ ἀναγνώσεως οἱ γραμματισταί;—πάνυ γε.—τί δέ; πρὸς τοὺς τῆς θαλάττης κινδύνους μὲν οἷε εὐτυχεστέρους τινὰς εἶναι τῶν σοφῶν κυβερνητῶν, ὡς ἐπὶ πᾶν εἰπεῖν;—οὐ δῆτα. ΣΩ. τί δέ; στρατεύομενος μετὰ ποτέρου ἂν ἥδιον τοῦ κινδύνου τε καὶ τῆς τύχης μετέχοις, μετὰ σοφοῦ στρατηγοῦ ἢ μετὰ ἀμαθοῦς;—μετὰ σοφοῦ.—τί δέ; ἀσθενῶν μετὰ ποτέρου ἂν ἡδέως κινδυνεύοις, μετὰ σοφοῦ ἱατροῦ ἢ

μετὰ ἀμαθοῦς;—μετὰ σοφοῦ.—ἄρ' οὖν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὅτι εὐτυχέστερον ἂν οἶι πράττειν μετὰ σοφοῦ πράττων ἢ μετὰ ἀμαθοῦς;—συνεχώνει.—ἡ σοφία ἄρα πανταχοῦ εὐτυχεῖν ποιεῖ τοὺς ἀνθρώπους. οὐ γὰρ δήπου ἀμαρτάνοι γ' ἂν ποτέ τι σοφία, ἀλλ' ἀνάγκη ὀρθῶς πράττειν καὶ τυγχάνειν· ἢ γὰρ ἂν οὐκέτι σοφία εἴη.

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I then took up the argument about using good things correctly. If we had a lot of food but did not eat, we would not be benefited. If each of the craftsmen had all the equipment appropriate to his own work but did not make use of it, they would not do well because of the acquisition alone. “So it seems that someone who is going to be happy must not merely acquire such goods as these, but must also make use of them, or else no benefit arises from their acquisition.” Clinias agreed. “If he uses them correctly or if he does not?” “If he uses them correctly.” And was it knowledge that guided the right usage of everything – wealth, health, beauty? “It was knowledge,” said he. “So, in the case of any acquisition or any activity, knowledge not only provides people with good fortune, but also it ensures they do well.”

συνωμολογησάμεθα τελευτῶντες οὐκ οἶδ' ὅπως ἐν κεφαλαίῳ οὕτω τοῦτο ἔχειν, σοφίας παρούσης, ᾧ ἂν παρῇ, μηδὲν προσδεῖσθαι εὐτυχίας· ἐπειδὴ δὲ τοῦτο συνωμολογησάμεθα, πάλιν ἐπυνθανόμην αὐτοῦ τὰ πρότερον ὡμολογημένα πῶς ἂν ἡμῖν ἔχοι. ὡμολογήσαμεν γάρ, ἔφην, εἰ ἡμῖν ἀγαθὰ πολλὰ παρείη, εὐδαιμονεῖν ἂν καὶ εὖ πράττειν.—συνέφη.—ἄρ' οὖν εὐδαιμονοῖμεν ἂν διὰ τὰ παρόντα ἀγαθὰ, εἰ μηδὲν ἡμᾶς ὠφελοῖ ἢ εἰ ὠφελοῖ;—εἰ ὠφελοῖ, ἔφη.—ἄρ' οὖν ἂν τι ὠφελοῖ, εἰ εἴη μόνον ἡμῖν, χρώμεθα δ' αὐτοῖς μή; οἷον σιτία εἰ ἡμῖν εἴη πολλά, ἐσθίοιμεν δὲ μή, ἢ ποτόν, πίνοιμεν δὲ μή, ἔσθ' ὅτι ὠφελοίμεθ' ἂν;—οὐ δῆτα, ἔφη.—τί δέ; οἱ δημιουργοὶ πάντες, εἰ αὐτοῖς εἴη πάντα τὰ ἐπιτήδεια παρεσκευασμένα ἐκάστω εἰς τὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἔργον, χρῶντο δὲ αὐτοῖς μή, ἄρ' ἂν οὗτοι εὖ πράττοιεν διὰ τὴν κτῆσιν, ὅτι κεκτημένοι εἴεν πάντα ἃ δεῖ κεκτηθῆναι τὸν δημιουργόν; οἷον τέκτων, εἰ παρεσκευασμένος εἴη τὰ τε ὄργανα ἅπαντα καὶ ξύλα ἱκανά, τεκταίνοιτο δὲ μή, ἔσθ' ὅτι ὠφελοῖτ' ἂν ἀπὸ τῆς κτήσεως;—οὐδαμῶς, ἔφη.—τί δέ, εἴ τις κεκτημένος εἴη πλοῦτόν τε καὶ ἃ

νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν πάντα τὰ ἀγαθὰ, χρῶτο δὲ αὐτοῖς μή, ἄρ' ἂν εὐδαιμονοῖ διὰ τὴν τούτων κτήσιν τῶν ἀγαθῶν;—οὐ δῆτα, ὦ Σώκρατες.—δεῖ ἄρα, ἔφην, ὡς ἔοικεν, μὴ μόνον κεκτηθῆσαι τὰ τοιαῦτα ἀγαθὰ τὸν μέλλοντα εὐδαίμονα ἔσεσθαι, ἀλλὰ καὶ χρῆσθαι αὐτοῖς· ἢ οὐδὲν ὄφελος τῆς κτήσεως γίγνεται.—ἀληθῆ λέγεις.—ἄρ' οὖν, ὦ Κλεινία, ἤδη τοῦτο ἱκανὸν πρὸς τὸ εὐδαίμονα ποιῆσαι τινα, τό τε κεκτηθῆσαι τὰγαθὰ καὶ τὸ χρῆσθαι αὐτοῖς;—ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ.—πότερον, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἐὰν ὀρθῶς χρῆται τις ἢ καὶ ἐὰν μή;—ἐὰν ὀρθῶς. ΣΩ. καλῶς γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, λέγεις. πλέον γάρ που οἶμαι θάτερόν ἐστιν, ἐάν τις χρῆται ὅτω οὖν μὴ ὀρθῶς πράγματι ἢ ἐὰν ἔξ· τὸ μὲν γὰρ κακόν, τὸ δὲ οὔτε

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I pressed on: would a person derive more benefit if he acquired a lot and did a lot without possessing intelligence, or if he acquired little and did little, while possessing intelligence? If he did less, wouldn't he make fewer errors, and wouldn't he be less wretched? "Entirely so." Who is inclined to do less – someone rich or poor? "Someone poor." Someone strong or weak? "Someone weak." Someone courageous and sound-minded or a coward? "A coward." And a lazy person, someone slow, dull of sight and hearing? We agreed with one another on all such examples. "To sum up, Clinias, in the case of everything we initially declared to be good, the argument is not about how they are naturally good just by themselves. If ignorance rules, then they are more bad than their opposites; but if understanding and wisdom rule, they are more good, yet just by themselves neither of them is of any value."

κακὸν οὔτε ἀγαθόν. ἢ οὐχ οὕτω φαμέν;—συνεχώρει.—τί οὖν; ἐν τῇ ἐργασίᾳ τε καὶ χρήσει τῇ περὶ τὰ ξύλα μὴ ἄλλο τί ἐστιν τὸ ἀπεργαζόμενον ὀρθῶς χρῆσθαι ἢ ἐπιστήμη ἢ τεκτονική;—οὐ δῆτα, ἔφην.—ἀλλὰ μὴν που καὶ ἐν τῇ περὶ τὰ σκευὴ ἐργασίᾳ τὸ ὀρθῶς ἐπιστήμη ἐστὶν ἢ ἀπεργαζομένη.—συνέφη.—ἄρ' οὖν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ περὶ τὴν χρεῖαν ὧν ἐλέγομεν τὸ πρῶτον τῶν ἀγαθῶν, πλούτου τε καὶ ὑγιείας καὶ κάλλους, τὸ ὀρθῶς πᾶσι τοῖς τοιοῦτοις χρῆσθαι ἐπιστήμη ἢν ἡγουμένη καὶ κατορθοῦσα τὴν πράξιν, ἢ ἄλλο τι;—ἐπιστήμη, ἢ δ' ὅς.—οὐ

μόνον ἄρα εὐτυχίαν ἀλλὰ καὶ εὐπραγίαν, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἡ ἐπιστήμη παρέχει τοῖς ἀνθρώποις ἐν πάσῃ κτήσει τε καὶ πράξει.—ὠμολόγει.—ἄρ' οὖν ὦ πρὸς Διός, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὄφελός τι τῶν ἄλλων κτημάτων ἄνευ φρονήσεως καὶ σοφίας; ἄρά γε ἂν ὄναιτο ἄνθρωπος πολλὰ κεκτημένος καὶ πολλὰ πράττων νοῦν μὴ ἔχων, ἢ μᾶλλον ὀλίγα νοῦν ἔχων; ὧδε δὲ σκοπεῖ οὐκ ἐλάττω πράττων ἐλάττω ἂν ἐξαμαρτάνοι, ἐλάττω δὲ ἀμαρτάνων ἦττον ἂν κακῶς πράττοι, ἦττον δὲ κακῶς πράττων ἄθλιος ἦττον ἂν εἴη;—πάνυ γ', ἔφη.—πότερον οὖν ἂν μᾶλλον ἐλάττω τις πράττοι πένης ὢν ἢ πλούσιος;—πένης, ἔφη.—πότερον δὲ ἀσθενὴς ἢ ἰσχυρός;—ἀσθενής.—πότερον δὲ ἔντιμος ἢ ἄτιμος;—ἄτιμος.—πότερον δὲ ἀνδρεῖος ὢν καὶ σώφρων ἐλάττω ἂν πράττοι ἢ δειλός;—δειλός.—οὐκοῦν καὶ ἀργός μᾶλλον ἢ ἐργάτης;—συνεχώρει.—καὶ βραδὺς μᾶλλον ἢ ταχύς, καὶ ἀμβλὺ ὀρῶν καὶ ἀκούων μᾶλλον ἢ ὀξύ;—πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα συνεχωροῦμεν ἀλλήλοις.—ἐν κεφαλαίῳ δ', ἔφην, ὦ Κλεινία, κινδυνεύει σύμπαντα ἃ τὸ πρῶτον ἔφαμεν ἀγαθὰ εἶναι, οὐ περὶ τούτου ὁ λόγος αὐτοῖς εἶναι, ὅπως αὐτὰ γε καθ' αὐτὰ πέφυκεν ἀγαθὰ εἶναι, ἀλλ' ὡς ἔοικεν ὧδ' ἔχει· ἐὰν μὲν αὐτῶν ἡγήται ἀμαθία, μείζω κακὰ εἶναι τῶν ἐναντίων, ὅσῳ δυνατώτερα ὑπηρετεῖν τῷ ἡγουμένῳ κακῶ ὄντι, ἐὰν δὲ φρονήσῃς τε καὶ σοφία, μείζω ἀγαθὰ, αὐτὰ δὲ καθ'

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I concluded: "Since we are all eager to be happy, and since it turns out that we become like this through using things, and using them correctly, and since knowledge provides the correctness and good fortune, then every man should, it seems, contrive by every possible means to become as wise as possible. And surely if someone believes he should acquire this from his father, from his guardians too, and from his other friends, begging and imploring them to grant him wisdom is no disgrace, Clinias. Nor is there cause for indignation in being a servant or slave to a lover or any person for the sake of this, in being willing to render any noble services out of his eagerness to become wise." "I really think you have spoken rather well," said he.

αὐτὰ οὐδέτερα αὐτῶν οὐδενὸς ἄξια εἶναι.—φαίνεται, ἔφη, ὡς ἔοικεν, οὕτως, ὡς σὺ λέγεις.—τί οὖν ἡμῖν συμβαίνει ἐκ τῶν εἰρημένων; ἄλλο τι

ἢ τῶν μὲν ἄλλων οὐδὲν ὄν οὔτε ἀγαθὸν οὔτε κακόν, τούτοις δὲ δυοῖν ὄντοιν ἢ μὲν σοφία ἀγαθόν, ἢ δὲ ἀμαθία κακόν;—ὡμολόγει. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν, ἔφη, τὸ λοιπὸν ἐπισκεψώμεθα. ἐπειδὴ εὐδαίμονες μὲν εἶναι προθυμούμεθα πάντες, ἐφάνημεν δὲ τοιοῦτοι γιγνόμενοι ἐκ τοῦ χρησθῆναι τε τοῖς πράγμασιν καὶ ὀρθῶς χρῆσθαι, τὴν δὲ ὀρθότητα καὶ εὐτυχίαν ἐπιστήμη ἦν ἡ παρέχουσα, δεῖ δὴ, ὥς ἔοικεν, ἐκ παντὸς τρόπου ἅπαντα ἄνδρα τοῦτο παρασκευάζεσθαι, ὅπως ὥς σοφώτατος ἔσται ἢ οὐ;—ναί, ἔφη.—καὶ παρὰ πατρός γε δήπου τοῦτο οἰόμενον δεῖν παραλαμβάνειν πολὺ μᾶλλον ἢ χρήματα, καὶ παρ' ἐπιτρόπων καὶ φίλων τῶν τε ἄλλων καὶ τῶν φασκόντων ἐραστῶν εἶναι, καὶ ξένων καὶ πολιτῶν, δεόμενον καὶ ἰκετεύοντα σοφίας μεταδιδόναι, οὐδὲν αἰσχρόν, ὦ Κλεινία, οὐδὲ νεμεσητὸν ἔνεκα τούτου ὑπηρετεῖν καὶ δουλεύειν καὶ ἐραστῇ καὶ παντὶ ἀνθρώπῳ, ὅτιοῦν ἐθέλοντα ὑπηρετεῖν τῶν καλῶν ὑπηρετημάτων, προθυμούμενον σοφὸν γενέσθαι· ἢ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι, ἔφη, ἐγώ, οὕτως;—πάννυ μὲν οὖν εὖ μοι δοκεῖς

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I was delighted that Clinias agreed wisdom can be taught and I said, “Best of men, it is good that you say so, and you have done well, by saving me from a lengthy consideration of this very question, whether wisdom can or cannot be taught. So now, since you think both that it can be taught, and that it is the only thing there is that makes a person happy and fortunate, would you say anything else is needed, apart from the practice of philosophy? And is this what you yourself intend to do?” “Yes certainly, Socrates,” he replied, “to the best of my ability.” I was pleased to hear this, and I said, “Dionysodorus and Euthydemus, this is my own example – perhaps amateurish, laborious and a bit too long – of what I want an exhortatory argument to be like. Now, one of you, whoever wishes, should give a demonstration of the same thing, done skilfully. For it is of great importance to us that this youth become wise and good.”

λέγειν, ἢ δ' ὅς.—εἰ ἔστι γε, ὦ Κλεινία, ἢν δ' ἐγώ, ἡ σοφία διδακτόν, ἀλλὰ μὴ ἀπὸ ταῦτομάτου παραγίνεται τοῖς ἀνθρώποις· τοῦτο γὰρ ἡμῖν ἔτι ἄσχεπτον καὶ οὕτω διωμολογημένον ἐμοί τε καὶ σοί.—ἀλλ' ἔμοιγε, ἔφη,

ὦ Σώκρατες, διδασκτὸν εἶναι δοκεῖ.—καὶ ἐγὼ ἡσθεῖς εἶπον· ἢ καλῶς λέγεις, ὦ ἄριστε ἀνδρῶν, καὶ εὖ ἐποίησας ἀπαλλάξας με σκέψεως πολλῆς περὶ τούτου αὐτοῦ, πότερον διδασκτὸν ἢ οὐ διδασκτὸν ἢ σοφία. νῦν οὖν ἐπειδὴ σοι καὶ διδασκτὸν δοκεῖ καὶ μόνον τῶν ὄντων εὐδαίμονα καὶ εὐτυχῇ ποιεῖν τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἄλλο τι ἢ φαίης ἂν ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι φιλοσοφεῖν καὶ αὐτὸς ἐν νῶ ἔχεις αὐτὸ ποιεῖν;—πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς οἶόν τε μάλιστα. καὶ γὰρ ταῦτα ἄσμενος ἀκούσας, τὸ μὲν ἐμόν, ἔφην, παράδειγμα, ὦ Διονυσόδωρέ τε καὶ Εὐθύδημε, οἷων ἐπιθυμῶ τῶν προτρεπτικῶν λόγων εἶναι, τοιοῦτον, ἰδιωτικὸν ἴσως καὶ μόλις διὰ μακρῶν λεγόμενον· σφῶν δὲ ὁπότερος βούλεται, ταῦτόν τοῦτο τέχνη πράττων ἐπιδειξάτω ἡμῖν. εἰ δὲ μὴ τοῦτο βούλεσθον, ὅθεν ἐγὼ ἀπέλιπον, τὸ ἐξῆς ἐπιδείξατον τῷ μεираκίῳ, πότερον πᾶσαν ἐπιστήμην δεῖ αὐτὸν κτᾶσθαι, ἢ ἔστι τις μία ἣν δεῖ λαβόντα εὐδαιμονεῖν τε καὶ ἀγαθὸν ἄνδρα εἶναι, καὶ τίς αὕτη. ὡς γὰρ ἔλεγον ἀρχόμενος, περὶ πολλοῦ ἡμῖν τυγχάνει ὃν τόνδε τὸν νεανίσκον σοφόν τε καὶ ἀγαθὸν γενέσθαι.

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Now, Crito, that is what I said, and I paid very close attention to what was to happen next. Dionysodorus, the elder of the two, was first to set about the argument. “Tell me, Socrates,” said he, “and you others who say you want this youth to become wise. Are you joking when you say this, or are you serious, and do you truly want this?” So, with this in mind, I emphasised that we were extremely serious. And Dionysodorus said, “Well, think about this, Socrates, in case you end up denying what you are now saying.” “I have thought about it,” said I, “and I shall never end up denying it.” “Well then,” said he, “are you saying that you want him to become wise?” “Yes, we certainly are.” “And at the moment, is Clinias wise or not?” “He is not boastful,” said I, “and he does not yet make this claim.” “But,” said he, “you want him to become what he is not, and no longer be what he now is.”

ΣΩ. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν ταῦτα εἶπον, ὦ Κρίτων· τῷ δὲ μετὰ τοῦτο ἐσομένῳ πάνυ σφόδρα προσεῖχον τὸν νοῦν, καὶ ἐπεσκόπουν τίνα ποτὲ τρόπον ἄψοιντο τοῦ λόγου καὶ ὁπόθεν ἄρξοιντο παρακελευόμενοι τῷ

νεανίσκῳ σοφίαν τε καὶ ἀρετὴν ἀσκεῖν. ὁ οὖν πρεσβύτερος αὐτῶν, ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, πρότερος ἤρχετο τοῦ λόγου, καὶ ἡμεῖς πάντες ἐβλέπομεν πρὸς αὐτὸν ὡς αὐτίκα μάλα ἀκουσόμενοι θαυμασίους τινὰς λόγους. ὅπερ

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When I heard this I was confused, and he seized upon my confused state and said, “Since you want him no longer to be what he now is, it seems you just want him to be dead. Yes, friends and lovers like these would be worth a lot, friends who would do anything to destroy their favourite.” When Ctesippus heard this, he was angry on behalf of his favourite and said, “Stranger from Thurii, if it were not such a crude expression, I would say ‘be it on your head’ for presuming to hold such a false notion of myself and the others, and one which in my view it is most unholy to express, that I would like this fellow to be utterly destroyed.” “What’s this, Ctesippus?” said Euthydemus. “Do you think it is possible to speak falsely?” “Yes, by Zeus,” he replied. “I would be mad not to.”

οὖν καὶ συνέβη ἡμῖν· θαυμαστὸν γάρ τινα, ὃ Κρίτων, ἀνὴρ κατῆρχεν λόγον, οὗ σοὶ ἄξιον ἀκοῦσαι, ὡς παρακελευστικὸς ὁ λόγος ἦν ἐπ’ ἀρετῇ. εἰπέ μοι, ἔφη, ὃ Σώκρατες τε καὶ ὑμεῖς οἱ ἄλλοι, ὅσοι φατὲ ἐπιθυμεῖν τόνδε τὸν νεανίσκον σοφὸν γενέσθαι, πότερον παίζετε ταῦτα λέγοντες ἢ ὡς ἀληθῶς ἐπιθυμεῖτε καὶ σπουδάζετε; καὶ γὰρ διενοήθη ὅτι ψηθήτην ἄρα ἡμᾶς τὸ πρότερον παίζειν, ἡνίκα ἐκελεύομεν διαλεχθῆναι τῷ νεανίσκῳ αὐτῷ, καὶ διὰ ταῦτα προσεπαισάτην τε καὶ οὐκ ἐσπουδασάτην·

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Euthydemus then trapped Ctesippus: when one is speaking of a matter, does he not speak of something that is? And what he speaks of is one of the things that are? So if Dionysodorus is speaking of things that are, he is speaking the truth and is saying nothing false about you. Ctesippus retorted that Dionysodorus was speaking of things that are, but not as they actually are. “What do you mean?” said Dionysodorus. “Are there some people who speak of things as they are?” “There are,

indeed,” he replied, “the noble and good, and those who speak the truth.” “What about this? What’s good is well disposed, and what’s bad badly so. Is this the case?” He concurred. “And you agree that the noble and good people speak of things as they are.” “I agree.” “So good people speak badly of anything bad, Ctesippus,” he said, “if they actually speak of it as it is?” This led to banter about speaking ‘greatly’ of the great and ‘warmly’ of the warm, and Dionysodorus accusing Ctesippus of being ‘abusive’.

ταῦτα οὖν διανοηθεὶς ἔτι μᾶλλον εἶπον ὅτι θαυμαστῶς σπουδάζοιμεν. καὶ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, σκόπει μὴν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅπως μὴ ἔξαρνος ἔσῃ ἃ νῦν λέγεις.—ἔσκεμμαι, ἦν δ’ ἐγώ· οὐ γὰρ μή ποτ’ ἔξαρνος γένωμαι.—τί οὖν; ἔφη· φατὲ βούλεσθαι αὐτὸν σοφὸν γενέσθαι;—πάνυ μὲν οὖν.—νῦν δέ, ἦ δ’ ὅς, Κλεινίας πότερον σοφός ἐστιν ἢ οὐ;—οὐκ οὐν φησί γέ πω· ἔστιν δέ, ἦν δ’ ἐγώ, οὐκ ἀλαζών.—ὕμεις δέ, ἔφη, βούλεσθε γενέσθαι αὐτὸν σοφόν, ἀμαθῆ δὲ μὴ εἶναι;—ὡμολογοῦμεν.—οὐκοῦν ὃς μὲν οὐκ ἔστιν, βούλεσθε αὐτὸν γενέσθαι, ὃς δ’ ἔστι νῦν, μηκέτι εἶναι.—καὶ ἐγὼ ἀκούσας ἐθορυβήθην· ὁ δέ μουθορυβουμένου ὑπολαβὼν, ἄλλο τι οὖν, ἔφη, ἐπεὶ βούλεσθε αὐτὸν ὃς νῦν ἐστὶν μηκέτι εἶναι, βούλεσθε αὐτόν, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἀπολωλέναι; καίτοι πολλοὺ ἂν ἄξιοι οἱ τοιοῦτοι εἶεν φίλοι τε καὶ ἔρασταί, οἵτινες τὰ παιδικὰ περὶ παντὸς ἂν ποιήσαιτο ἐξολωλέναι. καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος ἀκούσας ἠγανάκτησέν τε ὑπὲρ τῶν παιδικῶν καὶ εἶπεν· ὦ ξένη Θούριε, εἰ μὴ ἀγροικότερον, ἔφη, ἦν εἰπεῖν, εἶπον ἅν· σοὶ εἰς κεφαλὴν, ὅτι μαθὼν μου καὶ τῶν ἄλλων καταψεύδη τοιοῦτον πρᾶγμα, ὃ ἐγὼ οἶμαι οὐδ’ ὅσιον εἶναι λέγειν, ὡς ἐγὼ τόνδε βουλοίμην ἂν ἐξολωλέναι. ΣΩ. τί δέ, ἔφη, ὦ Κτήσιππε, ὁ Εὐθύδημος, ἦ δοκεῖ σοι οἷόν τ’ εἶναι ψεύδεσθαι;—νὴ Δία, ἔφη, εἰ μὴ μαίνομαι γε.—πότερον λέγοντα τὸ πρᾶγμα περὶ οὗ ἂν ὁ λόγος ἦ, ἢ μὴ λέγοντα;—λέγοντα, ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν εἴπερ λέγει αὐτό, οὐκ ἄλλο λέγει τῶν ὄντων ἢ ἐκεῖνο ὅπερ λέγει;—πῶς γὰρ ἅν; ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—ἔν μὴν κἀκεῖνο γ’ ἐστὶν τῶν ὄντων, ὃ λέγει, χωρὶς τῶν ἄλλων.—πάνυ γε.—οὐκοῦν ὁ ἐκεῖνο λέγων τὸ ὄν, ἔφη, λέγει;—ναί.—ἀλλὰ μὴν ὃ γε τὸ ὄν λέγων καὶ τὰ ὄντα τάληθῃ λέγει· ὥστε ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, εἴπερ λέγει τὰ ὄντα, λέγει τάληθῃ καὶ οὐδὲν κατὰ σοῦ ψεύδεται. ναί, ἔφη· ἀλλ’ ὁ ταῦτα λέγων, ἔφη

ὁ Κτήσιππος, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, οὐ τὰ ὄντα λέγει. καὶ ὁ Εὐθύδημος, τὰ δὲ μὴ ὄντα, ἔφη, ἄλλο τι ἢ οὐκ ἔστιν;—οὐκ ἔστιν.—ἄλλο τι οὖν οὐδαμοῦ τά γε μὴ ὄντα ὄντα ἐστίν;—οὐδαμοῦ.—ἔστιν οὖν ὅπως περὶ ταῦτα, τὰ μὴ ὄντα, πράξειεν ἂν τίς τι, ὥστ' ἐκεῖνα ποιήσειεν ἂν καὶ ὅστισοῦν τὰ μηδαμοῦ ὄντα;—οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—τί οὖν; οἱ ῥήτορες ὅταν λέγωσιν ἐν τῷ δήμῳ, οὐδὲν πράττουσι;—πράττουσι μὲν οὖν, ἦ δ' ὅς.—οὐκοῦν

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Since I thought they were being aggressive towards one another, I made light of it with Ctesippus, and said, “Ctesippus, if they are prepared to be generous, I think we should accept anything the strangers say, and not quarrel over a word. For if they know how to destroy people in such a way as to make worthy and intelligent folk out of those who are degenerate and stupid – if they know this, then let us make this concession to them. Let them destroy the lad for us and make him intelligent, and all the rest of us too. But if you younger folk are afraid, then let the danger fall upon me, as if they were practising on some slave. Since I am quite old, I am willing to run the risk and give myself over to Dionysodorus here as if he were Medea of Colchis. Let him destroy me, and if he wants to, let him boil me or do whatever he wants. Just let him bring me forth a worthy man.”

εἴπερ πράττουσι, καὶ ποιοῦσι;—ναί.—τὸ λέγειν ἄρα πράττειν τε καὶ ποιεῖν ἐστίν;—ὠμολόγησεν.—οὐκ ἄρα τά γε μὴ ὄντ', ἔφη, λέγει οὐδεὶς—ποιοῖ γὰρ ἂν ἤδη τί· σὺ δὲ ὠμολόγηκας τὸ μὴ ὄν μὴ οἶόν τ' εἶναι μηδένα ποιεῖν— ὥστε κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον οὐδεὶς ψευδῇ λέγει, ἀλλ' εἴπερ λέγει Διονυσόδωρος, τάληθ' ἔφη τε καὶ τὰ ὄντα λέγει. νῆ Δία, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος, ὦ Εὐθύδημε· ἀλλὰ τὰ ὄντα μὲν τρόπον τινὰ λέγει, οὐ μέντοι ὥς γε ἔχει. πῶς λέγεις, ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, ὦ Κτήσιππε; εἰσὶν γὰρ τινες οἱ λέγουσι τὰ πράγματα ὥς ἔχει;—εἰσὶν μέντοι, ἔφη, οἱ καλοὶ τε κάγαθοι καὶ οἱ τάληθ' ἐλγόντες.—τί οὖν; ἦ δ' ὅς· τάγαθὰ οὐκ εὔ, ἔφη, ἔχει, τὰ δὲ κακὰ κακῶς;—συνεχώρει.—τοὺς δὲ καλοὺς τε καὶ ἀγαθοὺς ὁμολογεῖς λέγειν ὥς ἔχει τὰ πράγματα;—ὁμολογῶ.—κακῶς ἄρα, ἔφη, λέγουσιν, ὦ Κτήσιππε, οἱ ἀγαθοὶ τὰ κακά, εἴπερ ὥς ἔχει λέγουσιν.—ναὶ μὰ Δία, ἦ δ'

ὅς, σφόδρα γε, τοὺς γοῦν κακοὺς ἀνθρώπους· ὧν σύ, ἔάν μοι πείθῃ, εὐλαβήσῃ εἶναι, ἵνα μὴ σε οἱ ἀγαθοὶ κακῶς λέγωσιν. ὡς εὖ ἴσθ' ὅτι κακῶς λέγουσιν οἱ ἀγαθοὶ τοὺς κακοὺς.—καὶ τοὺς μεγάλους, ἔφη ὁ Εὐθύδημος, μεγάλως λέγουσι καὶ τοὺς θερμοὺς θερμῶς;—μάλιστα δήπου, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος· τοὺς γοῦν ψυχροὺς ψυχρῶς λέγουσί τε καὶ φασὶν διαλέγεσθαι.—σὺ μὲν, ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, λοιδορῇ, ὧ Κτήσιππε, λοιδορῇ. ΣΩ. μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε, ἡ δ' ὅς, ὧ Διονυσόδωρε, ἐπεὶ φιλῶ σε, ἀλλὰ νουθετῶ σε ὡς ἐταῖρον, καὶ πειρῶμαι πείθειν μηδέποτε ἐναντίον ἐμοῦ οὕτως ἀγροίκως λέγειν ὅτι ἐγὼ τούτους βούλομαι ἐξολωλέναι, οὓς περὶ πλείστου ποιοῦμαι. ἐγὼ οὖν, ἐπειδὴ μοι ἐδόκουν ἀγριωτέρως πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἔχειν, προσέπαιζόν τε τὸν Κτήσιππον καὶ εἶπον ὅτι ὧ Κτήσιππε, ἐμοὶ μὲν δοκεῖ χρῆναι ἡμᾶς παρὰ τῶν ξένων δέχεσθαι ἃ λέγουσιν, ἐὰν ἐθέλωσι διδόναι, καὶ μὴ ὀνόματι διαφέρεισθαι. εἰ γὰρ ἐπίστανται οὕτως ἐξολλύναι ἀνθρώπους, ὥστ' ἐκ πονηρῶν τε καὶ ἀφρόνων χρηστοὺς τε καὶ ἔμφρονας ποιεῖν, καὶ τοῦτο εἴτε αὐτῷ ἡρῆκατον εἴτε καὶ παρ' ἄλλου του ἐμαθέτην φθόρον τινὰ καὶ ὄλεθρον τοιοῦτον, ὥστε ἀπολέσαντες πονηρὸν ὄντα χρηστὸν πάλιν ἀποφῆναι· εἰ τοῦτο ἐπίστασθον—δῆλον δὲ ὅτι ἐπίστασθον· ἐφάτην γοῦν τὴν τέχνην σφῶν εἶναι τὴν νεωστὶ ἡρῆμένην ἀγαθοὺς ποιεῖν τοὺς ἀνθρώπους ἐκ πονηρῶν—συγχωρήσωμεν οὖν αὐτοῖν αὐτό· ἀπολεσάντων ἡμῖν τὸ μειράκιον καὶ φρόνιμον ποιησάντων, καὶ ἅπαντάς γε ἡμᾶς τοὺς ἄλλους. εἰ δὲ ὑμεῖς οἱ νέοι φοβεῖσθε, ὥσπερ ἐν Καρὶ ἐν ἐμοὶ ἔστω ὁ κίνδυνος· ὡς ἐγώ, ἐπειδὴ καὶ πρεσβύτης εἰμί, παρακινδυνεύειν ἕτοιμος καὶ παραδίδωμι ἐμαυτὸν Διονυσοδώρῳ τούτῳ ὥσπερ τῇ Μηδείᾳ τῇ Κόλχῳ. ἀπολλύτω με, καὶ εἰ μὲν βούλεται, ἐψέτω, εἰ δ', ὅτι βούλεται, τοῦτο ποιεῖτω· μόνον χρηστὸν ἀποφηνάτω. καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος, ἐγὼ μὲν, ἔφη, καὶ αὐτός, ὧ Σώκρατες, ἕτοιμός εἰμι παρέχειν ἐμαυτὸν τοῖς ξένοις, καὶ ἐὰν βούλωνται δέρειν ἔτι μᾶλλον ἢ νῦν δέρουσιν, εἴ μοι ἡ δορὰ μὴ εἰς

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Then the argument shifted to whether contradiction is possible. Dionysodorus said one could not even prove that one person had ever contradicted another. Ctesippus said he was hearing himself, Ctesippus, contradicting Dionysodorus right now. Dionysodorus pressed: are

there accounts of each of the things that are? And do they not give an account of each as it is? But if both speakers give an account of the same thing, they say the same things – they don't contradict. If neither speaks of the thing, neither mentions it. And if I speak of the thing but you speak of something else, then I'm speaking of it while you are not – but how could someone who does not speak of it contradict someone who does? Ctesippus fell silent, while I was amazed at the argument and said it always seemed to me to simply say there is no false speaking, and to ask whether there is false thinking. "There is no false thinking either," he replied. "So there is no ignorance either, nor any ignorant people?"

ἀσκὸν τελευτήσῃ, ὥσπερ ἢ τοῦ Μαρσύου, ἀλλ' εἰς ἀρετήν. καίτοι με οἶται Διονυσόδωρος οὕτοσι χαλεπαίνειν αὐτῷ· ἐγὼ δὲ οὐ χαλεπαίνω, ἀλλ' ἀντιλέγω πρὸς ταῦτα ἃ μοι δοκεῖ πρὸς με μὴ καλῶς λέγειν. ἀλλὰ σὺ τὸ ἀντιλέγειν, ἔφη, ὦ γενναῖε Διονυσόδωρε, μὴ κάλει λοιδορεῖσθαι· ἕτερον γάρ τί ἐστι τὸ λοιδορεῖσθαι. καὶ Διονυσόδωρος, ὡς ὄντος, ἔφη, τοῦ ἀντιλέγειν, ὦ Κτήσιππε, ποιῇ τοὺς λόγους; πάντως δήπου, ἔφη, καὶ σφόδρα γε· ἢ σύ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, οὐκ οἶε εἶναι ἀντιλέγειν; οὐκ οὐν σύ γ' ἂν, ἔφη, ἀποδείξαις πώποτε ἀκούσας οὐδενὸς ἀντιλέγοντος ἑτέρου ἑτέρῳ. ἀληθῇ λέγεις; ἔφη ἀλλὰ ἀκούων μὲν νυνὶ σοὶ ἀποδείκνυμι ἀντιλέγοντος Κτησίππου Διονυσόδωρῳ. ἢ καὶ ὑπόσχοις ἂν τούτου λόγον; πάνυ, ἔφη. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἢ δ' ὅς· εἰσὶν ἐκάστῳ τῶν ὄντων λόγοι;—πάνυ γε.—οὐκοῦν ὡς ἔστιν ἕκαστον ἢ ὡς οὐκ ἔστιν; ὡς ἔστιν.—εἰ γὰρ μέμνησαι, ἔφη, ὦ Κτήσιππε, καὶ ἄρτι ἐπεδείξαμεν μηδὲνα λέγοντα ὡς οὐκ ἔστι· τὸ γὰρ μὴ ὄν οὐδεὶς ἐφάνη λέγων.—τί οὖν δὴ τοῦτο; ἢ δ' ὅς ὁ Κτήσιππος· ἡττόν τι ἀντιλέγομεν ἐγὼ τε καὶ σύ;—πότερον οὖν, ἢ δ' ὅς, ἀντιλέγοιμεν ἂν τοῦ αὐτοῦ πράγματος λόγον ἀμφοτέροι λέγοντες, ἢ οὕτω μὲν ἂν δήπου ταῦτα λέγοιμεν;—συνεχῶρει.—ἀλλ' ὅταν μηδέτερος, ἔφη, τὸν τοῦ πράγματος λόγον λέγῃ, τότε ἀντιλέγοιμεν ἂν; ἢ οὕτω γε τὸ παράπαν οὐδ' ἂν μεμνημένος εἴη τοῦ πράγματος οὐδέτερος ἡμῶν;—καὶ τοῦτο συνωμολόγει.—ἀλλ' ἄρα, ὅταν ἐγὼ μὲν τὸν τοῦ πράγματος λόγον λέγω, σὺ δὲ ἄλλου τινὸς ἄλλον, τότε ἀντιλέγομεν; ἢ ἐγὼ λέγω μὲν τὸ πρᾶγμα, σὺ δὲ οὐδὲ λέγεις τὸ παράπαν;

ὁ δὲ μὴ λέγων τῷ λέγοντι πῶς ἂν ἀντιλέγοι; καὶ ὁ μὲν Κτήσιππος ἐσίγησεν· ἐγὼ δὲ θαυμάσας τὸν λόγον, πῶς, ἔφην, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, λέγεις; οὐ γάρ τοι ἀλλὰ τοῦτόν γε τὸν λόγον πολλῶν δὴ καὶ πολλάκις ἀκηκοὺς ἀεὶ θαυμάζω—καὶ γὰρ οἱ ἀμφὶ Πρωταγόραν σφόδρα ἐχρῶντο αὐτῷ καὶ οἱ ἔτι παλαιότεροι· ἐμοὶ δὲ ἀεὶ θαυμαστός τις δοκεῖ εἶναι καὶ τοὺς τε ἄλλους ἀνατρέπων καὶ αὐτὸς αὐτόν —οἶμαι δὲ αὐτοῦ τὴν ἀλήθειαν παρὰ σοῦ κάλλιστα πεύσεσθαι. ἄλλο τι ψευδῇ λέγειν οὐκ ἔστιν; —τοῦτο γὰρ δύναται ὁ λόγος· ἢ γάρ; —ἀλλ’ ἢ λέγοντ’ ἀληθῆ λέγειν ἢ μὴ λέγειν; συνεχώρει. πότερον οὖν ψευδῇ μὲν λέγειν οὐκ ἔστι, δοξάζειν μέντοι ἔστιν; οὐδὲ δοξάζειν, ἔφη. οὐδ’ ἄρα ψευδῆς, ἣν δ’ ἐγώ, δόξα ἔστι τὸ παράπαν. οὐκ ἔφη. οὐδ’ ἄρα ἀμαθία οὐδ’ ἀμαθεὶς ἀνθρωποι· ἢ οὐ τοῦτ’ ἂν εἴη ἀμαθία, εἴπερ εἴη, τὸ ψεύδεσθαι τῶν πραγμάτων; πάνυ γε, ἔφη. ἀλλὰ τοῦτο οὐκ ἔστιν, ἣν δ’ ἐγώ. οὐκ ἔφη. λόγου ἕνεκα, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, λέγεις τὸν λόγον, ἵνα δὴ ἄτοπον λέγῃς, ἢ ὡς ἀληθῶς δοκεῖ σοι οὐδεὶς εἶναι ἀμαθὴς ἀνθρώπων;

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I asked directly: “Dionysodorus, are you presenting this argument for the sake of discussion, in order to say something unusual, or do you think in truth that there is no such thing as an ignorant person?” “You should try to refute me,” said he. “And based upon your argument, is there refutation when no one speaks falsely?” “There is not,” said Euthydemus. “Then Dionysodorus did not encourage me to refute him just now?” said I. “Indeed, how could someone encourage what is not?” I pressed on: if it is impossible to be in error either when acting, speaking or thinking, what have the two of you come here to teach? Or did you not claim earlier that you are the best people to impart excellence to someone who wishes to learn it? Dionysodorus dismissed this as old Cronus-talk, reminding me of what was said last year and refusing to deal with what was being said at the moment.

ἀλλὰ σύ, ἔφη, ἔλεγχον. ἢ καὶ ἔστι τοῦτο κατὰ τὸν σὸν λόγον, ἐξελέγξαι, μηδενὸς ψευδομένου; οὐκ ἔστιν, ἔφη ὁ Εὐθύδημος. οὐδ’ ἄρα ἐκέλευεν, ἔφην ἐγώ, νυνδὴ Διονυσόδωρος ἐξελέγξαι; τὸ γὰρ μὴ ὄν πῶς ἂν τις κελεύσαι; σὺ δὲ κελεύεις; ὅτι, ἣν δ’ ἐγώ, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, τὰ σοφὰ ταῦτα καὶ

τὰ εὖ ἔχοντα οὐ πάνυ τι μανθάνω, ἀλλὰ παχέως πως ἐννοῶ. ἴσως μὲν οὖν φορτικώτερόν τι ἐρήσομαι, ἀλλὰ συγγίγνωσκε. ΣΩ. ὅρα δέ· εἰ γὰρ μήτε ψεύδεσθαι ἔστιν μήτε ψευδῇ δοξάζειν μήτε ἀμαθῇ εἶναι, ἄλλο τι οὐδ' ἐξαμαρτάνειν ἔστιν, ὅταν τίς τι πράττη; πράττοντα γὰρ οὐκ ἔστιν ἀμαρτάνειν τούτου ὃ πράττει· οὐχ οὕτω λέγετε; πάνυ γ', ἔφη. τοῦτό ἐστιν ἥδη, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, τὸ φορτικὸν ἐρώτημα. εἰ γὰρ μὴ ἀμαρτάνομεν μήτε πράττοντες μήτε λέγοντες μήτε διανοούμενοι, ὑμεῖς, ὦ πρὸς Διός, εἰ ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχει, τίνος διδάσκαλοι ἦκατε; ἢ οὐκ ἄρτι ἔφατε ἀρετὴν κάλλιστ' ἂν παραδοῦναι ἀνθρώπων τῷ ἐθέλοντι μανθάνειν; εἴτ', ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁ Διονυσόδωρος ὑπολαβὼν, οὕτως εἶ Κρόνος, ὥστε ἂν τὸ πρῶτον εἴπομεν νῦν ἀναμνησκήσῃ, καὶ εἰ τι πέρυσιν εἶπον, νῦν ἀναμνησθήσῃ, τοῖς δ' ἐν τῷ παρόντι λεγομένοις οὐχ ἔξεις ὅτι χρῆ; καὶ γάρ, ἔφην ἐγώ, χαλεποὶ εἰσιν πάνυ—εἰκότως· παρὰ σοφῶν γὰρ λέγονται—ἐπεὶ καὶ τούτῳ τῷ τελευταίῳ παγχάλεπον χρήσασθαι ἔστιν, ὧ λέγεις. τὸ γὰρ οὐκ ἔχω ὅτι χρωμαί τί ποτε λέγεις, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε; ἢ δῆλον ὅτι ὥς οὐκ ἔχω ἐξελέγξαι αὐτόν; ἐπεὶ εἶπέ, τί σοι ἄλλο νοεῖ τοῦτο τὸ ῥῆμα, τὸ οὐκ ἔχω ὅτι χρήσωμαι τοῖς λόγοις; ἀλλ' ὃ σὺ λέγεις, ἔφη, τούτῳ τῷ πάνυ χαλεπὸν χρῆσθαι· ἐπεὶ ἀποκρίναι. πρὶν σὲ ἀποκρίνασθαι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε; οὐκ ἀποκρίνῃ; ἔφη. ἦ καὶ δίκαιον; δίκαιον μέντοι, ἔφη. κατὰ τίνα λόγον; ἦν δ' ἐγώ· ἢ δῆλον ὅτι κατὰ τόνδε, ὅτι σὺ νῦν πάσσοφός τις ἡμῖν ἀφῖξαι περὶ λόγους, καὶ οἶσθα ὅτε δεῖ ἀποκρίνασθαι καὶ ὅτε μή; καὶ νῦν οὐδ' ἂν ὀτιοῦν ἀποκρίνῃ, ἅτε γιγνώσκων ὅτι οὐ δεῖ; λαλεῖς, ἔφη, ἀμελήσας ἀποκρίνασθαι· ἀλλ', ὠγαθέ, πείθου καὶ ἀποκρίνου, ἐπειδὴ καὶ ὁμολογεῖς με σοφὸν εἶναι. πειστέον τοίνυν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ ἀνάγκη, ὥς ἔοικεν· σὺ γὰρ ἄρχεις. ἀλλ' ἐρώτα. πότερον οὖν ψυχὴν ἔχοντα νοεῖ τὰ νοοῦντα, ἢ καὶ τὰ ἄψυχα; τὰ ψυχὴν ἔχοντα. οἶσθα οὖν τι, ἔφη, ῥῆμα ψυχὴν ἔχον; μὰ Δία οὐκ ἔγωγε.

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After much back-and-forth, in which Euthydemus tried to trap me into saying I know by my soul and I always know, I resolved to get back to the exhortatory purpose and said, “Clinias, you should remind me where we left off. As I recall it was around the stage where we agreed, in the end, that one should practise philosophy.” “Yes,” he replied. “And

philosophy is the acquisition of knowledge. Isn't this the case?" "Yes." "Now, would it be of any benefit to us if, as we went about, we knew how to recognise where most gold is buried beneath the earth?" "Probably," he replied. "But we refuted this suggestion earlier," said I, "because we would be no better off even if all the earth's gold were to be ours without any trouble, or any need to dig. And so even if we knew how to turn stones into gold, the knowledge would be of no value, for if we did not also know how to use the gold, there turned out to be no benefit in it. Don't you remember?" "Entirely so," he replied.

τί οὖν ἄρτι ἤρου ὅτι μοι νοοῖ τὸ ῥῆμα; τί ἄλλο γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἢ ἐξήμαρτον διὰ τὴν βλακείαν; ἢ οὐκ ἐξήμαρτον ἀλλὰ καὶ τοῦτο ὀρθῶς εἶπον, εἰπὼν ὅτι νοεῖ τὰ ῥήματα; πότερα φῆς ἐξαμαρτάνειν με ἢ οὐ; ΣΩ. εἰ γὰρ μὴ ἐξήμαρτον, οὐδὲ σὺ ἐξελέγξεις, καίπερ σοφὸς ὢν, οὐδ' ἔχεις ὅτι χρῆ τῷ λόγῳ· εἰ δ' ἐξήμαρτον, οὐδ' οὕτως ὀρθῶς λέγεις, φάσκων οὐκ εἶναι ἐξαμαρτάνειν. καὶ ταῦτα οὐ πρὸς ἃ πέρυσιν ἔλεγες λέγω. ἀλλὰ ἔοικεν, ἔφην ἐγώ, ὧ Διονυσόδωρ τε καὶ Εὐθύδημε, οὗτος μὲν ὁ λόγος ἐν ταύτῳ μένειν καὶ ἔτι ὥσπερ τὸ παλαιὸν καταβαλὼν πίπτειν, καὶ ὥστε τοῦτο μὴ πάσχειν οὐδ' ὑπὸ τῆς ὑμετέρας πω τέχνης ἐξηρησθαι, καὶ ταῦτα οὕτως θυμαστικῆς οὔσης εἰς ἀκρίβειαν λόγων. καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος, θαυμάσιά γε λέγετ', ἔφη, ὧ ἄνδρες θούριοι εἵτε Χῖοι εἴθ' ὀπόθεν καὶ ὅπη χαίρετον ὀνομαζόμενοι· ὥς οὐδὲν ὑμῖν μέλει τοῦ παραληρεῖν. καὶ ἐγὼ φοβηθεὶς μὴ λαιδορία γένηται, πάλιν κατεπράυνον τὸν Κτήσιππον καὶ εἶπον· ὧ Κτήσιππε, καὶ νυνδὴ ἃ πρὸς Κλεινίαν ἔλεγον, καὶ πρὸς σὲ ταῦτα ταῦτα λέγω, ὅτι οὐ γινώσκεις τῶν ξένων τὴν σοφίαν ὅτι θαυμάσιά ἐστίν. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐθέλετον ἡμῖν ἐπιδείξασθαι σπουδάζοντε, ἀλλὰ τὸν Πρωτέα μιμεῖσθον τὸν Αἰγύπτιον σοφιστὴν γοητεύοντε ἡμᾶς. ἡμεῖς οὖν τὸν Μενέλαον μιμώμεθα, καὶ μὴ ἀφιώμεθα τοῖν ἀνδροῖν ἕως ἄν ἡμῖν ἐκφανῇτον ἐφ' ᾧ αὐτῷ σπουδάζετον· οἶμαι γάρ τι αὐτοῖν πάγκαλον φανεῖσθαι, ἐπειδὰν ἄρξωνται σπουδάζειν. ἀλλὰ δεώμεθα καὶ παραμυθώμεθα καὶ προσευχώμεθα αὐτοῖν ἐκφανῆναι. ἐγὼ οὖν μοι δοκῶ καὶ αὐτὸς πάλιν ὑψηλῆσθαι οἷω προσεύχομαι αὐτῷ φανῆναί μοι· ὅθεν γὰρ τὸ πρότερον ἀπέλιπον, τὸ ἐξῆς τούτοις πειράσομαι, ὅπως ἂν δύνωμαι, διελθεῖν, ἐάν πως ἐκκαλέσωμαι καὶ ἐλεήσαντέ με καὶ

οἰκτίραντε συντεταμένον καὶ σπουδάζοντα καὶ αὐτῷ σπουδάσητον. σὺ δέ, ὦ Κλεινία, ἔφην, ἀνάμνησόν με πόθεν τότ' ἀπελίπομεν. ὥς μὲν οὖν ἐγὼμαι, ἐνθένδε ποθέν. φιλοσοφητέον ὡμολογήσαμεν τελευτώντας· ἧ γάρ;—ναί, ἧ δ' ὅς.—ἡ δέ γε φιλοσοφία κτήσις ἐπιστήμης· οὐχ οὕτως; ἔφην.—ναί, ἔφην.—τίνα ποτ' οὖν ἂν κτησάμενοι ἐπιστήμην ὀρθῶς κησαίμεθα; ἄρ' οὐ τοῦτο μὲν ἀπλοῦν, ὅτι ταύτην ἥτις ἡμᾶς ὀνήσει;—πάνυ γ', ἔφην.—ἄρ' οὖν ἂν τι ἡμᾶς ὀνήσειεν, εἰ ἐπισταίμεθα γινώσκειν περιόντες ὅπου τῆς γῆς χρυσίον πλεῖστον κατορώρυκται;—ἴσως, ἔφην. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τὸ πρότερον, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, τοῦτό γε ἐξηλέγξαμεν, ὅτι οὐδὲν πλεόν, οὐδ' εἰ ἄνευ πραγμάτων καὶ τοῦ ὀρύττειν τὴν γῆν τὸ πᾶν ἡμῖν χρυσίον γένοιτο· ὥστε οὐδ' εἰ τὰς πέτρας χρυσᾶς ἐπισταίμεθα

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So what is needed is a knowledge in which the production, and knowing how to use what is produced, reside together. We do not need to be lyre makers, for the productive skill is one thing while the user's skill is another. The same holds for flute-making. I asked about the speech-writer's skill, and Clinias objected: "I notice that some speechwriters do not know how to deliver their own speeches, the ones they have composed, just as the lyre makers are unable to play the lyres – the skill of producing speeches is distinct from the skill of using them." I thought that you are giving sufficient evidence that the skill of the speech-makers is not the one whose acquisition would result in happiness. Indeed, this skill is a portion of the enchanters' skill, but a little inferior thereto. For the skill of the enchanters consists in charming snakes and wild creatures generally, while the speech-makers' skill involves charming and persuading jurors, assembly members, and large gatherings in general.

ποιεῖν, οὐδενὸς ἂν ἀξία ἡ ἐπιστήμη εἴη. εἰ γὰρ μὴ καὶ χρῆσθαι ἐπιστησόμεθα τῷ χρυσίῳ, οὐδὲν ὄφελος αὐτοῦ ἐφάνη ὄν· ἧ οὐ μέμνησαι; ἔφην ἐγώ.—πάνυ γ', ἔφην, μέμνημαι.—οὐδέ γε, ὥς ἔοικε, τῆς ἄλλης ἐπιστήμης ὄφελος γίγνεται οὐδέν, οὔτε χρηματιστικῆς οὔτε ἰατρικῆς οὔτε ἄλλης οὐδεμιᾶς, ἥτις ποιεῖν τι ἐπίσταται, χρῆσθαι δὲ μὴ ᾧ ἂν ποιήσῃ οὐχ οὕτως;—συνέφην.—οὐδέ γε εἴ τις ἔστιν ἐπιστήμη ὥστε

ἀθανάτους ποιεῖν, ἄνευ τοῦ ἐπίστασθαι τῇ ἀθανασίᾳ χρῆσθαι οὐδὲ ταύτης ἔοικεν ὄφελος οὐδέν, εἴ τι δεῖ τοῖς πρόσθεν ὠμολογημένοις τεκμαίρεσθαι.—συνεδόκει ἡμῖν πάντα ταῦτα.—τοιαύτης τινὸς ἄρα ἡμῖν ἐπιστήμης δεῖ, ὧ καλὲ παῖ, ἣν δ' ἐγώ, ἐν ἧ συμπέπτωκεν ἅμα τό τε ποιεῖν καὶ τὸ ἐπίστασθαι χρῆσθαι τούτῳ ὃ ἂν ποιῇ.—φαίνεται, ἔφη.—πολλοῦ ἄρα δεῖ, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἡμᾶς λυροποιούς δεῖν εἶναι καὶ τοιαύτης τινὸς ἐπιστήμης ἐπηβόλους. ἐνταῦθα γὰρ δὴ χωρὶς μὲν ἡ ποιοῦσα τέχνη, χωρὶς δὲ ἡ χρωμένη διήρηται τοῦ αὐτοῦ πέρι· ἡ γὰρ λυροποιικὴ καὶ ἡ κιθαριστικὴ πολὺ διαφέρειτον ἀλλήλοιν. οὐχ οὕτως;—συνέφη.—οὐδὲ μὴν αὐλοποιικῆς γε δῆλον ὅτι δεόμεθα· καὶ γὰρ αὕτη ἑτέρα τοιαύτη.—συνεδόκει.—ἀλλὰ πρὸς θεῶν, ἔφην ἐγώ, εἰ τὴν λογοποιικὴν τέχνην μάθοιμεν, ἄρ' ἐστὶν αὕτη ἣν ἔδει κεκτημένους ἡμᾶς εὐδαίμονας εἶναι;—οὐκ οἶμαι, ἔφη, ἐγώ, ὁ Κλεινίας ὑπολαβών. τίني τεκμηρίῳ, ἣν δ' ἐγώ, χρῇ; ὁρῶ, ἔφη, τινὰς λογοποιούς, οἱ τοῖς ἰδίῳι λόγοις, οἷς αὐτοὶ ποιοῦσιν, οὐκ ἐπίστανται χρῆσθαι, ὥσπερ οἱ λυροποιοὶ ταῖς λύραις, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐνταῦθα ἄλλοι δυνατοὶ χρῆσθαι οἷς ἐκεῖνοι ἡργάσαντο, οἱ λογοποιεῖν αὐτοὶ ἀδύνατοι· δῆλον οὖν ὅτι καὶ περὶ λόγους χωρὶς ἡ τοῦ ποιεῖν τέχνη καὶ ἡ τοῦ χρῆσθαι. ἱκανόν μοι δοκεῖς, ἔφην ἐγώ, τεκμήριον λέγειν, ὅτι οὐχ αὕτη ἐστὶν ἡ τῶν λογοποιῶν τέχνη, ἣν ἂν κτησάμενός τις εὐδαίμων εἴη. καίτοι ἐγὼ ὥμην ἐνταῦθά που φανήσεσθαι τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἣν δὴ πάλαι ζητοῦμεν. καὶ γὰρ μοι οἱ τε ἄνδρες αὐτοὶ οἱ λογοποιοί, ὅταν συγγένωμαι αὐτοῖς, ὑπέρσοφοι, ὧ Κλεινία, δοκοῦσιν εἶναι, καὶ αὐτὴ ἡ τέχνη αὐτῶν θεσπεσία τις καὶ ὑψηλὴ. καὶ μέντοι οὐδὲν θαυμαστόν· ἔστι γὰρ τῆς τῶν ἐπωδῶν τέχνης μόνιον μικρῷ τε ἐκείνης ὑποδεεστέρα.

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I suggested the skill of the general next, but Clinias said, “This is, in a sense, a skill in hunting down human beings. Nothing in the actual skill of hunting goes any further than hunting down and subduing, and whenever hunters subdue whatever they are hunting, they are not able to make use of it. Instead the hunters hand it over to the cooks. The same goes for geometers, astronomers and calculators, since they too are hunters. They do not produce their own diagrams; instead,

they make discoveries. And since they themselves do not know how to make use of them, but only how to hunt them down, they hand over, of course, to the dialecticians. And the same goes for the generals: whenever they capture some city or army, they hand it over to the statesmen. So if we need a particular skill which also knows how to make use of that which it acquires, then we must search for something else rather than the skill of the general.”

ΣΩ. ἡ μὲν γὰρ τῶν ἐπωδῶν ἔχεών τε καὶ φαλαγγίων καὶ σκορπίων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων θηρίων τε καὶ νόσων κήλησίς ἐστιν, ἡ δὲ δικαστῶν τε καὶ ἐκκλησιαστῶν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ὄχλων κήλησίς τε καὶ παραμυθία τυγχάνει οὕσα ἢ σοί, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἄλλως πως δοκεῖ; οὐκ, ἀλλ’ οὕτω μοι φαίνεται, ἔφη, ὡς σὺ λέγεις. ποῖ οὖν, ἔφην ἐγώ, τραποίμεθ’ ἂν ἔτι; ἐπὶ ποίαν τέχνην; ἐγὼ μὲν οὐκ εὐπορῶ, ἔφη. ἀλλ’, ἦν δ’ ἐγώ, ἐμὲ οἶμαι ἠύρηκέναι. τίνα; ἔφη ὁ Κλεινίας. ἡ στρατηγική μοι δοκεῖ, ἔφην ἐγώ, τέχνη παντὸς μᾶλλον εἶναι ἢν ἂν τις κτησάμενος εὐδαίμων εἴη. οὐκ ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ. πῶς; ἦν δ’ ἐγώ. θηρευτική τις ἦδε γέ ἐστιν τέχνη ἀνθρώπων. τί δὴ οὖν; ἔφην ἐγώ. οὐδεμία, ἔφη, τῆς θηρευτικῆς αὐτῆς ἐπὶ πλεον ἐστὶν ἢ ὅσον θηρεῦσαι καὶ χειρώσασθαι· ἐπειδὰν δὲ χειρώσωνται τοῦτο ὃ ἂν θηρεύωνται, οὐ δύνανται τούτῳ χρῆσθαι, ἀλλ’ οἱ μὲν κυνηγέται καὶ οἱ ἀλιῆς τοῖς ὀψοποιοῖς παραδιδόασιν, οἱ

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CR: What are you saying, Socrates? Did that young man make a pronouncement of that sort?

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S: Don’t you believe it, Crito?

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CR: By Zeus, I don’t. In fact, if he said all that, I think he needs neither Euthydemus nor anyone else to educate him.

δ’ αὖ γεωμέτραι καὶ οἱ ἀστρονόμοι καὶ οἱ λογιστικοί—θηρευτικοὶ γάρ εἰσι καὶ οὗτοι· οὐ γὰρ ποιοῦσι τὰ διαγράμματα ἕκαστοι τούτων, ἀλλὰ τὰ ὄντα ἀνευρίσκουσιν—ἅτε οὖν χρῆσθαι αὐτοὶ αὐτοῖς οὐκ ἐπιστάμενοι, ἀλλὰ θηρεῦσαι μόνον, παραδιδόασι δήπου τοῖς διαλεκτικοῖς

καταχρησθαι αὐτῶν τοῖς εὐρήμασιν, ὅσοι γε αὐτῶν μὴ παντάπασιν ἀνόητοί εἰσιν. εἶεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ κάλλιστε καὶ σοφώτατε Κλεινία· τοῦτο οὕτως ἔχει· πάνυ μὲν οὖν. καὶ οἱ γε στρατηγοί, ἔφη, οὕτω τὸν αὐτὸν

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S: Well then, by heaven, perhaps it was Ctesippus who said all this and I am being forgetful? In any case, I know quite well that it was neither Euthydemus nor Dionysodorus who said all this. But, blessed Crito, was it perhaps one of the superior beings in the vicinity who made the pronouncement? For I know that I did hear all this.

τρόπον· ἐπειδὴν ἡ πόλιν τινὰ θηρεύσωνται ἢ στρατόπεδον, παραδιδόασιν τοῖς πολιτικοῖς ἀνδράσιν—αὐτοὶ γὰρ οὐκ ἐπίστανται χρῆσθαι τούτοις ἃ ἐθήρευσαν—ὥσπερ οἶμαι οἱ ὀρτυγοθῆραι τοῖς ὀρτυγοτρόφοις παραδιδόασιν. εἰ οὖν, ἦ δ' ὅς, δεόμεθα ἐκείνης τῆς τέχνης, ἥτις ὥ ἂν κτήσεται ἢ ποιήσασα ἢ θηρευσάμενη αὐτὴ καὶ ἐπιστήσεται χρῆσθαι, καὶ ἡ τοιαύτη ποιήσει ἡμᾶς μακαρίους, ἄλλην δὲ τινά, ἔφη, ζητητέον ἀντὶ τῆς στρατηγικῆς.

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CR: Yes by Zeus, Socrates, I think it was indeed one of the superior beings, very much so. But after that, did you continue searching for some sort of skill? Did you or did you not find the skill you were searching for?

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S: Did we find it? Heavens, no. But we were quite comical fellows, just like children chasing after larks, constantly believing we were just on the point of capturing each of the kinds of knowledge, while they kept on escaping us. Once we had arrived at the art of kingship, and we were considering it closely in case it might be the one that provides happiness, we ended up in a sort of labyrinth. Thinking we were already at the end, having turned another corner, we appeared to be back at the beginning of the search once more, and just as badly off as we were at the outset.

KP. τί λέγεις σύ, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἐκεῖνο τὸ μειράκιον τοιαῦτ' ἐφθέγγατο; ΣΩ. οὐκ οἶμαι, ὦ Κρίτων; KP. μὰ Δί' οὐ μέντοι. οἶμαι γὰρ αὐτὸν ἐγώ, εἰ ταῦτ' εἶπεν, οὔτ' Εὐθυδήμου οὔτε ἄλλου οὐδενὸς ἔτ' ἀνθρώπου δεῖσθαι εἰς παιδείαν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄρα, ὦ πρὸς Διός, μὴ ὁ Κτήσιππος ἦν ὁ ταῦτ' εἰπών, ἐγὼ δὲ οὐ μένημαι;

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CR: How did that happen to you, Socrates?

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S: I'll tell you. The fact is, we had presumed that the skill of statesmanship and the skill of kingship were the same. The skill of generalship and the others hand over to this skill to take charge of their works, since it alone knows how to make use of them. So it seemed evident to us that this was what we were seeking, and was the cause of right action in the city, simply, as the line from Aeschylus says, seated alone at the helm of the city, governing all, in charge of all, making everything useful.

KP. ποῖος Κτήσιππος; ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν τόδε γε εὖ οἶδα, ὅτι οὔτε Εὐθύδημος οὔτε Διονυσόδωρος ἦν ὁ εἰπών ταῦτα· ἀλλ', ὦ δαιμόνιε Κρίτων, μὴ τις τῶν κρειττόνων παρὼν αὐτὰ ἐφθέγγατο; ὅτι γὰρ ἤκουσά γε ταῦτα, εὖ οἶδα. KP. ναὶ μὰ Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες· τῶν κρειττόνων μέντοι τις ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, καὶ πολὺ γε. ἀλλὰ μετὰ τοῦτο ἔτι τινὰ ἐζητήσατε τέχνην; καὶ ἤυρετε ἐκείνην ἢ οὐχ ἤυρετε, ἧς ἔνεκα ἐζητεῖτε; ΣΩ. πόθεν, ὦ μακάριε, ἤυρομεν; ἀλλ' ἤμεν πάνυ γελοῖοι· ὥσπερ τὰ παιδία τὰ τοὺς κορυδούς διώκοντα, αἰὲν ὥόμεθα ἐκάστην τῶν ἐπιστημῶν αὐτίκα λήψεσθαι, αἱ δ' αἰὲν ὑπεξέφευγον. τὰ μὲν οὖν πολλὰ τί ἄν σοι λέγοιμι; ἐπὶ δὲ δὴ τὴν βασιλικὴν ἐλθόντες τέχνην καὶ διασκοπούμενοι αὐτὴν εἰ αὕτη εἴη ἢ τὴν εὐδαιμονίαν παρέχουσα τε καὶ ἀπεργαζομένη, ἐνταῦθα ὥσπερ εἰς λαβύρινθον ἐμπεσόντες, οἴομενοι ἤδη ἐπὶ τέλει εἶναι, περικάμψαντες πάλιν ὥσπερ ἐν ἀρχῇ τῆς ζητήσεως ἀνεφάνημεν ὄντες καὶ τοῦ ἴσου δεόμενοι ὅσους περ ὅτε τὸ πρῶτον ἐζητοῦμεν. KP. πῶς δὴ τοῦτο ὑμῖν συνέβη, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἐγὼ φράσω. ἔδοξε γὰρ δὴ ἡμῖν ἡ πολιτικὴ καὶ ἡ βασιλικὴ τέχνη ἢ αὕτη εἶναι. KP. τί οὖν δὴ; ΣΩ. ταύτῃ τῇ τέχνῃ ἢ τε στρατηγικῇ καὶ αἱ ἄλλαι παραδιδόναι ἄρχειν τῶν ἔργων ὧν αὐταὶ

δημιουργοί εἰσιν, ὡς μόνῃ ἐπισταμένη χρῆσθαι. σαφῶς οὖν ἐδόκει ἡμῖν αὕτη εἶναι ἣν ἐζητοῦμεν, καὶ ἡ αἰτία τοῦ ὁρθῶς πράττειν ἐν τῇ

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CR: Well, was your understanding unsound, Socrates?

πόλει, καὶ ἀτεχνῶς κατὰ τὸ Αἰσχύλου ἱαμβεῖον μόνῃ ἐν τῇ πρύμνῃ καθῆσθαι τῆς πόλεως, πάντα κυβερνῶσα καὶ πάντων ἄρχουσα πάντα χρήσιμα ποιεῖν. ΚΡ. οὐκοῦν καλῶς ὑμῖν ἐδόκει, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. σὺ κρινεῖς, ὦ Κρίτων, ἐὰν βούλῃ ἀκούειν καὶ τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα συμβάντα ἡμῖν. αὐθις γὰρ δὴ πάλιν ἐσκοποῦμεν ὧδέ πως· φέρε, πάντων ἄρχουσα ἡ βασιλικὴ τέχνη τί ἡμῖν

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S: You will decide, Crito, if you are willing to hear what happened to us after this. When we asked what outcome the skill of kingship brings about for us – as medical skill brings health, and the skill of agriculture brings food from the earth – we found we couldn't say what it produces. Eventually, Clinias and I agreed that good is presumably nothing but knowledge of some sort. So the skill of kingship had to make the citizens wise and confer knowledge, if it was really going to be the one that benefits them and makes them happy.

ἀπεργάζεται ἔργον ἢ οὐδέν; πάντως δήπου, ἡμεῖς ἔφαμεν πρὸς ἀλλήλους. οὐ καὶ σὺ ἂν ταῦτα φαίης, ὦ Κρίτων; ΚΡ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί οὖν ἂν φαίης αὐτῆς ἔργον εἶναι; ὥσπερ εἰ σὲ ἐγὼ ἐρωτῶην, πάντων ἄρχουσα ἡ ἱατρικὴ ὦν ἄρχει, τί ἔργον παρέχεται; οὐ τὴν ὑγίειαν ἂν φαίης; ΚΡ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί δὲ ἡ ὑμετέρα τέχνη ἡ γεωργία; πάντων ἄρχουσα ὦν ἄρχει, τί ἔργον ἀπεργάζεται; οὐ τὴν τροφήν ἂν φαίης τὴν ἐκ τῆς γῆς παρέχειν ἡμῖν; ΚΡ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. τί δὲ ἡ βασιλικὴ πάντων ἄρχουσα ὦν ἄρχει; τί ἀπεργάζεται; ἴσως οὐ πάνυ γ' εὐπορεῖς. ΚΡ. μὰ τὸν Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐδὲ γὰρ ἡμεῖς, ὦ Κρίτων· ἀλλὰ τοσόνδε γε οἶσθα, ὅτι εἴπερ ἐστὶν αὕτη ἣν ἡμεῖς ζητοῦμεν, ὠφέλιμον αὐτὴν δεῖ εἶναι. ΚΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀγαθὸν γέ τι δεῖ ἡμῖν αὐτὴν παραδιδόναι; ΚΡ. ἀνάγκη, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀγαθὸν δέ γέ που ὠμολογήσαμεν ἀλλήλοις ἐγὼ τε καὶ Κλεινίας οὐδὲν εἶναι ἄλλο ἢ ἐπιστήμην τινά. ΚΡ. ναί, οὕτως ἔλεγες. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ μὲν

ἄλλα ἔργα, ἃ φαίη ἄν τις πολιτικῆς εἶναι—πολλὰ δέ που ταῦτ' ἄν εἴη, οἷον πλουσίους τοὺς πολίτας παρέχειν καὶ ἐλευθέρους καὶ ἀστασιάστους—πάντα ταῦτα οὔτε κακὰ οὔτε ἀγαθὰ ἐφάνη, ἔδει δὲ σοφὸν ποιεῖν καὶ ἐπιστήμης μεταδιδόναι, εἴπερ ἔμελλεν αὕτη εἶναι ἡ

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CR: That's it. So, based upon your report of the discussion, this was presumably agreed by yourselves at that stage.

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S: Well then, does the skill of kingship make the people wise and good?

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CR: Is there any reason why not, Socrates?

ὠφελοῦσά τε καὶ εὐδαίμονας ποιοῦσα. ΚΡ. ἔστι ταῦτα τότε γοῦν οὕτως ὑμῖν ὠμολογήθη, ὥς σὺ τοὺς λόγους ἀπήγγειλας. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἡ βασιλικὴ σοφὸν ποιεῖ τοὺς ἀνθρώπους καὶ ἀγαθοὺς; ΚΡ. τί γὰρ κωλύει, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄρα πάντας καὶ πάντα ἀγαθοὺς; καὶ πᾶσαν ἐπιστήμην, σκυτοτομικὴν τε καὶ τεκτονικὴν καὶ τὰς ἄλλας ἀπάσας, αὕτη ἡ παραδιδουῦσά ἐστιν; ΚΡ. οὐκ οἶμαι ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες.

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S: But does it make everyone good at everything? And is this the skill that confers all knowledge – shoe-making, carpentry, and all the others?

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CR: No, Socrates, I don't think so.

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S: Well, what knowledge does it confer? Now, it should not be the artificer of any of the outcomes that are neither good nor bad, yet it should confer no knowledge apart from itself. Is it acceptable if we say that it is that by which we shall make others good?

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CR: Entirely so.

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ τίνα δὴ ἐπιστήμην; ἥ τί χρῆσόμεθα; τῶν μὲν γὰρ ἔργων οὐδενὸς δεῖ αὐτὴν δημιουργὸν εἶναι τῶν μήτε κακῶν μήτε ἀγαθῶν,

ἐπιστήμην δὲ παραδιδόναι μηδεμίαν ἄλλην ἢ αὐτὴν ἑαυτήν. λέγωμεν δὴ οὐν τίς ποτέ ἐστιν αὕτη, ἥ τί χρησόμεθα; βούλει φῶμεν, ὦ Κρίτων, ἥ ἄλλους ἀγαθοὺς ποιήσομεν; ΚΡ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οἱ τί ἔσονται ἡμῖν ἀγαθοὶ καὶ τί χρήσιμοι; ἢ ἔτι λέγωμεν ὅτι ἄλλους ποιήσουσιν, οἱ δὲ ἄλλοι ἐκεῖνοι ἄλλους;

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S: In what respect will they be good and useful for us? Or would we continue to say that they will make others so, and those others will do this too? But it is not at all evident to us in what exact respect they are good, especially since we have discredited the outcomes ascribed to statesmanship. No, it is simply a case of the proverb, ‘Corinthos, son of Zeus’, and as I said, we were just as badly off, or even worse off, when it came to knowing what the knowledge that will make us happy actually is.

ὅτι δὲ ποτε ἀγαθοὶ εἰσιν, οὐδαμοῦ ἡμῖν φαίνονται, ἐπειδὴ περ τὰ ἔργα τὰ λεγόμενα εἶναι τῆς πολιτικῆς ἡτιμάσαμεν, ἀλλ’ ἀτεχνῶς τὸ λεγόμενον ὁ Διὸς Κόρινθος γίγνεται, καὶ ὅπερ ἔλεγον, τοῦ ἴσου ἡμῖν ἐνδεῖ ἢ ἔτι πλέονος πρὸς τὸ εἰδέναι τίς ποτέ ἐστιν ἡ ἐπιστήμη ἐκείνη ἢ ἡμᾶς εὐδαίμονας ποιήσει; ΚΡ. νῆ τὸν Δία, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰς πολλήν γε ἀπορίαν, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἀφίκεσθε. ΣΩ. ἔγωγε οὐν καὶ αὐτός, ὦ Κρίτων, ἐπειδὴ ἐν ταύτῃ

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CR: By Zeus, Socrates, it seems you ended up in considerable difficulty.

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S: Now, I myself, Crito, since I had landed in this difficulty, began to exclaim at the top of my voice, begging the two strangers to rescue us, myself and the young man, from the third wave of the argument, to be serious in every way, and reveal to us, in all seriousness, what precisely is the knowledge which we should obtain if we are to live out the rest of our lives beautifully.

τῇ ἀπορίᾳ ἐνεπεπτώκη, πᾶσαν ἤδη φωνὴν ἠφίειν, δεόμενος τοῖν ξένοιον ὥσπερ Διοσκοῦρων ἐπικαλούμενος σῶσαι ἡμᾶς, ἐμέ τε καὶ τὸ

μειράκιον, ἐκ τῆς τρικυμίας τοῦ λόγου, καὶ παντὶ τρόπῳ σπουδάσαι, καὶ σπουδάζαντας ἐπιδείξαι τίς ποτ' ἐστὶν ἡ ἐπιστήμη ἣς τυχόντες ἂν καλῶς τὸν ἐπίλοιπον βίον διέλθοιμεν. ΚΡ. τί οὖν; ἠθέλησέν τι ὑμῖν ἐπιδείξαι ὁ Εὐθύδημος; ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; καὶ ἥρξατό γε, ὦ ἑταῖρε, πάνυ μεγαλοφρόνως τοῦ λόγου ὥδε—

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CR: Well then, was Euthydemus prepared to reveal anything to you?

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S: Of course, and he began his account, my friend, in a very high-minded manner, as follows. “Well, Socrates, this knowledge that has perplexed you for so long, shall I teach it to you, or show you that you possess it?” “Blessed man,” said I, “is it within your power to do this?” “It certainly is,” he replied. “Then show me that I possess it, by Zeus, since for a man of my age that will be much easier than learning it.” He asked if there is anything I know. “Certainly,” I replied. “That’s enough,” said he. “Now, do you think it is possible for anything at all not to be just what it happens to be?” “By Zeus, I do not.” “And you do know something?” “I do.” “In that case you are knowledgeable, if you actually know.” “Certainly, in relation to that ‘something’.” “That makes no difference. Isn’t it necessary that you know everything since you are knowledgeable?” “Heavens,” said I, “even when there is so much else that I do not know?” “Well then, if there is something you do not know, you are not knowledgeable.”

πότερον δὴ σε, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ταύτην τὴν ἐπιστήμην, περὶ ἣν πάλαι ἀπορεῖτε, διδάξω, ἢ ἐπιδείξω ἔχοντα; ὦ μακάριε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἔστι δὲ ἐπὶ σοὶ τοῦτο; πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφη. ἐπιδείξον τοίνυν με νῆ Δί', ἔφην ἐγώ, ἔχοντα· πολὺ γὰρ ῥᾶον ἢ μανθάνειν τηλικόνδε ἄνδρα. φέρε δὴ μοι ἀποκρίναι, ἔφη· ἔστιν ὅτι ἐπίστασαι;—πάνυ γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ πολλά, σμικρά γε.—ἀρκεῖ, ἔφη. ἄρ' οὖν δοκεῖς οἷόν τέ τι τῶν ὄντων τοῦτο ὁ τυγχάνει ὄν, αὐτὸ τοῦτο μὴ εἶναι;—ἀλλὰ μὰ Δί' οὐκ ἔγωγε.—οὐκοῦν σύ, ἔφη, ἐπίστασά τι;—ἔγωγε.—οὐκοῦν ἐπιστήμων εἶ, εἴπερ ἐπίστασαι;—πάνυ γε, τούτου γε αὐτοῦ.—οὐδὲν διαφέρει· ἀλλ' οὐκ ἀνάγκη σε ἔχει πάντα ἐπίστασθαι ἐπιστήμονά γε ὄντα;—μὰ Δί', ἔφην ἐγώ· ἐπεὶ πολλὰ

ἄλλ' οὐκ ἐπίσταμαι.—οὐκοῦν εἴ τι μὴ ἐπίστασαι, οὐκ ἐπιστήμων εἶ.—
 ἐκείνου γε, ὦ φίλε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ.—ἦττον οὖν τι, ἔφη, οὐκ ἐπιστήμων εἶ;
 ἄρτι δὲ ἐπιστήμων ἔφησθα εἶναι· καὶ οὕτως τυγχάνεις ὧν αὐτὸς οὗτος
 ὅς εἰ, καὶ αὖ πάλιν οὐκ εἶ, κατὰ ταῦτά ἅμα. εἶεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, Εὐθύδημε· τὸ
 γὰρ λεγόμενον, καλὰ δὴ παταγεῖς· πῶς οὖν ἐπίσταμαι ἐκείνην τὴν
 ἐπιστήμην ἣν ἐζητοῦμεν; ὥς δὴ τοῦτο ἀδύνατόν ἐστιν τὸ αὐτὸ εἶναι τε
 καὶ μὴ, εἴπερ ἓν ἐπίσταμαι, ἅπαντα ἐπίσταμαι—οὐ γὰρ ἂν εἶην
 ἐπιστήμων τε καὶ ἀνεπιστήμων ἅμα—ἐπεὶ δὲ πάντα ἐπίσταμαι, κἀκείνην
 δὴ τὴν ἐπιστήμην ἔχω· ἄρα οὕτως λέγεις, καὶ τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σοφόν;
 αὐτὸς σαυτὸν γε δὴ ἐξελέγχεις, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες. τί δέ, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ
 Εὐθύδημε, σὺ οὐ πέπονθας τοῦτο τὸ αὐτὸ πάθος; ἐγὼ γάρ τοι μετὰ σοῦ
 ὅτιοῦν ἂν πάσχω καὶ μετὰ Διονυσοδώρου τοῦδε, φίλης κεφαλῆς, οὐκ
 ἂν πάνυ ἀγανακτοίην. εἶπέ μοι, σφῶ οὐχὶ τὰ μὲν ἐπίστασθον τῶν
 ὄντων, τὰ δὲ οὐκ ἐπίστασθον; ἥκιστα γε, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁ
 Διονυσόδωρος. πῶς λέγετον; ἔφην ἐγώ· ἀλλ' οὐδὲν ἄρα ἐπίστασθον; καὶ
 μάλα, ἦ δ' ὅς.

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By Zeus,” said I, “what a wonder you are describing. Great good has come to light. But surely all the rest of the people don’t know either everything or nothing?” “Well, presumably,” said he, “it is not the case that they know some things while not knowing others. Everyone knows everything, if they actually know even one thing.” And under questioning by Ctesippus they did accept that they knew everything, case by case. There was nothing that Ctesippus did not ask them, no matter how base it was. Yet the two men met his questions most valiantly, just like boars that are driven towards an onslaught. As a result, I myself was compelled in the end to ask, incredulously, if Dionysodorus knew how to dance, and he replied, “Certainly.” “I do not suppose that at your age, you have attained such advanced wisdom that you can also somersault over swords, and be spun about on a wheel, have you?” “There is nothing I cannot do,” he replied. “And when you were children, even at the moment you were born, did you know everything?” They both said yes, simultaneously.

ΣΩ. πάντ' ἄρα, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἐπίστασθον, ἐπειδήπερ καὶ ὅτιοῦν; πάντ', ἔφη καὶ σύ γε πρὸς, εἴπερ καὶ ἐν ἐπίστασαι, πάντα ἐπίστασαι. ὦ Ζεῦ, ἔφην ἐγώ, ὡς θαυμαστὸν λέγεις καὶ ἀγαθὸν μέγα πεφάνθαι. μὼν καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες ἄνθρωποι πάντ' ἐπίστανται, ἢ οὐδέν; οὐ γὰρ δήπου, ἔφη, τὰ μὲν ἐπίστανται, τὰ δ' οὐκ ἐπίστανται, καὶ εἰσὶν ἅμα ἐπιστήμονές τε καὶ ἀνεπιστήμονες. ἀλλὰ τί; ἦν δ' ἐγώ. πάντες, ἢ δ' ὅς, πάντα ἐπίστανται, εἴπερ καὶ ἐν. ὦ πρὸς τῶν θεῶν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε—δῆλοι γάρ μοι ἔστον ἤδη ὅτι σπουδάζετον, καὶ μόλις ὑμᾶς προυκαλεσάμην σπουδάζειν—αὐτὼ ὄντι πάντα ἐπίστασθον; οἷον τεκτονικὴν καὶ σκυτικὴν; πάνυ γ', ἔφη. ἢ καὶ νευρορραφεῖν δυνατὴ ἔστον; καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δία καττύνει, ἔφη. ἢ καὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα, τοὺς ἀστέρας ὅποσοι εἰσὶ, καὶ τὴν ἄμμον; πάνυ γε, ἢ δ' ὅς· εἴτ' οὐκ ἂν οἶε ὁμολογήσαι ἡμᾶς; καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος ὑπολαβὼν· πρὸς Διός, ἔφη, Διονυσόδωρε, τεκμήριόν τί μοι τούτων ἐπιδείξατον τοιόνδε, ᾧ εἴσομαι ὅτι ἀληθῆ λέγετον. τί ἐπιδείξω; ἔφη. οἶσθα Εὐθύδημον ὁπόσους ὀδόντας ἔχει, καὶ ὁ Εὐθύδημος ὁπόσους σύ; οὐκ ἔξαρκεῖ σοι, ἔφη, ἀκοῦσαι ὅτι πάντα ἐπιστάμεθα; μηδαμῶς, ἢ δ' ὅς, ἀλλὰ τοῦτο ἔτι ἡμῖν μόνον εἴπατον καὶ ἐπιδείξατον ὅτι ἀληθῆ λέγετον· καὶ ἐὰν εἴπητον ὁπόσους ἐκάτερος ἔχει ὑμῶν, καὶ φαίνησθε γνόντες ἡμῶν ἀριθμησάντων, ἤδη πεισόμεθα ὑμῖν καὶ τᾶλλα. ἡγουμένω οὖν σκώπτεσθαι οὐκ ἠθέλετην, ἀλλ' ὡμολογησάτην πάντα χρήματα ἐπίστασθαι, καθ' ἐν ἑκαστον ἐρωτῶμενοι ὑπὸ Κτησίππου. ὁ γὰρ Κτησίππος πάνυ ἀπαρακαλύπτως οὐδέν ὅτι οὐκ ἡρώτα τελευτῶν, καὶ τὰ αἰσχίστα, εἰ ἐπισταίσθην· τῷ δὲ ἀνδρείοτατα ὁμόσε ἤτην τοῖς ἐρωτήμασιν, ὁμολογοῦντες εἰδέναι, ὥσπερ οἱ κάπροι οἱ πρὸς τὴν πληγὴν ὁμόσε ὠθούμενοι, ὥστ' ἔγωγε καὶ αὐτός, ὦ Κρίτων, ὑπ' ἀπιστίας ἠναγκάσθην τελευτῶν ἐρέσθαι τὸν Εὐθύδημον εἰ καὶ ὀρχεῖσθαι ἐπίσταιτο ὁ Διονυσόδωρος· ὁ δέ, πάνυ, ἔφη. οὐ δήπου, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ ἐς μαχαίρας γε κυβιστᾶν καὶ ἐπὶ τροχοῦ δινεῖσθαι τηλικούτος ὢν, οὕτω πόρρω σοφίας ἤκει; οὐδέν, ἔφη, ὅτι οὐ. πότερον δέ, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, πάντα νῦν μόνον ἐπίστασθον ἢ καὶ αἰεὶ; καὶ αἰεὶ, ἔφη. καὶ ὅτε παιδία ἦσθην καὶ εὐθύς γενόμενοι ἠπίστασθε πάντα; ἐφάτην ἅμα ἀμφοτέρω. ΣΩ. καὶ ἡμῖν μὲν ἄπιστον ἐδόκει τὸ πρᾶγμα εἶναι· ὁ δ' Εὐθύδημος, ἀπιστεῖς, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες; πλὴν γ' ὅτι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, εἰκὸς ὑμᾶς ἔστι

σοφούς εἶναι. ἀλλ' ἦν, ἔφη, ἐθελήσης μοι ἀποκρίνεσθαι, ἐγὼ ἐπιδείξω καὶ σὲ ταῦτα τὰ θαυμαστὰ ὁμολογοῦντα. ἀλλὰ μήν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἥδιστα ταῦτα ἐξελέγχομαι. εἰ γάρ τοι λέληθα ἐμαυτὸν σοφὸς ὢν, σὺ δὲ τοῦτο ἐπιδείξεις ὥς πάντα ἐπίσταμαι καὶ αἰεὶ, τί μείζον ἔρμαιον αὐτοῦ ἂν εὗροιμι ἐν παντὶ τῷ βίῳ; ἀποκρίνου δὴ, ἔφη.

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Euthydemus wanted to prove I accept these amazing propositions too. He asked if I know what I know by means of something. “By the soul.” He pressed: do you always know by this same means? Always? Do you know some things by means of this and others by means of something else, or do you know all things by this? “I know all things by this,” I replied, “whatever I know at any rate.” Through careful stripping of qualifications like ‘whatever I know’ and ‘whenever I know’, he got me to say simply “Always” and “All things.” Then he announced: “Now, you have also accepted that you always know by means of that whereby you know. So it is obvious that you knew as a child, even when you were being born, even when you were being conceived. Even before you yourself were born, even before heaven and earth came into being, you knew all things, since you always know. And indeed, by Zeus, you yourself always will know, and will know all things, if it so pleases me.”

ὥς ἀποκρινομένου ἐρώτα. ἄρ' οὖν, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπιστήμων του εἶ ἢ οὐ;—ἔγωγε.—πότερον οὖν ὧ ἐπιστήμων εἶ, τούτῳ καὶ ἐπίστασαι, ἢ ἄλλῳ τῷ;—ὦ ἐπιστήμων. οἶμαι γάρ σε τὴν ψυχὴν λέγειν· ἢ οὐ τοῦτο λέγεις; οὐκ αἰσχύνῃ, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες; ἐρωτώμενος ἀντερωτᾶς; εἶεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ· ἀλλὰ πῶς ποιῶ; οὕτω γὰρ ποιήσω ὅπως ἂν σὺ κελεύῃς. ὅταν μὴ εἰδῶ ὅτι ἐρωτᾶς, κελεύεις με ὅμως ἀποκρίνεσθαι, ἀλλὰ μὴ ἐπανερέσθαι; ὑπολαμβάνεις γὰρ δήπου τι, ἔφη, ὃ λέγω; ἔγωγε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ. πρὸς τοῦτο τοίνυν ἀποκρίνου ὃ ὑπολαμβάνεις. τί οὖν, ἔφη, ἂν σὺ μὲν ἄλλῃ ἐρωτᾶς διανοούμενος, ἐγὼ δὲ ἄλλῃ ὑπολάβω, ἔπειτα πρὸς τοῦτο ἀποκρίνωμαι, ἐξαρκεῖ σοι ἐὰν μηδὲν πρὸς ἔπος ἀποκρίνωμαι; ἔμοιγε, ἦ δ' ὅς· οὐ μέντοι σοί γε, ὥς ἐγὼμαι. οὐ τοίνυν μὰ Δία ἀποκρινοῦμαι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, πρότερον πρὶν ἂν πύθωμαι. οὐκ ἀποκρινῇ, ἔφη, πρὸς ἃ ἂν αἰεὶ ὑπολαμβάνῃς, ὅτι ἔχων φλυαρεῖς καὶ ἀρχαιότερος εἶ

τοῦ δέοντος, καὶ γὰρ ἔγνω αὐτὸν ὅτι μοι χαλεπαῖνοι διαστέλλονται τὰ λεγόμενα, βουλούμενός με θηρεῦσαι τὰ ὀνόματα περιστήσας. ἀνεμνήσθην οὖν τοῦ Κόννου, ὅτι μοι κακέϊνος χαλεπαίνει ἐκάστοτε ὅταν αὐτῷ μὴ ὑπέικω, ἔπειτά μου ἦττον ἐπιμελεῖται ὡς ἀμαθοῦς ὄντος· ἐπεὶ δὲ οὖν διενενοήμην καὶ παρὰ τοῦτον φοιτᾶν, ᾧ ἦθην δεῖν ὑπέικειν, μὴ με σκαῖον ἡγησάμενος φοιτητὴν μὴ προσδέχοιτο. εἶπον οὖν· ἄλλ' εἰ δοκεῖ σοι, Εὐθύδημε, οὕτω ποιεῖν, ποιητέον· σὺ γὰρ πάντως πού κάλλιον ἐπίστασαι διαλέγεσθαι ἢ ἐγώ, τέχνην ἔχων ἰδιώτου ἀνθρώπου. ἐρώτα οὖν πάλιν ἐξ ἀρχῆς. ἀποκρίνου δὴ, ἔφη, πάλιν, πότερον ἐπίστασαί τω ἢ ἐπίστασαι, ἢ οὐ;—ἐγωγε, ἔφην, τῇ γε ψυχῇ. ΣΩ. οὗτος αὖ, ἔφη, προσαποκρίνεται τοῖς ἐρωτωμένοις. οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγε ἐρωτῶ ὅτῳ, ἀλλ' εἰ ἐπίστασαί τω. πλέον αὖ, ἔφην ἐγώ, τοῦ δέοντος ἀπεκρινάμην ὑπὸ ἀπαιδευσίας. ἀλλὰ συγγίγνωσκέ μοι· ἀποκρινοῦμαι γὰρ ἤδη ἀπλῶς ὅτι ἐπίσταμαί τω ἢ ἐπίσταμαι.—πότερον, ἢ δ' ὅς, τῷ αὐτῷ τούτῳ γ' αἰεὶ, ἢ ἔστι μὲν ὅτε τούτῳ, ἔστιν δὲ ὅτε ἐτέρῳ;—αἰεὶ, ὅταν ἐπίστωμαι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, τούτῳ. οὐκ αὖ, ἔφη, παύση παραφθεγγόμενος; ἀλλ' ὅπως μὴ τι ἡμᾶς σφῆλη τὸ αἰεὶ τοῦτο. οὐκ οὖν ἡμᾶς γ', ἔφη, ἀλλ' εἴπερ, σέ. ἀλλ' ἀποκρίνου· ἢ αἰεὶ τούτῳ ἐπίστασαι;—αἰεὶ, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἐπειδὴ δεῖ ἀφελεῖν τὸ ὅταν.—οὐκοῦν αἰεὶ μὲν τούτῳ ἐπίστασαι· αἰεὶ δ' ἐπιστάμενος πότερον τὰ μὲν τούτῳ ἐπίστασαι ᾧ ἐπίστασαι, τὰ δ' ἄλλω, ἢ τούτῳ πάντα;—τούτῳ, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἅπαντα, ἃ γ' ἐπίσταμαι. τοῦτ' ἐκεῖνο, ἔφη ἥκει τὸ αὐτὸ παράφθεγμα. ἀλλ' ἀφαιρῶ, ἔφην ἐγώ, τὸ ἃ γ' ἐπίσταμαι. ἀλλὰ μηδὲ ἔν, ἔφη, ἀφέλης· οὐδὲν γάρ σου δέομαι. ἀλλὰ μοι ἀπόκριναι· δύναιο ἂν ἅπαντα ἐπίστασθαι, εἰ μὴ πάντα ἐπίσται; τέρας γὰρ ἂν εἴη, ἦν δ' ἐγώ. καὶ ὅς εἶπε· Προστίθει τοίνυν ἥδη ὅτι βούλει ἅπαντα γὰρ ὁμολογεῖς ἐπίστασθαι. ἔοικα, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἐπειδὴ περ γε οὐδεμίαν ἔχει δύναμιν τὸ ἢ ἐπίσταμαι, πάντα δὲ ἐπίσταμαι. οὐκοῦν καὶ αἰεὶ ὠμολόγηκας ἐπίστασθαι τούτῳ ᾧ ἐπίστασαι, εἴτε ὅταν ἐπίστη εἴτε ὅπως βούλει· αἰεὶ γὰρ ὠμολόγηκας ἐπίστασθαι καὶ ἅμα πάντα. δῆλον οὖν ὅτι καὶ παῖς ὢν ἠπίστω, καὶ ὅτ' ἐγίγνου, καὶ ὅτ' ἐφύου· καὶ πρὶν αὐτὸς γενέσθαι, καὶ πρὶν οὐρανὸν καὶ γῆν γενέσθαι, ἠπίστω ἅπαντα, εἴπερ αἰεὶ ἐπίστασαι. καὶ ναὶ μὰ Δία, ἔφη, αὐτὸς αἰεὶ ἐπιστήση καὶ ἅπαντα, ἂν ἐγὼ βούλωμαι. ἀλλὰ βουληθείης, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ᾧ πολυτίμητε Εὐθύδημε, εἰ δὴ τῷ ὄντι ἀληθῆ

λέγεις. ἀλλ' οὐ σοι πάνυ πιστεύω ἱκανῶ εἶναι, εἰ μή σοι συμβουλευθείη ὁ ἀδελφός σου οὐτοσί Διονυσόδωρος· οὕτω δὲ τάχα ἄν. εἶπετον δέ μοι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ—

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I asked him to tell me how I may say that I know such things as that good men are unjust. “You know, indeed,” he replied. “What?” said I. “That good men are not unjust.” “Yes, I’ve always known that,” said I. “But I am asking where I learned that the good people are unjust.” “Nowhere,” replied Dionysodorus. “Then I do not know this,” said I. “You are ruining the argument,” said Euthydemus to Dionysodorus, “and this fellow will turn out not to have known this, and to be knowledgeable and not knowledgeable at the same time.” Dionysodorus blushed. And I said, “I am certainly inferior to Heracles, who was not able to do battle with the hydra, a sophistical creature so clever that if someone cut off one head of the argument, she sent forth many more in its place. He could not do battle with her and with some other sophistical crab recently emerged from the sea, who so pained Heracles by talking and biting from his left-hand side that he called for the help of his nephew, Iolaus. But if my Iolaus were to arrive, he would just make matters worse.”

τὰ μὲν γὰρ ἄλλα οὐκ ἔχω ὑμῖν πῶς ἀμφισβητοῖν, οὕτως εἰς σοφίαν τερατώδεσιν ἀνθρώποις, ὅπως ἐγὼ οὐ πάντα ἐπίσταμαι, ἐπειδὴ γε ὑμεῖς φατε—τὰ δὲ τοιάδε πῶς φῶ ἐπίστασθαι, Εὐθύδημε, ὡς οἱ ἀγαθοὶ ἄνδρες ἀδικοὶ εἰσιν; φέρε εἰπέ, τοῦτο ἐπίσταμαι ἢ οὐκ ἐπίσταμαι; ἐπίστασαι μέντοι, ἔφη. τί; ἦν δ' ἐγώ. ὅτι οὐκ ἀδικοὶ εἰσιν οἱ ἀγαθοί. ΣΩ. πάνυ γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, πάλαι. ἀλλ' οὐ τοῦτο ἐρωτῶ· ἀλλ' ὡς ἀδικοὶ εἰσιν οἱ ἀγαθοί, ποῦ ἐγὼ τοῦτο ἔμαθον; οὐδαμοῦ, ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος. οὐκ ἄρα ἐπίσταμαι, ἔφην, τοῦτο ἐγώ. διαφθείρεις, ἔφη, τὸν λόγον, ὁ Εὐθύδημος πρὸς τὸν Διονυσόδωρον, καὶ φανήσεται οὐτοσί οὐκ ἐπιστάμενος, καὶ ἐπιστήμων ἅμα ὢν καὶ ἀνεπιστήμων. καὶ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος ἠρυθρίασεν. ἀλλὰ σύ, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, πῶς λέγεις, ὦ Εὐθύδημε; οὐ δοκεῖ σοι ὀρθῶς ἀδελφὸς λέγειν ὁ πάντ' εἰδώς; ἀδελφὸς γάρ, ἔφη, ἐγὼ εἶμι Εὐθυδήμου, ταχὺ ὑπολαβὼν ὁ Διονυσόδωρος; καὶ γὰρ εἶπον· ἕασον, ὦγαθέ, ἕως ἂν Εὐθύδημός με διδάξῃ

ὥς ἐπίσταμαι τοὺς ἀγαθοὺς ἄνδρας ὅτι ἄδικοί εἰσι, καὶ μή μοι φθονήσης τοῦ μαθήματος. φεύγεις, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλεις ἀποκρίνεσθαι. εἰκότως γ', εἶπον ἐγὼ ἥττων γάρ εἰμι καὶ τοῦ ἐτέρου ὑμῶν, ὥστε πολλοῦ δέω μὴ οὐ δύο γε φεύγειν. πολὺ γάρ ποῦ εἰμι φαυλότερος τοῦ Ἡρακλέους, ὃς οὐχ οἶός τε ἦν τῇ τε ὕδρᾳ διαμάχεσθαι, σοφιστρία οὖση καὶ διὰ τὴν σοφίαν ἀνιείσῃ, εἰ μίαν κεφαλὴν τοῦ λόγου τις ἀποτέμοι, πολλὰς ἀντὶ τῆς μιᾶς, καὶ καρκίνῳ τινὶ ἐτέρῳ σοφιστῇ ἐκ θαλάττης ἀφιγμένῳ, νεωστί, μοι δοκεῖν, καταπεπλευκότι· ὃς ἐπειδὴ αὐτὸν ἐλύπει οὕτως ἐκ τοῦ ἐπ' ἀριστερὰ λέγων καὶ δάκνων, τὸν Ἰόλεων τὸν ἀδελφιδοῦν βοηθὸν ἐπεκαλέσατο, ὁ δὲ αὐτῷ

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Then Dionysodorus pursued a new line: “Was Iolaus any more the nephew of Heracles than yours?” Through careful steps he had me admit that Patrocles is my brother, then established that their father Chaeredemus was a father while being other than mine, and since being other than a father means not being a father, that Sophroniscus likewise, being other than Chaeredemus, is not a father. “And so you, Socrates, are fatherless,” said Euthydemus. Then Ctesippus took up the argument: is Euthydemus’ father, being other than my father, the same? “The same, indeed.” “But, Euthydemus, is he my father only, or is he the father of everyone else too?” “Of everyone else too. Or do you think the same man, being a father, is not a father?” This extended to their mother being the mother of sea urchins, and themselves being brothers to gudgeons, puppies and piglets.

ἱκανῶς ἐβοήθησεν. ὁ δ' ἐμὸς Ἰόλεως Πατροκλῆς εἰ ἔλθοι, πλεόν ἂν θάτερον ποιήσειεν. ἀποκρίναι δὴ, ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, ὁπότε σοι ταῦτα ὕμνηται· πότερον ὁ Ἰόλεως τοῦ Ἡρακλέους μᾶλλον ἢν ἀδελφιδοῦς ἢ σός; κράτιστον τοίνυν μοι, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, ἦν δ' ἐγὼ, ἀποκρίνασθαι σοι. οὐ γὰρ μὴ ἀνῆς ἐρωτῶν, σχεδόν τι ἐγὼ τοῦτ' εὖ οἶδα, φθονῶν καὶ διακωλύων, ἵνα μὴ διδάξῃ με Εὐθύδημος ἐκεῖνο τὸ σοφόν.—ἀποκρίνου δὴ, ἔφη.—ἀποκρίνομαι δὴ, εἶπον, ὅτι τοῦ Ἡρακλέους ἦν ὁ Ἰόλεως ἀδελφιδοῦς, ἐμὸς δ', ὥς ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ, οὐδ' ὁπωστιοῦν. οὐ γὰρ Πατροκλῆς

ἦν αὐτῷ πατήρ, ὁ ἐμὸς ἀδελφός, ἀλλὰ παραπλήσιον μὲν τοῦνομα Ἰφικλῆς, ὁ Ἡρακλέους ἀδελφός.—Πατροκλῆς δέ, ἦ δ' ὅς, σός;—πάνυ γ', ἔφην ἐγώ, ὁμομήτριός γε, οὐ μέντοι ὁμοπάτριος.—ἀδελφὸς ἄρα ἐστὶ σοι καὶ οὐκ ἀδελφός.—οὐχ ὁμοπάτριός γε, ὦ βέλτιστε, ἔφην ἐκείνου μὲν γὰρ Χαιρέδημος ἦν πατήρ, ἐμὸς δὲ Σωφρονίσκος.—πατήρ δὲ ἦν, ἔφη, Σωφρονίσκος καὶ Χαιρέδημος; ΣΩ. πάνυ γ', ἔφην· ὁ μὲν γε ἐμὸς, ὁ δὲ ἐκείνου.—οὐκοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἕτερος ἦν Χαιρέδημος τοῦ πατρός;—τούμου γ', ἔφην ἐγώ.—ἄρ' οὖν πατήρ ἦν ἕτερος ὢν πατρός; ἢ σὺ εἶ ὁ αὐτὸς τῷ λίθῳ;—δέδοικα μὲν ἔγωγ', ἔφην, μὴ φανῶ ὑπὸ σοῦ ὁ αὐτός· οὐ μέντοι μοι δοκῶ.—οὐκοῦν ἕτερος εἶ, ἔφη, τοῦ λίθου;—ἕτερος μέντοι.—ἄλλο τι οὖν ἕτερος, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὢν λίθου οὐ λίθος εἶ; καὶ ἕτερος ὢν χρυσοῦ οὐ χρυσὸς εἶ;—ἔστι ταῦτα.—οὐκ οὐν καὶ ὁ Χαιρέδημος, ἔφη, ἕτερος ὢν πατρός οὐκ ἂν πατήρ ἐστιν.—ἔοικεν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, οὐ πατήρ εἶναι. εἰ γὰρ δήπου, ἔφη, πατήρ ἐστιν ὁ Χαιρέδημος, ὑπολαβὼν ὁ Εὐθύδημος, πάλιν αὖ ὁ Σωφρονίσκος ἕτερος ὢν πατρός οὐ πατήρ ἐστιν, ὥστε σὺ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀπάτωρ εἶ. καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος ἐκδεξάμενος, ὁ δὲ ὑμέτερος, ἔφη, αὖ πατήρ οὐ ταῦτα ταῦτα πέπονθεν; ἕτερός ἐστιν τούμου πατρός;—πολλοῦ γ', ἔφη, δεῖ, ὁ Εὐθύδημος.—ἀλλά, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὁ αὐτός;—ὁ αὐτὸς μέντοι.—οὐκ ἂν συμβουλοίμην. ἀλλὰ πότερον, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, ἐμὸς μόνον ἐστὶ πατήρ ἢ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἀνθρώπων;—καὶ τῶν ἄλλων, ἔφη ἢ οἶμι τὸν αὐτὸν πατέρα ὄντα οὐ πατέρα εἶναι;—ὥμην δῆτα, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—τί δέ; ἦ δ' ὅς χρυσὸν ὄντα μὴ χρυσὸν εἶναι; ἢ ἄνθρωπον ὄντα μὴ ἄνθρωπον;—μὴ γάρ, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, τὸ λεγόμενον, οὐ λίνον λίνῳ συνάπτεις· δεινὸν γὰρ λέγεις πρᾶγμα εἰ ὁ σὸς πατήρ πάντων ἐστὶν πατήρ.—ἀλλ' ἔστιν, ἔφη.—πότερον ἀνθρώπων; ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Κτήσιππος, ἢ καὶ ἵππων καὶ τῶν ἄλλων πάντων ζώων; πάντων, ἔφη.—ἦ καὶ μήτηρ ἢ μήτηρ;—καὶ ἡ μήτηρ γε.—καὶ τῶν ἐχίνων ἄρα, ἔφη, ἢ σὴ μήτηρ μήτηρ ἐστὶ τῶν θαλαττίων.—καὶ ἡ σὴ γ', ἔφη.—καὶ σὺ ἄρα ἀδελφὸς εἶ τῶν κωβίων καὶ κυναρίων καὶ χοιριδίων.—καὶ γὰρ σὺ, ἔφη.—κάπρος ἄρα σοι πατήρ ἐστὶ καὶ κύων.—καὶ γὰρ σοί, ἔφη. αὐτίκα δέ γε, ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, ἂν μοι ἀποκρίνη, ὦ Κτήσιππε, ὁμολογήσεις ταῦτα. εἰπέ γάρ μοι, ἔστι σοι κύων;—καὶ μάλα πονηρός, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—ἔστιν οὖν

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Then Dionysodorus asked whether Ctesippus has a dog. “Yes, a very nasty one.” Does he have puppies? “Yes, and they are very like himself.” “So the dog is their father?” “Yes, I saw him covering the bitch myself.” “Well now, isn’t the dog yours? In that case, he is a father and he is yours, and so he turns out to be your father, and you turn out to be the brother of puppies.” Then Dionysodorus quickly interrupted: “Answer this little question for me. Do you beat this dog?” Ctesippus laughed and said, “Yes, by the gods, since I can’t do it to you.” “Aren’t you beating your own father then?”

αὐτῷ κυνίδια;—καὶ μάλ’, ἔφη, ἕτερα τοιαῦτα.—οὐκοῦν πατήρ ἐστὶν αὐτῶν ὁ κύων;—ἔγωγέ τοι εἶδον, ἔφη, αὐτὸν ὀχεύοντα τὴν κύνα.—τί οὖν; οὐ σός ἐστιν ὁ κύων;—πάνυ γ’, ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν πατήρ ὢν σός ἐστιν, ὥστε σὸς πατήρ γίγνεται ὁ κύων καὶ σὺ κυναρίων ἀδελφός; καὶ αὐθις ταχὺ ὑπολαβὼν ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, ἵνα μὴ πρότερόν τι εἴποι ὁ Κτήσιππος, καὶ ἔτι γέ μοι μικρόν, ἔφη, ἀποκρίναι· τύπτεις τὸν κύνα τοῦτον;—καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος γελάσας, νῆ τοὺς θεοὺς, ἔφη· οὐ γὰρ δύναμαι σέ.—οὐκοῦν τὸν σαυτοῦ πατέρα, ἔφη, τύπτεις; ΣΩ. πολὺ μέντοι, ἔφη, δικαιότερον τὸν ὑμέτερον πατέρ’ ἂν τύπτοιμι, ὅτι μαθὼν σοφοὺς ὑεῖς οὕτως ἔφυσεν. ἀλλ’ ἦ που, ὦ Εὐθύδημε ὁ Κτήσιππος, πόλλ’ ἀγαθὰ ἀπὸ τῆς ὑμετέρας σοφίας ταύτης ἀπολέλαυκεν ὁ πατήρ ὁ ὑμέτερός τε καὶ τῶν κυνιδίων. ἀλλ’ οὐδὲν δεῖται πολλῶν ἀγαθῶν, ὦ Κτήσιππε, οὔτ’ ἐκεῖνος οὔτε σύ. οὐδὲ σύ, ἦ δ’ ὅς, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, αὐτός; οὐδὲ ἄλλος γε οὐδεὶς ἀνθρώπων. εἰπὲ γάρ μοι, ὦ

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Euthydemus asked whether it is a benefit for a sick person to drink medicine when he needs to, and whether in battle it is better to go wearing armour. Ctesippus agreed. “Indeed, since you accept that it is a benefit for a man to drink medicine when necessary, shouldn’t he simply drink this beneficial substance as much as possible? And in that case, would it be an advantage if someone were to grind and blend a wagon-load of hellebore for him?” Ctesippus replied, “Very much so, Euthydemus, particularly if the man who drinks it is the size of the big

statue at Delphi.” And in battle, since it is a benefit to wear armour, should we carry as many spears and shields as possible? Ctesippus quipped whether they would arm Geryon¹² and Briareus in this way.

Κτήσιππε, εἰ ἀγαθὸν νομίζεις εἶναι ἀσθενοῦντι φάρμακον πιεῖν ἢ οὐκ ἀγαθὸν εἶναι δοκεῖ σοι, ὅταν δέηται· ἢ εἰς πόλεμον ὅταν ἦ, ὅπλα ἔχοντα μᾶλλον ἰέναι ἢ ἄνοπλον.—ἔμοιγε, ἔφη. καίτοι οἶμαί τί σε τῶν καλῶν ἐρεῖν.—σὺ ἄριστα εἶση, ἔφη ἄλλ’ ἀποκρίνου. ἐπειδὴ γὰρ ὡμολόγεις ἀγαθὸν εἶναι φάρμακον, ὅταν δέη, πίνειν ἀνθρώπῳ, ἄλλο τι τοῦτο τὸ ἀγαθὸν ὥς πλεῖστον δεῖ πίνειν, καὶ καλῶς ἐκεῖ ἔξει, ἐάν τις αὐτῷ τρίψας ἐγκεράσῃ ἐλλεβόρου ἅμαξαν;—καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος εἶπεν· πάνυ γε σφόδρα, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, ἐὰν ἦ γε ὁ πίνων ὅσος ὁ ἀνδριάς ὁ ἐν Δελφοῖς.—οὐκοῦν, ἔφη, καὶ ἐν τῷ πολέμῳ ἐπειδὴ ἀγαθὸν ἐστὶν ὅπλα ἔχειν, ὥς πλεῖστα δεῖ ἔχειν δόρατά τε καὶ ἀσπίδας, ἐπειδὴ περ ἀγαθὸν ἐστὶν;—μᾶλα δήπου, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος· σὺ δ’ οὐκ οἶε, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, ἀλλὰ μίαν καὶ ἐν δόρῳ;—ἔγωγε.—ἦ καὶ τὸν Γηρυόνην ἄν, ἔφη, καὶ τὸν Βριάρεων οὕτως σὺ ὀπλίσαις; ἐγὼ δὲ ᾧμην σὲ δεινότερον εἶναι, ἅτε ὀπλομάχην ὄντα, καὶ τόνδε τὸν ἐταῖρον. καὶ ὁ μὲν Εὐθύδημος ἐσίγησεν ὁ δὲ Διονυσόδωρος πρὸς

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Then Dionysodorus asked whether it is a benefit to possess gold and to have benefits at all times and in all places. And should gold be especially in ourselves? “Would a person be supremely blessed if he were to have three talents of gold in his stomach, a talent in his skull, and a stater of gold in each eye?” Ctesippus retorted that the most blessed of the Scythians¹³, and their very best men, are the ones who have a lot of gold in their own skulls, and that they drink from their own gilded skulls. Then Euthydemus produced another ambiguity: the Scythians and others see what is ‘capable of vision’¹⁴ – which is ambiguous between ‘capable of seeing’ and ‘capable of being seen’ – and so our cloaks, being capable of being seen, are ‘capable of vision’. And do our cloaks see nothing? “To me, Euthydemus,” said Ctesippus, “you seem to have fallen asleep, without being asleep, and if it is possible to speak yet say nothing, that is just what you are doing.”

τὰ πρότερον ἀποκεκριμένα τῷ Κτησίππῳ ἦρετο, οὐκοῦν καὶ χρυσίον, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἀγαθὸν δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι ἔχειν;—πάνυ, καὶ ταῦτά γε πολὺ, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—τί οὖν; ἀγαθὰ οὐ δοκεῖ σοι χρῆναι ἀεὶ τ' ἔχειν καὶ πανταχοῦ;—σφόδρα γ', ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ χρυσίον ἀγαθὸν ὁμολογεῖς εἶναι;—ὡμολόγηκα μὲν οὖν, ἦ δ' ὅς.—οὐκοῦν ἀεὶ δεῖ αὐτὸ ἔχειν καὶ πανταχοῦ καὶ ὡς μάλιστα ἐν ἑαυτῷ; καὶ εἴη ἂν εὐδαιμονέστατος εἰ ἔχοι χρυσίου μὲν τρία τάλαντα ἐν τῇ γαστρί, τάλαντον δ' ἐν τῷ κρανίῳ, στατήρα δὲ χρυσοῦ ἐν ἑκατέρῳ τῷ φθαλμῷ;—φασὶ γε οὖν, ὦ Εὐθύδημε, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος, τούτους εὐδαιμονεστάτους εἶναι Σκυθῶν καὶ ἀρίστους ἄνδρας, οἱ χρυσίον τε ἐν τοῖς κρανίοις ἔχουσιν πολὺ τοῖς ἑαυτῶν, ὥσπερ σὺ νυνδὴ ἔλεγες τὸν κύνα τὸν πατέρα, καὶ ὁ θαυμασιώτερόν γε ἔτι, ὅτι καὶ πίνουσιν ἐκ τῶν ἑαυτῶν κρανίων κεχρυσωμένων, καὶ ταῦτα ἐντὸς καθορῶσιν, τὴν ἑαυτῶν κορυφὴν ἐν ταῖς χερσὶν ἔχοντες. ΣΩ. πότερον δὲ ὁρῶσιν, ἔφη ὁ Εὐθύδημος, καὶ Σκύθαι τε καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι ἄνθρωποι τὰ δυνατὰ ὁρᾶν ἢ τὰ ἀδύνατα;—τὰ δυνατὰ δήπου.—οὐκοῦν καὶ σύ, ἔφη;—κάγώ.—ὁρᾷς οὖν τὰ ἡμέτερα ἱμάτια;—ναί.—δυνατὰ οὖν ὁρᾶν ἐστὶν ταῦτα.—ὑπερφυῶς, ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος.—τί δέ; ἦ δ' ὅς.—μῆδέν. σὺ δὲ ἴσως οὐκ οἶε αὐτὰ ὁρᾶν οὕτως ἡδὺς εἶ. ἀλλὰ μοι δοκεῖς, Εὐθύδημε, οὐ καθεύδων ἐπικεκοιμησθαι καί, εἰ οἶόν τε λέγοντα μῆδέν λέγειν, καὶ σὺ τοῦτο ποιεῖν. ἦ γὰρ οὐχ οἶόν τ', ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, σιγῶντα λέγειν;—οὐδ' ὁπωστιοῦν, ἦ δ' ὅς ὁ Κτήσιππος.—ἄρ' οὐδὲ λέγοντα σιγᾶν;—ἔτι ἦττον, ἔφη.—ὅταν οὖν λίθους λέγῃς καὶ ξύλα καὶ σιδήρια, οὐ σιγῶντα λέγεις;—οὐκ οὐκ εἴ γε ἐγώ, ἔφη, παρέρχομαι ἐν τοῖς χαλκείοις, ἀλλὰ φθεγγόμενα καὶ βοῶντα μέγιστον τὰ σιδήρια λέγεται, ἐάν τις ἄψῃται· ὥστε τοῦτο μὲν ὑπὸ σοφίας ἔλαθες οὐδὲν εἰπών. ἀλλ' ἔτι μοι τὸ ἕτερον ἐπιδείξατον, ὅπως αὐτὸς ἔστιν λέγοντα σιγᾶν. καί μοι ἐδόκει ὑπεραγωνιᾶν ὁ Κτήσιππος διὰ τὰ παιδικά. ὅταν σιγᾷς, ἔφη ὁ Εὐθύδημος, οὐ πάντα σιγᾷς;—ἔγωγε, ἦ δ' ὅς.—οὐκοῦν καὶ τὰ λέγοντα σιγᾷς, εἴπερ τῶν ἀπάντων ἐστὶν τὰ λεγόμενα.—τί δέ; ἔφη ὁ Κτήσιππος, οὐ σιγᾷ πάντα;—οὐ δήπου, ἔφη ὁ Εὐθύδημος.—ἀλλ' ἄρα, ὦ βέλτιστε, λέγει τὰ πάντα;—τά γε δήπου λέγοντα.—ἀλλὰ, ἦ δ' ὅς, οὐ τοῦτο ἐρωτῶ, ἀλλὰ τὰ πάντα σιγᾷ ἢ λέγει;

The discussion moved to whether a speaking of what is silent¹⁵ is possible, and a silence of speaking. Euthydemus asked: when you are silent, are you silent in relation to all things? “I am.” Aren’t you also silent in relation to whatever speaks, if this is included in all things? And since the different is not silent, do all things speak? Dionysodorus jumped in with “Neither and both – yes, I know quite well that you will not be able to deal with this answer.” And Ctesippus, in his usual way, broke into very loud laughter and said, “Euthydemus, your brother has led the argument into a contradiction, and he has perished and been defeated.” Now, Clinias was extremely pleased, and he laughed, with the result that Ctesippus grew in stature tenfold.

οὐδέτερα καὶ ἀμφοτέρα, ἔφη ὑφαρπάσας ὁ Διονυσόδωρος· εὖ γὰρ οἶδα ὅτι τῇ ἀποκρίσει οὐχ ἔξεις ὅτι χρῆ. καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος, ὥσπερ εἰώθει, μέγα πάνυ ἀνακαγχάσας, ὧ Εὐθύδημε, ἔφη, ὁ ἀδελφός σου ἐξημποτέρικεν τὸν λόγον, καὶ ἀπόλωλέ τε καὶ ἤττηται. καὶ ὁ Κλεινίας πάνυ ἥσθη καὶ ἐγέλασεν, ὥστε ὁ Κτήσιππος ἐγένετο πλεῖον ἢ δεκαπλάσιος. ὁ δέ μοι δοκεῖ ἄτε πανοῦργος ὢν, ὁ Κτήσιππος, παρ’ αὐτῶν τούτων αὐτὰ ταῦτα παρηκηκῶει· οὐ γάρ ἐστιν ἄλλων τοιαύτη σοφία τῶν νῦν ἀνθρώπων.

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And I said, “Clinias, why are you laughing at matters that are so serious and beautiful?” “Well, Socrates,” said Dionysodorus, “have you ever yet seen a beautiful matter?” “Yes, I have, Dionysodorus, lots of them.” “So are they different from the beautiful, or the same as the beautiful?” And I became utterly perplexed, but I said they were different from the beautiful, although some beauty is present with each of them. “So, if an ox is present with you, you are an ox, and because I am present with you now, you are Dionysodorus?” “What a thing to say,” said I. “But what way could the different be different, just because difference is present with difference?” I asked if the beautiful is not beautiful and the base not base? “If it seems so to me.” “And indeed the two of you seem to me to bring the process of dialectic to fruition, just like craftsmen who bring their appropriate work to fruition.”

κάγὼ εἶπον· τί γελαῖς, ὦ Κλεινία, ἐπὶ σπουδαίοις οὕτω πράγμασιν καὶ καλοῖς; σὺ γὰρ ἤδη τι πώποτ' εἶδες, ὦ Σώκρατες, καλὸν πρᾶγμα; ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος. ἔγωγε, ἔφην, καὶ πολλὰ γε, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε. ΣΩ. ἄρα ἕτερα ὄντα τοῦ καλοῦ, ἔφη, ἢ ταῦτα τῷ καλῷ; κάγὼ ἐν παντὶ ἐγενόμην ὑπὸ ἀπορίας, καὶ ἡγούμην δίκαια πεπονθέναι ὅτι ἔγρυξα, ὅμως δὲ ἕτερα ἔφην αὐτοῦ γε τοῦ καλοῦ· πάρεστιν μέντοι ἐκάστῳ αὐτῶν κάλλος τι. ἐὰν οὖν, ἔφη, παραγένηται σοι βοῦς, βοῦς εἶ, καὶ ὅτι νῦν ἐγὼ σοι πάρειμι, Διονυσόδωρος εἶ; εὐφήμει τοῦτό γε, ἦν δ' ἐγώ. ἀλλὰ τίνα τρόπον, ἔφη, ἐτέρου ἐτέρῳ παραγενομένου τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερον ἂν εἴη; ἄρα τοῦτο, ἔφην ἐγώ, ἀπορεῖς; ἤδη δὲ τοῖν ἀνδροῖν τὴν σοφίαν ἐπεχείρουν μιμεῖσθαι, ἅτε ἐπιθυμῶν αὐτῆς. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἀπορῶ, ἔφη, καὶ ἐγὼ καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι ἅπαντες ἄνθρωποι ὃ μὴ ἔστι; τί λέγεις, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε; οὐ τὸ καλὸν καλόν ἐστιν καὶ τὸ αἰσχρὸν αἰσχρόν;—ἐὰν ἔμοιγε, ἔφη, δοκῇ.—οὐκοῦν δοκεῖ;—πάνυ γ', ἔφη.—οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ταῦτόν ταῦτόν καὶ τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερον; οὐ γὰρ δήπου τό γε ἕτερον ταῦτόν, ἀλλ'

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Then Dionysodorus led me into another trap: to whom is brass-working appropriate? To the brass-workers. Making pots? To the potters. Cutting up, skinning¹⁶, boiling or roasting the portions of meat once cut up? To the cook. And if someone enacts what is appropriate, isn't he acting aright? So if someone slaughters the cook, cuts him up and boils and roasts him, he will be acting aright? "By Poseidon," said I, "at this stage you are putting the finishing touches to your wisdom. I wonder, will it ever be mine, and become my own?" Then through steps about what things are mine (those I can sell, give away or sacrifice), and about living creatures (those that have soul), and about my ancestral gods Apollo¹⁷, Zeus and Athena being mine and living creatures, he asked: since you have agreed that Zeus and the other gods are yours, are you allowed to sell them, or give them away, or treat them as you wish, just like any other living creatures?

ἔγωγε οὐδ' ἂν παῖδα ᾧμην τοῦτο ἀπορῆσαι, ὥς οὐ τὸ ἕτερον ἕτερόν ἐστιν. ἀλλ', ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, τοῦτο μὲν ἐκὼν παρήκας, ἐπεὶ τὰ ἄλλα μοι

δοκεῖτε ὥσπερ οἱ δημιουργοὶ οἷς ἕκαστα προσήκει ἀπεργάζεσθαι, καὶ ὑμεῖς τὸ διαλέγεσθαι παγκάλως ἀπεργάζεσθαι. οἷσθα οὖν, ἔφη, ὅτι προσήκει ἐκάστοις τῶν δημιουργῶν; πρῶτον τίνα χαλκεύειν προσήκει, οἷσθα;—ἔγωγε· ὅτι χαλκέα.—τί δέ, κεραμεύειν;—κεραμέα.—τί δέ, σφάττειν τε καὶ ἐκδέρειν καὶ τὰ μικρὰ κρέα κατακόψαντα ἔψειν καὶ ὀπτᾶν; μάγειρον, ἦν δ' ἐγώ.—οὐκοῦν ἐάν τις, ἔφη, τὰ προσήκοντα πράττη, ὀρθῶς πράξει;—μάλιστα.—προσήκει δέ γε, ὡς φῆς, τὸν μάγειρον κατακόπτειν καὶ ἐκδέρειν; ὠμολόγησας ταῦτα ἦ οὐ;—ὠμολόγησα, ἔφην, ἀλλὰ συγγνώμην μοι ἔχε.—δῆλον τοίνυν, ἦ δ' ὅς, ὅτι ἂν τις σφάξας τὸν μάγειρον καὶ κατακόψας ἐψήσῃ καὶ ὀπτήσῃ, τὰ προσήκοντα ποιήσῃ καὶ ἐάν τὸν χαλκέα τις αὐτὸν χαλκεύῃ καὶ τὸν κεραμέα κεραμεύῃ, καὶ οὗτος τὰ προσήκοντα πράξει. ὦ Πόσειδον, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ἥδη κολοφῶνα ἐπιτιθεῖς τῇ σοφίᾳ. ἄρ' ἀνὰ μοί ποτε αὕτη παραγενήσεται ὥστε μοι οἰκεία γενέσθαι; ἐπιγνοίης ἂν αὐτήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔφη, οἰκείαν γενομένην; ἐάν σύ γε βούλῃ, ἔφην ἐγώ, δῆλον ὅτι. τί δέ, ἦ δ' ὅς, τὰ σαυτοῦ οἶε γινώσκειν; εἰ μὴ τι σὺ ἄλλο λέγεις· ἀπὸ σοῦ γὰρ δεῖ ἄρχεσθαι, τελευτᾶν δ' εἰς Εὐθύδημον τόνδε. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν, ἔφη, ταῦτα ἡγῇ σὰ εἶναι, ὧν ἂν ἄρξης καὶ ἐξῇ σοι αὐτοῖς χρῆσθαι ὅτι ἂν βούλῃ; οἷον βοῦς καὶ πρόβατον, ἄρ' ἂν ἡγοῖο ταῦτα σὰ εἶναι, ἃ σοι ἐξεῖν καὶ ἀποδόσθαι καὶ δοῦναι καὶ θῦσαι ὅτῳ βούλοιο θεῶν; ἢ δ' ἂν μὴ οὕτως ἔχῃ, οὐ σά; κἀγώ (ἥδη γὰρ ὅτι ἐξ αὐτῶν καλὸν τι ἀνακύψοιτο τῶν ἐρωτημάτων, καὶ ἅμα βουλόμενος ὅτι τάχιστ' ἀκούσαι) πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ἔφην, οὕτως ἔχει· τὰ τοιαῦτά ἐστιν μόνα ἐμά.—τί δέ; ζῶα, ἔφη, οὐ ταῦτα καλεῖς ἢ ἂν ψυχὴν ἔχῃ; ναί, ἔφην.—ὁμολογεῖς οὖν τῶν ζώων ταῦτα μόνα εἶναι σά, περὶ ἃ ἂν σοι ἐξουσία ἦ πάντα ταῦτα ποιεῖν ἃ νυνδὴ ἐγὼ ἔλεγον;—ὁμολογῶ.—καὶ ὅς, εἰρωνικῶς πάνυ ἐπισχὼν ὥς τι μέγα σκοπούμενος, εἶπέ μοι, ἔφη, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔστιν σοι Ζεὺς πατρῷος;—καὶ ἐγὼ ὑποπτεύσας ἤξειν τὸν λόγον οἷπερ ἐτελεύτησεν, ἀπορὸν τινα στροφὴν ἔφευγόν τε καὶ ἐστρεφόμεν ἥδη ὥσπερ ἐν δικτύῳ εἰλημμένος· οὐκ ἔστιν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε.—ταλαίπωρος ἄρα τις σύ γε ἄνθρωπος εἶ καὶ οὐδὲ Ἀθηναῖος, ὧ μῆτε θεοὶ πατρῷοί εἰσιν μῆτε ἱερὰ μῆτε ἄλλο μηδὲν καλὸν καὶ ἀγαθόν.—ἔα, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, ὦ Διονυσόδωρε, εὐφήμει τε καὶ μὴ χαλεπῶς με προδίδασκε. ἔστι γὰρ ἔμοιγε καὶ βωμοὶ

καὶ ἱερὰ οἰκεῖα καὶ πατρῷα καὶ τὰ ἄλλα ὅσαπερ τοῖς ἄλλοις Ἀθηναίοις τῶν τοιούτων.—εἶτα τοῖς ἄλλοις, ἔφη, Ἀθηναίοις οὐκ ἔστιν Ζεὺς ὁ πατρῷος;—οὐκ ἔστιν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, αὕτη ἡ ἐπωνυμία Ἰώνων οὐδενί, οὔθ' ὅσοι ἐκ τῆσδε τῆς πόλεως ἀπωκισμένοι εἰσὶν οὔθ' ἡμῖν, ἀλλὰ Ἀπόλλων πατρῷος διὰ τὴν τοῦ Ἰωνος γένεσιν· Ζεὺς δ' ἡμῖν πατρῷος μὲν οὐ καλεῖται, ἔρκειος δὲ καὶ φράτριος, καὶ Ἀθηναία φρατρία.—ἀλλ' ἄρκεϊ γ', ἔφη ὁ Διονυσόδωρος· ἔστιν γάρ σοι, ὡς ἔοικεν, Ἀπόλλων τε καὶ Ζεὺς καὶ Ἀθηνᾶ.—πάνυ, ἦν δ' ἐγώ.—οὐκοῦν καὶ οὗτοι σοὶ θεοὶ ἂν εἶεν; ἔφη.—πρόγονοι, ἦν δ' ἐγώ, καὶ δεσπόται.—ἀλλ' οὖν σοὶ γε, ἔφη ἡ οὐ σοὺς ὠμολόγηκας αὐτοὺς εἶναι;—ὠμολόγηκα, ἔφην· τί γὰρ πάθω;—οὐκοῦν, ἔφη, καὶ ζῶα εἰσιν οὗτοι οἱ θεοί; ὠμολόγηκας γὰρ ὅσα ψυχὴν ἔχει ζῶα εἶναι. ἢ οὗτοι οἱ θεοὶ οὐκ ἔχουσιν ψυχὴν;—ἔχουσιν, ἦν δ' ἐγώ.—οὐκοῦν καὶ ζῶα εἰσιν;—ζῶα, ἔφην.—τῶν δέ γε ζώων, ἔφη, ὠμολόγηκας ταῦτ' εἶναι σά, ὅσα ἂν σοι ἐξῇ καὶ δοῦναι καὶ ἀποδόσθαι καὶ θῆσαι δὴ θεῶ ὅτῳ ἂν βούλῃ.—ὠμολόγηκα, ἔφην· οὐκ ἔστιν γάρ μοι ἀνάδυσσις, ὦ Εὐθύδημε. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ μοι εὐθύς, ἦ δ' ὅς, εἰπέ· ἐπειδὴ σὸν ὁμολογεῖς εἶναι τὸν Δία

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Well, Crito, while I lay there speechless, as though I had been felled by the argument, Ctesippus came to my aid saying, “Bravo Heracles, what a good argument.” And Dionysodorus asked, “Is Heracles a bravo, or a bravo Heracles?” And Ctesippus responded, “By Poseidon, what formidable arguments. I give up. The two men are invincible.”

καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους θεοὺς, ἄρα ἔξεστί σοι αὐτοὺς ἀποδόσθαι ἢ δοῦναι ἢ ἄλλ' ὅτι ἂν βούλῃ χρῆσθαι ὥσπερ τοῖς ἄλλοις ζώοις; ἐγώ μὲν οὖν, ὦ Κρίτων, ὥσπερ πληγείς ὑπὸ τοῦ λόγου, ἐκείμην ἄφωνος· ὁ δὲ Κτήσιππος μοι ἰὼν ὡς βοηθήσων, Πυππᾶξ ὦ Ἡράκλεις, ἔφη, καλοῦ λόγου.—καὶ ὁ Διονυσόδωρος, πότερον οὖν, ἔφη, ὁ Ἡρακλῆς πυππᾶξ ἐστὶν ἢ ὁ πυππᾶξ Ἡρακλῆς;—καὶ ὁ Κτήσιππος, ὦ Πόσειδον, ἔφη, δεινῶν λόγων. ἀφίσταμαι ἀμάχῳ τῷ ἄνδρῃ.

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With that, dear Crito, I must say that there was no one present who did not heap praises upon the two men and their argument. Indeed, they almost died laughing, clapping and rejoicing. Now even the very

columns of the Lyceum came close to applause and delight at these two men. As for myself, I was reduced to admitting that no one had ever before beheld any people who were as wise as they were, and being utterly captivated by the wisdom of the pair, I took to praising and eulogising them both, saying: “You are two blessed men, possessed of a wondrous nature, who have perfected such a subject so readily in such a short period of time. The most exalted of your arguments is that you have no concern for most of humanity, nor indeed for important people or those with a reputation, but only for those who are similar to yourselves. For I know quite well that there are very few people similar to yourselves who would be content with these arguments, while everyone else is so unappreciative of them that they would be more ashamed to refute others by such arguments than to be refuted themselves.”

ἐνταῦθα μέντοι, ὦ φίλε Κρίτων, οὐδεὶς ὅστις οὐ τῶν παρόντων ὑπερεπήνεσε τὸν λόγον καὶ τὸν ἄνδρα, καὶ γελῶντες καὶ κροτοῦντες καὶ χαίροντες ὀλίγου παρετάθησαν. ἐπὶ μὲν γὰρ τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν ἐφ’ ἐκάστοις πᾶσι παγκάλως ἐθορύβουν μόνοι οἱ τοῦ Εὐθυδήμου ἔρασταί, ἐνταῦθα δὲ ὀλίγου καὶ οἱ κίονες οἱ ἐν τῷ Λυκείῳ ἐθορύβησάν τ’ ἐπὶ τοῖν ἀνδροῖν καὶ ἤσθησαν. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν καὶ αὐτὸς οὕτω διετέτην, ὥστε ὁμολογεῖν μηδένας πώποτε ἀνθρώπους ἰδεῖν οὕτω σοφούς, καὶ παντάπασι καταδουλωθεὶς ὑπὸ τῆς σοφίας αὐτοῖν ἐπὶ τὸ ἐπαινεῖν τε καὶ ἐγκωμιάζειν αὐτῷ ἐτραπόμην, καὶ εἶπον· ὦ μακάριοι σφὼ τῆς θαυμαστῆς φύσεως, οἳ τοσοῦτον πρᾶγμα οὕτω ταχὺ καὶ ἐν ὀλίγῳ χρόνῳ ἐξεύργασθον. πολλὰ μὲν οὖν καὶ ἄλλα οἱ λόγοι ὑμῶν καλὰ ἔχουσιν, ὦ Εὐθύδημέ τε καὶ Διονυσόδωρε· ἐν δὲ τοῖς καὶ τοῦτο μεγαλοπρεπέστατον, ὅτι τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ τῶν σεμνῶν δὴ καὶ δοκούντων

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I continued: “There is also an appealing and kindly aspect to your arguments. Whenever you declare that there is nothing beautiful, nothing good or white, and so on, and that nothing is at all different from anything else, you simply stitch up people’s mouths well and

truly. Yet, because you don't just do this to others but you seem also to do it to your own mouths, this is entirely delightful and it takes away the offensive aspect of the arguments. And yet, what is most significant is that you have arranged matters and contrived them so skilfully that anyone at all can learn this in a short period of time. I realised this myself by paying attention to Ctesippus, and how quickly he was able to imitate you without any preparation. Now, the fact that this business of yours is readily imparted is all very well, but it is not appropriate for discussion before a general audience. It is best, rather, that the two of you conduct your discussions only with one another. Failing that, it should be someone who is paying you a fee. And if you are sensible, you will also give the same advice to your pupils: never to conduct a discussion with anyone else. For whatever is scarce is valuable, Euthydemus, while water is cheapest, although it is the best, as Pindar says."

τί εἶναι οὐδὲν ὑμῖν μέλει, ἀλλὰ τῶν ὁμοίων ὑμῖν μόνον. ἐγὼ γὰρ εὖ οἶδα ὅτι τούτους τοὺς λόγους πάνυ μὲν ἂν ὀλίγοι ἀγαπῶεν ἄνθρωποι ὅμοιοι ὑμῖν, οἱ δ' ἄλλοι οὕτως ἀγνοοῦσιν αὐτούς, ὥστ' εὖ οἶδα ὅτι αἰσχυρθεῖεν ἂν μᾶλλον ἐξελέγχοντες τοιοῦτοις λόγοις τοὺς ἄλλους ἢ αὐτοὶ ἐξελεγχόμενοι. καὶ τότε αὖ ἕτερον δημοτικόν τι καὶ πρᾶγον ἐν τοῖς λόγοις· ὁπότεν φῆτε μήτε καλὸν εἶναι μηδὲν μήτε ἀγαθὸν πρᾶγμα μήτε λευκὸν μηδ' ἄλλο τῶν τοιούτων μηδέν, μηδὲ τὸ παράπαν ἐτέρων ἕτερον, ἀτεχνῶς μὲν τῷ ὄντι συρράπτετε τὰ στόματα τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ὥσπερ καὶ φατέ· ὅτι δ' οὐ μόνον τὰ τῶν ἄλλων, ἀλλὰ δόξατε ἂν καὶ τὰ ὑμέτερα αὐτῶν, τοῦτο πάνυ χαρίεν τέ ἐστίν καὶ τὸ ἐπαχθὲς τῶν λόγων ἀφαιρεῖται. τὸ δὲ δὴ μέγιστον, ὅτι ταῦτα οὕτως ἔχει ὑμῖν καὶ τεχνικῶς ἐξηύρηται, ὥστ' ἐν πάνυ ὀλίγῳ χρόνῳ ὄντιν οὖν ἂν μαθεῖν ἀνθρώπων· ἔγνω ἔγωγε καὶ τῷ Κτησίππῳ τὸν νοῦν προσέχων ὥς ταχὺ ὑμᾶς ἐκ τοῦ παραχρήμα μιμεῖσθαι οἷός τε ἦν. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν τοῦ πράγματος σφῶν τὸ σοφὸν πρὸς μὲν τὸ ταχὺ παραδιδόναι καλόν, ἐναντίον δ' ἀνθρώπων διαλέγεσθαι οὐκ ἐπιτήδειον, ἀλλ' ἂν γέ μοι πείθησθε, εὐλαβήσεσθε μὴ πολλῶν ἐναντίον λέγειν, ἵνα μὴ ταχὺ ἐκμαθόντες ὑμῖν μὴ εἰδῶσιν χάριν. ἀλλὰ μάλιστα μὲν αὐτῷ πρὸς ἀλλήλῳ μόνῳ

διαλέγεσθον· εἰ δὲ μή, εἴπερ ἄλλου του ἐναντίον, ἐκείνου μόνου ὃς ἂν ὑμῖν διδῶ ἀργύριον. τὰ αὐτὰ δὲ ταῦτα, ἐὰν

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S: Having discussed all this, Crito, and some other issues that took less time, we departed. Now, you should consider how you are going to join us as a pupil of these two men who claim to be able to teach anyone who is willing to pay them, and who say that neither a person's nature nor his age prevents anyone at all from easily acquiring their wisdom. And it is most important for you to hear that, according to them, this wisdom is not an impediment to making money.

σωφρονῆτε, καὶ τοῖς μαθηταῖς συμβουλευέσете, μηδέποτε μηδενὶ ἀνθρώπων διαλέγεσθαι ἄλλ' ἢ ὑμῖν τε καὶ αὐτοῖς· τὸ γὰρ σπάνιον, ὃ Εὐθύδημε, τίμιον, τὸ δὲ ὕδωρ εὐωνότατον, ἄριστον ὄν, ὡς ἔφη Πίνδαρος. ἄλλ' ἄγετε, ἣν δ' ἐγώ, ὅπως κάμῃ καὶ Κλεινίαν τόνδε παραδέξεσθον. ταῦτα, ὃ Κρίτων, καὶ ἄλλα ἅττα ἔτι βραχέα διαλεχθέντες ἀπῆμεν. σκόπει οὖν ὅπως συμφοιτήσεις παρὰ τῷ

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CR: Well, Socrates, although I myself love listening to discussions, and would be pleased to learn something, I fear that I too am one of those people who would prefer being refuted by such arguments as these, rather than refuting someone else. Now, although it seems ridiculous to be giving you a warning, I want to report what I heard nevertheless. The fact is that one of the people coming from your gathering approached me as I was out and about, a man who regards himself as extremely wise, a formidable figure when it comes to writing speeches for use in law courts. "Crito," said he, "are you taking no lessons from these wise men?" I replied that when I was standing near them I was unable to hear clearly because of the crowd. "And yet," said he, "it was worth hearing, at any rate." I asked what his overall impression was. "It was just the sort of thing you always hear from people like this, babbling and making a useless fuss about nothing of any consequence."

ἄνδρε, ὡς ἐκείνω φατὸν οἶω τε εἶναι διδάξαι τὸν ἐθέλοντ' ἀργύριον διδόναι, καὶ οὔτε φύσιν οὔθ' ἡλικίαν ἐξείργειν οὐδεμίαν—ὃ δὲ καὶ σοὶ μάλιστα προσήκει ἀκοῦσαι, ὅτι οὐδὲ τοῦ χρηματίζεσθαί φατον διακωλύειν οὐδέν—μὴ οὐ παραλαβεῖν ὄντινοῦν εὐπετῶς τὴν σφετέραν σοφίαν. ΚΡ. καὶ μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, φιλήκοος μὲν ἔγωγε καὶ ἡδέως ἂν τι μανθάνοιμι, κινδυνεύω μέντοι κάγω εἰς εἶναι τῶν οὐχ ὁμοίων Εὐθυδήμῳ, ἀλλ' ἐκείνων ὧν δὴ καὶ σὺ

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CR: And I said, “But surely philosophy is something graceful?” “Graceful in what way, blessed man?” he asked. “It is of no value at all. And had you actually been there, I think you would have been utterly ashamed on behalf of your own friend, so strangely did he behave, willing to surrender himself to men who care not what they say, and fasten upon every word that is spoken. And these fellows are counted among the most influential people of this day and age. But the fact is, Crito, that the subject itself, and the people who devote their time to the subject, are worthless and ridiculous.” Now, Socrates, it did not seem right to me for him or anyone else to criticise the subject. However, it did seem right to apportion blame for your willingness to engage in discourse with such people as these, in front of a large audience.

ἔλεγες, τῶν ἥδιον ἂν ἐξελεγχομένων ὑπὸ τῶν τοιούτων λόγων ἢ ἐξελεγχόντων. ἀτὰρ γελοῖον μέν μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι τὸ νουθετεῖν σε, ὅμως δέ, ἃ γ' ἤκουον, ἐθέλω σοι ἀπαγγεῖλαι. τῶν ἀφ' ὑμῶν ἀπιόντων ἴσθ' ὅτι προσελθὼν τίς μοι περιπατοῦντι, ἀνὴρ οἰόμενος πάνυ εἶναι σοφός, τούτων τις τῶν περὶ τοὺς λόγους τοὺς εἰς τὰ δικαστήρια δεινῶν, ὦ Κρίτων, ἔφη, οὐδὲν ἀκροᾷ τῶνδε τῶν σοφῶν;—οὐ μὰ τὸν Δία, ἦν δ' ἐγώ· οὐ γὰρ οἷός τ' ἦ προσστὰς κατακούειν ὑπὸ τοῦ ὄχλου.—καὶ μὴν, ἔφη, ἀξιόν γ' ἦν ἀκοῦσαι.—τί δέ; ἦν δ' ἐγώ.—ἵνα ἤκουσας ἀνδρῶν διαλεγομένων οἱ νῦν σοφώτατοί εἰσι τῶν περὶ τοὺς τοιούτους λόγους.—κάγω εἶπον· τί οὖν ἐφαίνοντό σοι;—τί δὲ ἄλλο, ἦ δ' ὅς, ἢ οἷά περ αἰεὶ ἂν τις τῶν τοιούτων ἀκούσαι ληρούντων καὶ περὶ οὐδενὸς ἀξίων ἀναξίαν σπουδὴν ποιουμένων; (οὕτως γὰρ πῶς καὶ εἶπεν τοῖς ὀνόμασιν).—καὶ

ἐγώ, ἀλλὰ μέντοι, ἔφην, χαρίεν γέ τι πρᾶγμα ἐστὶν ἡ φιλοσοφία. ΚΡ.
ποῖον, ἔφη, χαρίεν, ὦ

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S: Crito, men like these are marvels. However, I do not yet know what I am to say to you. What sort of person was he who approached you and apportioned blame to philosophy? Was he one of the formidable combatants from the law courts, a rhetorician? Or was he one of the people who sends them into battle, a composer of speeches with which the rhetoricians engage in combat?

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CR: By Zeus, he is not a rhetorician at all, nor do I think he has ever appeared in court. Yet they say he understands the business, and that he is formidable, and composes formidable speeches.

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S: Now I understand. I was just about to speak about these people myself. For although they are, according to Prodicus, on the boundary between the philosopher and the statesman, they think that they are the wisest men of all. And they believe that the only thing preventing them from being well regarded by everyone are people who engage in philosophy. So they believe that if they reduce the reputation of these people, and make them seem worthless, the victory prize will indisputably be theirs immediately, a reputation for wisdom in the eyes of all. So they maintain that they are in truth the wisest, and whenever they get tangled up in arguments of a private nature, that they are being worsted by Euthydemus and his followers. Yet they believe quite plausibly that they are extremely wise for they possess a measure of philosophy and a measure of statesmanship. So, remaining aloof from danger and conflict, they reap the harvest of wisdom.

μακάριε; οὐδενὸς μὲν οὖν ἄξιον. ἀλλὰ καὶ εἰ νῦν παρεγένου, πάνυ ἂν σε οἶμαι αἰσχυνοῦσθαι ὑπὲρ τοῦ σεαυτοῦ ἐταίρου· οὕτως ἦν ἄτοπος, ἐθέλων ἑαυτὸν παρέχειν ἀνθρώποις οἷς οὐδὲν μέλει ὅτι ἂν λέγωσιν, παντὸς δὲ ῥήματος ἀντέχονται. καὶ οὗτοι, ὅπερ ἄρτι ἔλεγον, ἐν τοῖς κράτιστοῖς εἰσι τῶν νῦν. ἀλλὰ γάρ, ὦ Κρίτων, ἔφη, τὸ πρᾶγμα αὐτὸ καὶ οἱ ἄνθρωποι οἱ

ἐπὶ τῷ πράγματι διατρίβοντες φαῦλοί εἰσιν καὶ καταγέλαστοι. ἐμοὶ δέ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸ πρᾶγμα ἐδόκει οὐκ ὀρθῶς ψέγειν οὐθ' οὗτος οὐτ' εἴ τις ἄλλος ψέγει· τὸ μέντοι ἐθέλειν διαλέγεσθαι τοιούτοις ἐναντίον πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων ὀρθῶς μοι ἐδόκει μέμφεσθαι. ΣΩ. ὦ Κρίτων, θαυμάσιοί εἰσιν οἱ τοιοῦτοι ἄνδρες. ἀτὰρ οὐπω οἶδα ὅτι μέλλω ἐρεῖν. ποτέρων ἦν ὁ προσελθὼν σοι καὶ μεμφόμενος τὴν φιλοσοφίαν; πότερον τῶν ἀγωνίσασθαι δεινῶν ἐν τοῖς δικαστηρίοις, ῥήτωρ τις, ἢ τῶν τοὺς τοιούτους εἰσπεμπόντων, ποιητῆς τῶν λόγων οἷς οἱ ῥήτορες ἀγωνίζονται; ΚΡ. ἥκιστα νῆ τὸν Δία ῥήτωρ, οὐδὲ οἶμαι πώποτ' αὐτὸν ἐπὶ δικαστήριον ἀναβεβηκέναι· ἀλλ' ἐπαΐειν αὐτόν φασι περὶ τοῦ πράγματος νῆ τὸν Δία καὶ δεινὸν εἶναι καὶ δεινοὺς λόγους συντιθέναι. ΣΩ. ἤδη μανθάνω· περὶ τούτων καὶ αὐτὸς νυνδὴ ἔμελλον λέγειν. οὗτοι γάρ εἰσιν μὲν, ὦ Κρίτων, οὓς ἔφη Πρόδικος μεθόρια φιλοσόφου τε ἀνδρὸς καὶ πολιτικοῦ, οἶονται δ' εἶναι πάντων σοφώτατοι ἀνθρώπων, πρὸς δὲ τῷ εἶναι καὶ δοκεῖν πάνυ παρὰ πολλοῖς, ὥστε παρὰ πᾶσιν εὐδοκιμεῖν ἐμποδῶν σφίσιν εἶναι οὐδένας ἄλλους ἢ τοὺς περὶ φιλοσοφίαν ἀνθρώπους. ἡγοῦνται οὖν, ἐὰν τούτους εἰς δόξαν καταστήσωσιν μηδενὸς δοκεῖν ἀξίους εἶναι, ἀναμφισβητήτως ἥδη παρὰ πᾶσιν τὰ νικητήρια εἰς δόξαν οἷσεσθαι σοφίας πέρι. εἶναι μὲν γὰρ τῇ ἀληθείᾳ σφᾶς σοφωτάτους, ἐν δὲ τοῖς ἰδίους λόγοις ὅταν ἀποληφθῶσιν, ὑπὸ τῶν ἀμφὶ Εὐθύδημον κολούεσθαι. σοφοὶ δὲ ἡγοῦνται εἶναι πάνυ—εἰκότως· μετρίως μὲν γὰρ φιλοσοφίας ἔχειν, μετρίως δὲ πολιτικῶν, πάνυ ἐξ εἰκότος λόγου—μετέχειν γὰρ ἀμφοτέρων ὅσον ἔδει, ἐκτὸς δὲ ὄντες κινδύνων καὶ ἀγώνων καρποῦσθαι τὴν σοφίαν. ΚΡ. τί οὖν; δοκοῦσί σοι τι, ὦ Σώκρατες, λέγειν; οὐ γάρ τοι ἀλλὰ ὅ γε λόγος ἔχει τινὰ εὐπρέπειαν τῶν ἀνδρῶν. ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ ἔχει ὄντως, ὦ Κρίτων, εὐπρέπειαν μᾶλλον

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CR: What of it, Socrates? Do you think they have a point since their argument does have a certain neatness at least?

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S: Yes, indeed, Crito, it does indeed possess neatness rather than truth. For if philosophy is good, and so too is the activity of the statesman,

each in a different respect, and these fellows are in between those two since they partake of both, then they do not have a point since they are inferior with respect to both. And if one is good and the other bad, then they are better with respect to one group and worse with respect to the other. But if both are bad, in that case and in no other, they would be speaking the truth to an extent. But the fact of the matter is that these fellows, although they partake of both, are inferior with respect to both, with respect to what is of value in statesmanship and what is of value in philosophy, and despite being, in truth, in third place, they are ambitious to be regarded as first. So we should forgive this ambition of theirs and not be troubled, yet still recognise that they are the sort of people they are. For we ought to admire any man whatsoever who says anything that conforms to good sense and takes the trouble to pursue it courageously.

ἡ ἀλήθειαν. οὐ γὰρ ῥάδιον αὐτοὺς πείσαι ὅτι καὶ ἄνθρωποι καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα ὅσα μεταξύ τινοῖν δυοῖν ἐστὶν καὶ ἀμφοτέρω τυχάνει μετέχοντα, ὅσα μὲν ἐκ κακοῦ καὶ ἀγαθοῦ, τοῦ μὲν βελτίω, τοῦ δὲ χείρω γίνονται· ὅσα δὲ ἐκ δυοῖν ἀγαθῶν μὴ πρὸς ταῦτόν, ἀμφοῖν χείρω πρὸς ὃ ἂν ἐκάτερον ἢ χρηστόν ἐκείνων ἐξ ὧν συνετέθη· ὅσα δ' ἐκ δυοῖν κακοῖν συνεθέντα μὴ πρὸς τὸ αὐτὸ ὄντοιν ἐν τῷ μέσῳ ἐστίν, ταῦτα μόνον βελτίω ἐκατέρου ἐκείνων ἐστίν, ὧν ἀμφοτέρων μέρος μετέχουσιν. εἰ μὲν οὖν ἡ φιλοσοφία ἀγαθὸν ἐστὶν καὶ ἡ πολιτικὴ πρᾶξις, πρὸς ἄλλο δὲ ἐκάτερα, οὗτοι δ' ἀμφοτέρων μετέχοντες τούτων ἐν μέσῳ εἰσὶν, οὐδὲν λέγουσιν—ἀμφοτέρων γὰρ εἰσι φαυλότεροι—εἰ δὲ ἀγαθὸν καὶ κακόν, τῶν μὲν βελτίους, τῶν δὲ χείρους· εἰ δὲ κακὰ ἀμφοτέρω, οὕτως ἂν τι λέγοιεν ἀληθές, ἄλλως δ' οὐδαμῶς. οὐκ ἂν οὖν οἶμαι αὐτοὺς ὁμολογῆσαι οὔτε κακῶ αὐτῷ ἀμφοτέρω εἶναι οὔτε τὸ μὲν κακόν, τὸ δὲ ἀγαθόν· ἀλλὰ τῷ ὄντι οὗτοι ἀμφοτέρων μετέχοντες ἀμφοτέρων ἥττους εἰσὶν πρὸς ἐκάτερον πρὸς ὃ ἢ τε πολιτικὴ καὶ ἡ φιλοσοφία ἀξίω λόγου ἐστών, καὶ τρίτοι ὄντες τῇ ἀληθείᾳ ζητοῦσι πρῶτοι δοκεῖν εἶναι. συγγιγνώσκω μὲν οὖν αὐτοῖς χρὴ τῆς ἐπιθυμίας καὶ μὴ χαλεπαίνειν, ἡγεῖσθαι μέντοι τοιούτους εἶναι οἷοί εἰσιν· πάντα γὰρ ἄνδρα χρὴ ἀγαπᾶν ὅστις καὶ ὅτιοῦν λέγει ἐχόμενον

306d

CR: Yes, indeed, Socrates, and I myself, as I am always telling you, am perplexed over my sons and how I should deal with them. Now, one of them is still young and little, but Critobulus is now at an age where he needs someone who will do something for him. Now, whenever I am in your company, you always have the same effect. I think that it is madness to have taken such trouble in so many different ways for the sake of my children – trouble in relation to marriage to ensure noble birth on their mother's side, and trouble over making money – whilst I neglected their education. Yet, whenever I look at any of those people who profess to educate humanity, I am shocked, and each one of them seems to me, on reflection, to be utterly outlandish, to tell you the truth between ourselves. And so I do not know how I am to turn the young man towards philosophy.

φρονήσεως πράγμα καὶ ἀνδρείως ἐπεξίων διαπονεῖται. ΚΡ. καὶ μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, καὶ αὐτὸς περὶ τῶν υἱῶν, ὥσπερ ἀεὶ πρὸς σε λέγω, ἐν ἀπορίᾳ εἰμὶ τί δεῖ αὐτοῖς χρήσασθαι. ὁ μὲν οὖν νεώτερος ἔτι καὶ σμικρὸς ἐστίν, Κριτόβουλος δ' ἤδη ἡλικίαν ἔχει καὶ δεῖται τινος ὅστις αὐτὸν ὀνήσει. ἐγὼ μὲν οὖν ὅταν σοὶ συγγένωμαι, οὕτω διατίθεμαι ὥστ' ἐμοὶ δοκεῖ μανίαν εἶναι τὸ ἔνεκα τῶν παίδων ἄλλων μὲν πολλῶν σπουδὴν τοιαύτην ἐσχικέναι, καὶ περὶ τοῦ γάμου ὅπως ἐκ γενναιοτάτης ἔσονται μητρός, καὶ περὶ τῶν χρημάτων ὅπως ὡς πλουσιώτατοι, αὐτῶν δὲ περὶ παιδείας ἀμελῆσαι. ὅταν δὲ εἷς τινα ἀποβλέψω τῶν φασκόντων ἂν παιδεῦσαι ἀνθρώπους, ἐκπέπληγμαι καὶ μοι δοκεῖ εἷς ἕκαστος αὐτῶν σκοποῦντι πάντῃ ἀλλόκοτος εἶναι,

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S: Crito, my friend, don't you realise that in every activity the inferior practitioners are numerous and of no value, while the serious ones are few, and valuable beyond measure? And don't you think that gymnastics is a worthy activity, money-making too, and rhetoric and generalship?

ὥς γε πρὸς σὲ τάληθῃ εἰρήσθαι· ὥστε οὐκ ἔχω ὅπως προτρέπω τὸ μειράκιον ἐπὶ φιλοσοφίαν. ΣΩ. ὦ φίλε Κρίτων, οὐκ οἶσθα ὅτι ἐν παντὶ

ἐπιτηδεύματι οἱ μὲν φαῦλοι πολλοὶ καὶ οὐδενὸς ἄξιοι, οἱ δὲ σπουδαῖοι ὀλίγοι καὶ παντὸς ἄξιοι; ἐπεὶ γυμναστική οὐ καλὸν δοκεῖ σοι εἶναι, καὶ χρηματιστική καὶ ῥητορική καὶ στρατηγία; ΚΡ. ἔμοιγε πάντως δήπου. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἐν ἐκάστη τούτων τοὺς πολλοὺς πρὸς

307b

CR: Entirely so, of course I do.

307b

S: Well then, in each of those cases, don't you know that most people are comical exponents of the particular role?

307b

CR: Yes, by Zeus, that is certainly true.

307b

S: So, will you yourself shun all of these activities on account of this, and refuse to direct your son towards them?

ἕκαστον τὸ ἔργον οὐ καταγελάστους ὄρα; ΚΡ. ναὶ μὰ τὸν Δία, καὶ μάλα ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἦ οὖν τούτου ἔνεκα αὐτός τε φεύξῃ πάντα τὰ ἐπιτηδεύματα καὶ τῷ υἱῷ οὐκ ἐπιτρέψεις; ΚΡ. οὐκ οὐν δίκαιόν γε, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. μὴ τοῖνυν ὅ γε οὐ χρή ποίει, ὦ Κρίτων, ἀλλ' ἐάσας χαίρειν τοὺς ἐπιτηδεύοντας φιλοσοφίαν, εἴτε χρηστοὶ εἰσιν εἴτε πονηροί, αὐτὸ τὸ πρᾶγμα βασανίσας καλῶς τε καὶ εὖ,

307c

CR: That wouldn't be right, Socrates.

307c

S: Then do not do what you should not do, Crito. Rather, bid farewell to the exponents of philosophy, whether they be worthy or base, and having tested the subject itself well and truly, turn not just your sons but every man away from it if it proves in your eyes to be unworthy. However, if it proves to be as I think it is, then pursue it and practise it with all your heart, both you and yours, as the saying goes.

ἐὰν μὲν σοι φαίνεται φαῦλον ὄν, πάντ' ἄνδρα ἀπότρεπε, μὴ μόνον τοὺς υἱεῖς· ἐὰν δὲ φαίνεται οἷον οἶμαι αὐτὸ ἐγὼ εἶναι, θαρρῶν δίωκε καὶ ἄσκει, τὸ λεγόμενον δὴ τοῦτο, αὐτός τε καὶ τὰ παιδιά.

Notes

¹ This is a reference to Clinias, who becomes involved later in the dialogue.

² A reference to the King of the Persian (Achaemenid) Empire.

³ The Corybantes were armed, crested male dancers who worshipped the goddess Cybele. They also conducted a male coming-of-age ritual connected with the victory of a warrior in battle.

⁴ According to legend, Medea had the power to reanimate dismembered bodies and rejuvenate the elderly. Having seen her reconstitute a ram that had been cut up and put into a stew, and desirous that their father should be returned to his youth, the daughters of King Pelias cut him up and put him in a pot, but Medea never performed the ceremony.

⁵ Marsyas was a Satyr who, according to legend, challenged Apollo to a music contest and lost. As punishment, he chose to have his hide used as a wine-skin.

⁶ Cronus, the father of Zeus, who was overthrown by his son, represents things that are past their time.

⁷ Meneleus forced Proteus to reveal which of the gods he had offended so that he could make amends and find his way home. *Odyssey* iv.456 ff.

⁸ The quote is likely to be from *Seven Against Thebes*.

⁹ This proverb involves needless repetition because Corinthus was the son of Zeus.

¹⁰ Castor and Pollux, known as the *dioscuri*, were protectors of seafarers.

¹¹ Hellebore is a plant now known to be toxic but which was used in ancient medicine to treat various conditions, including mental disorders.

¹² Geryon and Briareus were two fearsome mythological creatures. The first was a giant with multiple heads and multiple bodies; the second was a giant with one hundred arms.

¹³ Herodotus, iv.65, describes the Scythians as gilding the skulls of their enemies and drinking from them.

¹⁴ The Greek phrase translated 'capable of vision' is ambiguous between 'capable of seeing' and 'capable of being seen'.

¹⁵ The Greek phrases translated 'a speaking of what is silent' and 'a silence of speaking' are ambiguous between 'a speaking by a thing that is silent' and 'a

speaking about a thing that is silent’.

¹⁶ The Greek phrase translated here is ambiguous between ‘it is appropriate for the cook that the cook engages in cutting and skinning’ and ‘it is appropriate for the cook that one engages in the cutting and skinning of the cook’.

¹⁷ According to legend, Ion was the son of Apollo and Creusa. Euripides, *Ion* 61-75.

¹⁸ *Olympian* i.1.